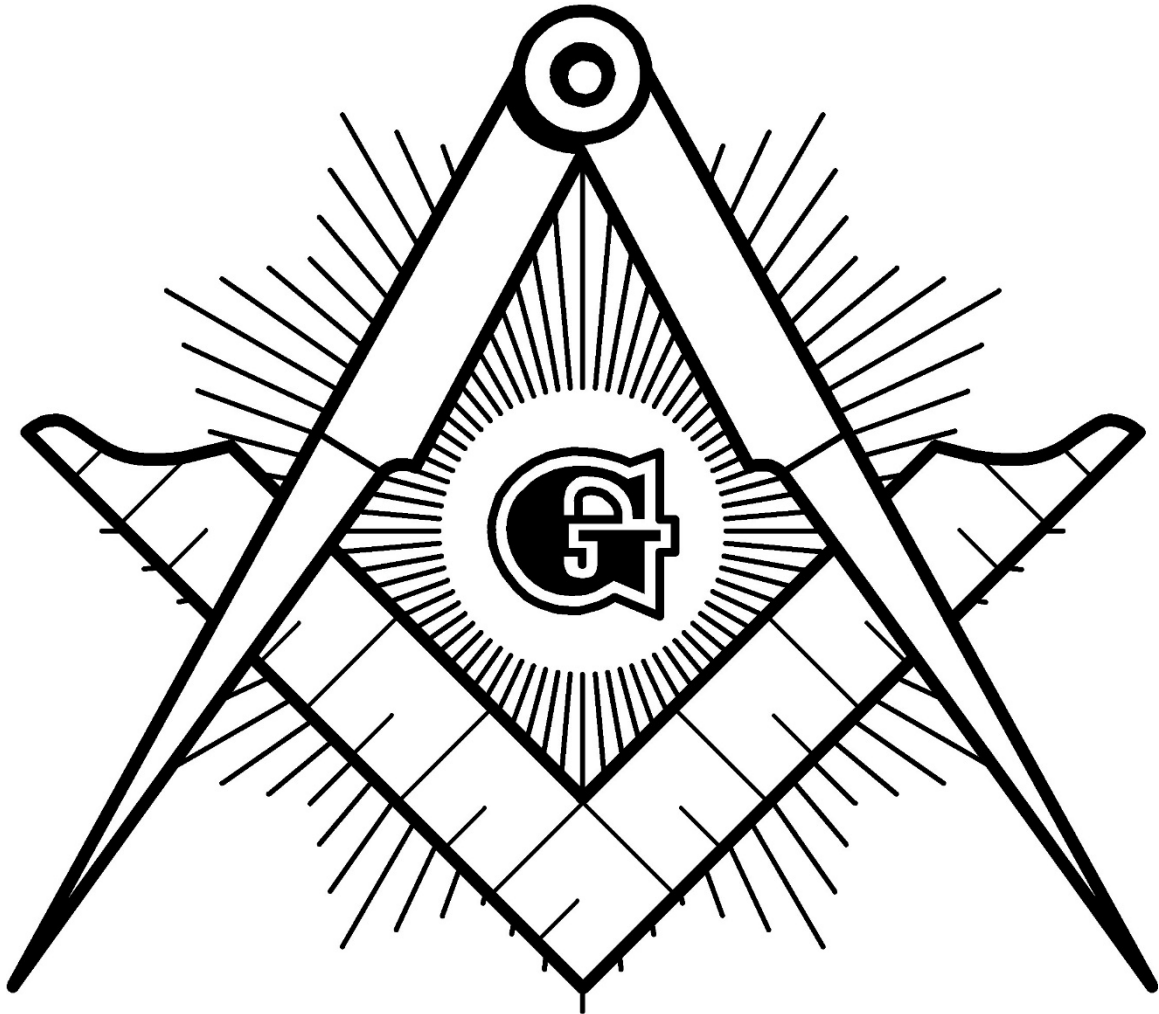


SHORT TALKS FOR THE MASTER MASON



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BOOK OF CONSTITUTIONS GUARDED BY THE TILER'S SWORD

by: Unknown

Let me introduce the speaker of the evening, although, as presiding officers so often say, he hardly needs an introduction. I believe that most Masons know him well and, after I describe him, you will easily recognize him. He is the Tiler of his Lodge and a very interesting man to meet. You will find it worthwhile cultivating his acquaintance.

I have met him wherever I have been privileged to visit lodge. He is a man of uncertain age. He is old in wisdom, in his knowledge of Masonic Lore, and in his understanding of human nature. He is young with that spirit of eternal youth that comes with fulfillment of the sweet law of Brotherhood. He knows all the Brethren intimately and never misses a meeting of his lodge. He has seen young men hesitatingly enter the preparation room for the first time; he has seen them passed and raised, watched their enthusiastic progress through the stations, served under them as they sat in the Oriental Chair, and walked with drawn sword at the head of the procession as they were carried to their last resting place.

His name is legion, but I prefer to call him Peters, because everybody calls him by his first name; and if your think tank is working tonight, you will recognize the appropriateness of calling him Peter.

He does not get into the lodge room very often and would be particularly embarrassed if called upon to make a speech. I have seen him come into the room on large meeting nights to help the deacons purge the lodge. He will cast his eyes carelessly over the crowd and then confidently couch for every man in the room. I have sometimes wondered whether he possesses uncanny wisdom or whether he is simply faking. But let us go out into his little room that is furnished with a cast-off table and some chairs that were used in the lodge room before it was remodeled; let us light the cigar, cigarette or pipe

that Masonic custom denies us in the lodge, tilt our chairs back against the wall, lay our heads against that greasy spot left by many heads that have rested there before ours, and listen to this Masonic Philosopher.

"I have often wondered, " says Peter, "about these Masonic Symbols. Generally, when you fellows are in there watching the work, I am out here by myself, and so you see I have lots of time to think. Sometimes I am puzzled by what the Ritual says in its explanation of these symbols. Take for instance, those nine emblems of the Third Degree. I suppose most of you fellows have forgotten all about them because you generally come streaming out here and throw your aprons in a pile for me to straighten out about the time the Master starts on his lecture. The only time you stay is when the Master tells you there is going to be coffee and sandwiches after the work, and then you hang around during the lecture.

"There is one of those emblems that has given me more trouble than anything else in Masonry; it is the one in which you see a book lying on a velvet pillow with a sword over the top. The Masters tells you that it is the Book of Constitutions Guarded by the Tiler's Sword, and that it reminds us to be ever watchful and guarded in our thoughts, words, and actions, particularly when before the enemies of Masonry, ever bearing in mind those truly Masonic virtues,; silence and circumspection. Now, that never seemed just right to me.

"Those old boys who gave us this Ritual had pretty good ideas about symbolism, and the things they used as symbols generally meant just exactly what they told you about them. It is funny how much meaning they could get out of such things as a trowel, a square or a level. True symbolism, you know, isn't forced. It just comes naturally. The moment you hear the explanation, you say, 'Of Course! Why didn't I think of that before?' That is why I could never see what there was about that book and sword to teach us to be watchful and guarded in our thoughts, words and actions. "You know the Chinese with their three monkeys, one with his hands over his ears, the other with his hands over his eyes, and the third with his hands over his mouth made a much better symbol of being watchful and guarded than our book and sword, and the same thing holds true in regard to silence and circumspection. If that is what we want to teach, we had better get rid of that book and sword and throw a picture of the three wise monkeys on the screen.

"Some time ago I read a book written by a great man who had spent his life studying Masonry. One thing that makes me want to study Masonry is

that so many great men have found it worthy of such deep study. This writer seemed to have the idea that Masonry didn't always say just exactly what it meant. He said something about the real truth of Masonry being hidden in the Ritual instead of being revealed by it; that you had to search out the real meaning of the Masonic Symbols for yourself. That always stuck by me. I was talking to one of the brethren about it and he agreed with this Masonic writer.

This brother said we don't sell the secrets of Freemasonry; when a man pays for his degrees, we only sell him the tools and he must use them to dig out the secrets for himself. And so, I dug away at the old book and sword trying to understand what it really meant until the other night when one of these Service association fellows came around and talked to us. "He showed us how much the Masons had to do with the founding of this government. He told us how Paul Revere's ride was organized among Masons and how all the fellows that helped Paul Revere make that ride were his Brethren, while Paul Revere himself was Provincial Grand Master of Masons in Massachusetts. He told us of the Boston Tea Party, and how the little affair was arranged at the Old Green Dragon Tavern, which was nothing more or less than a Masonic Temple. He told us about John Hancock, Benjamin Franklin, Joseph Warren, Lafayette, and George Washington; and ever so many more of those early patriots who were all Masons, and how it was by working together as Masons that they carried out on the Revolutionary War, and then afterwards built this nation of ours. he told us about the constitution of the United States. You know the interesting thing about that is not that these men were Masons, many of our prominent citizens today are Masons, but that the same group of men who were leaders of our Fraternity were also leaders of the nation at that time. And then he told us how, because our Brethren had laid the foundation of this nation and because that foundation was in accord with Masonic principles, it was our duty to build the rest of the Temple to Liberty in America, and to watch over it and guard it with our very lives.

"So I got the thinking about that old Book and sword and it seemed to me that perhaps after all there was a real meaning behind it that was concealed rather than revealed in the Ritual, as that Masonic writer that I told you about said; and it seemed to me that Book of Constitutions, instead of being a symbol of silence and circumspection, was a symbol of constitutional government such as we have in this country. Our Book of Constitutions, you know, is our Masonic fundamental law, just as the Constitution of the United

States is the fundamental law of our nation. So, you see how naturally it becomes the symbol of constitutional government.

"That Sword over the Book is this little old sword lying here on the table beside me. You know, this sword isn't any good to hurt anybody with, but it is just a symbol by which Freemasonry protects itself against cowans and eavesdroppers. So, it is just a symbol of Masonry on guard and, as the Book of Constitutions is a symbol of constitutional government, the Tiler's Sword is a symbol of Masonry on guard. Do you see what I'm getting at? I believe the Book of Constitutions Guarded by the Tiler's Sword teaches us that Masonry should always be the Guardian of Constitutional Government.

"I was telling another Brother about this the other night and he told me I was wrong because Masonry was older than the United States government and the symbol, he said, must be older than this country of ours. So, I got to thinking about that too and it came to me that much of this speculative Masonry that we have today comes to us from England. Of course, I understand that Masonry as we know it has been gathered together from many countries. Some fellows say that we get it direct from the boys that worked on King Solomon's Temple, but it may be that isn't quite right. Speculative Masonry, in its present form at least, did have its origin in England, and you know that a lot of the ideas about constitutional government that were accepted by us were first brought into practice back in England before the United States became a free country. And so I thought it very likely that even back then in those days our English Brethren, just like our Revolutionary Brethren were fighting for constitutional government and maybe they had as much to do with getting it in England as George Washington, Paul Revere and the other boys had with getting it in this country.

"But I'm inclined to agree with Brother Mackey, who believed that our monitorial definition of this emblem is a modern one, and was introduced by Brother Webb. It does not appear in the first edition of Webb's Monitor, but I found it in the second edition, printed in 1802. Mackey says, 'This interpretation of Webb is a very unsatisfactory one. The Book of Constitutions is the Symbol of constituted law rather than of silence and circumspection, and when guarded by the Tiler's Sword it would seem properly to symbolize regard for and obedience to law, a prominent Masonic duty.'

"So, until somebody shows me that I am wrong, I am going to believe every time I see that book and sword on the screen that the book is the Constitution of the United States and the sword is Freemasonry on guard;

and instead of teaching me to be watchful and guarded in all my thoughts, words and actions; it is going to teach me to be ever watchful and guarded against the enemies of my nation and its Constitution, so that when I get up into the Grand Lodge above those old boys up there that built this nation are going to meet me with the Lion's Paw, and vouch for me when the Supreme Grand Master of the Universe takes the Pass. "

That is Peter's story of the Book of Constitutions Guarded by the Tiler's Sword. You may take it or leave it, but somehow or other I think he is right. At least, ever since I heard tell that story I have had a new thrill while listening to the Master explaining the nine Masonic Emblems in the Third Degree; and I say to myself, "Well, that is all right for the candidate. We can't give him all the light at once, because he would simply be blinded by its brilliance. But, for myself, I have been out in the anteroom with Peters using our working tools in a search for further Masonic light, and I know that sword and book mean that it is up to me to fight the enemies of constitutional government and to protect our Constitution from those seeking to destroy it. And with the help of the Great Architect of the Universe, and my nearly three million Brethren, I am going to do that little job!

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FIVE POINTS

by: Unknown

The Five Points of Fellowship, as every Master Masons knows, contain the essence of the doctrine of brotherhood. But many a new brother asks, pertinently, "why are they called "Points?" In the Old Constitutions, as explained in the Hallowell or Regius manuscript, are fifteen regulations, called "points." The old verse runs:

"Fifteen artyculus there they soughton And fifteen poyntys there they wroghton." Translated into easy English, this reads: "Fifteen articles there they sought And fifteen points there they wrought."

Phillips "New World of Words," published in 1706, defines "point" as "a head, or chief matter." Moreover, an operative Masons "points" the seams of as wall by filling in the chinks left in laying bricks or stone, thus completing the structure.

In older days of the Speculative Art there were "twelve original points" as we learn from the old English lectures, done away with by the United Grand Lodge of England at the time of the reconciliation of 1813. They were introduced by the following passage:

"There are in Freemasonry twelve original points, which form the basis of the system and comprehend the whole ceremony of initiation. Without the existence of these points, no man ever was, or can be, legally and essentially received into the Order. Every person who is made a Mason must go through these twelve forms and ceremonies, not only in the first degree, but in every subsequent one." The twelve points were: Opening, Preparation, Report, Entrance, Prayer, Circumambulation, Advancing. Obligation, Investiture, Northeast Corner and Closing; and each was symbolized by one of the Twelve Tribes of Israel for ingenious reasons not necessary to set forth here.

The twelve original points were never introduced into the United States, and are now no longer used in England, although the ceremonies which they typify, of course, are integral parts of all Masonic rituals.

Our Five Points of Fellowship are not allied to these, except as they are reflected in the word "points." We also find this relationship in the Perfect Points of our Entrance, once called Principal Points. Dr. Oliver, famous,

learned and not always accurate Masonic student and writer (1782-1867) sums up the Five Points in his "Landmarks," as follows:

"Assisting a brother in his distress, supporting him in his virtuous undertakings, praying for his welfare, keeping inviolate his secrets and vindicating his reputation as well in his absence as in his presence."

By which it will be seen that in Oliver's day the Five Points were not exactly as they are with us now.

Strange though it seems, a change was made in the symbolism of the Five Points as recently as 1842, at the Baltimore Masonic Convention. Prior to that time, according to Cole, the Five Points were symbolized by hand, foot, knee, breast and back. After 1842, the hand was omitted, and the mouth and ear tacked on as the fifth.

Mackey believed that:

"The omission of the first and the insertion of the last are innovations and the enumeration given by Cole is the old and genuine one which was originally taught in England by Preston and in his country by Webb."

Some curiosities of ritual changes, though interesting, are more for the antiquarian than the average lodge member. Most of us are more concerned with a practical explanation of the Five Points as they have been taught for nearly a hundred years.

For they have a practical explanation, which goes much more deeply into fraternal and brotherly relations than the ritual indicates. A man goes on foot a short distance by preference; for a longer journey he boards a streetcar, rides in an automobile, engages passage on a railroad or courses through the air in a plane. Service to our brethren on foot does not imply any special virtue in that means of transportation. The word expresses the willingness of him who would serve our own pleasure and refuse to travel merely because the means is not to our liking would hardly be Masonic.

We assist our brethren when we can; also, we serve them. The two terms are not interchangeable; we cannot assist a Brother without serving, but we may serve him without assisting him. For a wholly negative action may be a service; suppose we have a just claim against him and, because of our Fraternal relations, we postpone pressing it. That is true service, but not active assistance, such as we might give if we gave or loaned him money to satisfy some other's claim.

How far should we go "on foot" to render service? Nothing is said in the ritual, but the cable-tow is otherwise used as a measure of length. That same Baltimore Masonic Convention defined a cable-tow's length as "the scope of a brother's reasonable ability." Across town may be too far for one, and across a continent not too far for another. In better words, our own conception of brotherhood must say how far we travel to help our brother.

Mackey expressed thus:

"Indolence should not cause our footsteps to halt, or wrath to turn them aside; but with eager alacrity and swiftness of foot, we should press forward in the exercise of charity and kindness to a distressed fellow creature."

The petition at the Altar of the Great Architect of the Universe before engaging in any great and important undertaking is sound Masonic doctrine. To name the welfare of our brother in our petitions is good - but not for the reasons which the good Dr. Mackey set forth; the great Masonic student's pen slipped here, even as Jove has been known to nod! He Said: "In our devotions to almighty God we should remember a brother's welfare as our own, for the prayers of a fervent and sincere heart will find no less favor in the sight of heaven because the petition for self intermingles with aspirations of benevolence for a friend." Apparently, we should pray for our friends because God will look with favor on an unselfish action on our part - which is un-Masonic and selfish! Cole, writing years before Mackey (1817) said of his Third, our Second Point:

"When I offer up my ejaculations to Almighty God, a brother's welfare I will remember as my own, for as the voices of babes and sucklings ascend to the Throne of Grace, so most assuredly will the breathings of a fervent heart arise to the mansions of bliss, as our prayers are certainly required of each other."

This seems to be interpretable as meaning that we should pray for our brethren because we love them, and because, knowing our own need of their prayers, we realize their need of ours.

Anciently, it was written "Laborare est orare," - to labor is to pray. If indeed prayer is labor, then to pray for our brethren we may labor for our brethren, which at once clarifies the Second Point and makes it a practical, everyday, do-it-now admonition. To work for our brother's welfare is in the most brotherly manner to petition the Most High for him.

We often associate with the idea of a "secret" something less than proper; "He has a secret in his life," "He is secretive." "He says one thing but in his secret heart he thinks another" are all expressions which seem to connote some degree of guilt with what is secret. We keep our brother's secrets, guilty or innocent, but let us not assume that every secret is of a guilty variety. He may have a secret ambition, a secret joy, a secret hope - if he confides these to us, is our teaching merely to refuse to tell them, or to keep them in the fine old sense of that word - to hold, to guard. to preserve. The Keeper of the Door stands watch and ward, not to keep it from others, but to see that none use it improperly. Thus, we are to keep the secret joys and ambitions of our brethren, close in our hearts, until he wants them known, but also by sympathy and understanding, helping him to maintain them.

Even without this broad interpretation, the keeping of a brother's confidence has more to it than mere silence. If he confides to us a guilty secret, since to betray him may not only make known that which he wishes hidden; but places him in danger. To betray a trust is never the act of a brother. In ordinary life an unsought trust does not carry with it responsibility to preserve it; in Freemasonry it does! No matter how we wish we did not share the secret, if it has been given us by a brother, we cannot suffer our tongues to betray him, no matter what it costs us to remain silent, unless we forget alike our obligation and the Third Point.

"Do you stumble and fall, my brother? My hand is stretched out to prevent it. Do you need aid? My hand is yours - use it. It is your hand, for the time being. My strength is united to yours. You are not alone in your struggle - I stand with you on the Fourth of the Five Points, and as your need may be, so "Deo volente," will be my strength for you."

So, must we speak when the need comes. It makes no difference in what way our brother stumbles; it may be mentally; it may be spiritually; it may be materially; it may be morally. No exceptions are noted in our teachings. We are not told to stretch forth the hand in aid "If," and "perhaps," and "but!" Not for us to judge, to condemn, to admonish . . . for us only to put forth our strength unto our falling brother at his need, without question and without stint. For such is the Kingdom of Brotherhood.

More sins are committed in the name of the Fifth of the Five Points than in the name of liberty! Too often we offer counsel when it is not advice but help that is needed. Too often we admonish of motes within our brother's eye

when our own vision is blinded by beams. What said the Lord? (Amos VII, in the Fellowcraft's Degree.) "Behold, I will set a plumb line in the midst of my people Israel; I will not again pass by them anymore." "In the midst of my people Israel" - not in the far away land; not across the river; not up on the mountain top, but in the midst of them, an intimate personal individual plumb line!

So are we to judge our brethren; not by the plumb, the square or the level that we are each taught to carry in our hearts, but by his plumb, his square, his level.

If he build true by his own tools, we have no right to judge him by ours. The friendly reminders we must whisper to him are of incorrect building by his own plumb line. He may differ from us in opinion; he may be Republican where we are Democrat, Methodist where we are Baptist; Wet where we are Dry; Protectionist where we are Free trade; League of Nations proponent where we are "biter enders" - we must not judge him by the plumb line of our own beliefs.

Only when we see him building untrue to his own tools have we the right to remind him of his faults. When we see a brave man shrinking, a virtuous man abandoning himself to vice, a good man acting as a criminal - then is his building faulty judged by his own plumb line and we may heed the Fifth of the Five Points and counsel and advise him to swing back, true to his own working tools.

And finally, we do well to remember Mackey's interpretation of the Fifth Point:

". . . we should never revile a brother's character behind his back but rather, when attacked by others, support and defend it." "Speak no ill of the dead, since they cannot defend themselves" might well have been written of the absent. In the Masonic sense no brother is absent if his brother is present, since then he has always a champion and defender, standing upon the Fifth Point as upon a rock.

So considered - and this little paper is but a slender outline of how much and how far the Five Points extend - these teachings of Masonry, concerned wholly with the relations of brother to brother, become a broad and beautiful band of blue - the blue of the Blue Lodge - the True Blue of Brotherhood.

FOREIGN COUNTRIES

by: Carl H. Claudy

A reprint of Chapter XXX of "Foreign Countries," published and copyrighted by the Masonic Service Association of North America in 1925.

Our ancient operative brethren desired to become Masters so that, when they travelled in foreign countries, they could still practice their craft. Speculative Freemasons still desire to "travel in foreign countries" and study their craft that they may receive such instruction as will enable them to do so, and when travelling, to receive a Master's Wages.

But the "Foreign Countries" do not mean to us the various geographical and political divisions of the Old World, nor do we use the Word we learn as a means of identification to enable us to build material temples and receive coin of the realm for our labor. "Foreign Countries" is to us a symbol.

Like all the rest of the symbols, it has more than one interpretation; but, unlike many, none of these is very difficult to trace or understand.

Freemasonry itself is the first "foreign country" in which the initiate will travel; a world as different from the familiar workaday world, as France is different from England, or Belgium from Greece. Everything is different in the Masonic world; the standards are different, the "Money" is different, the ideas are different. In the familiar world, money, place and power are the standards by which we judge our fellows. In the fraternity all are on the level, and there are neither rich nor poor. In the world outside there are laws to prevent, and police and penalties to enforce obedience; in the fraternity the laws are not "thou shalt not" but "thou shalt" and the fundamental of them all is the golden rule, the law of brotherly love. Men conform to the laws of Freemasonry not because they must but because they will. Surely such a land is a "foreign country" to the stranger within its borders; and the visitor must study it, learn its language and its customs, if he is to enjoy it.

Many learn but a few phrases and only enough of its customs to conform. There are thousands of Americans who went all over France during the war with a pack of cigarettes, a friendly smile and "no comprende!" as their sole knowledge of the language; but did they learn to know France? A Lodge member may know the words of the opening and closing and how to act

in a lodge, learn to call his fellows "brother" and pay his dues; but will that get him all there is in the foreign country in which he finds him-self?

America north and south is a mighty continent . . . It has many countries. To know one is not to know all. The man at home in Mexico will find Newfoundland strange, and the Canadian will not feel at home in Chile if he knows nothing of that country.

So, it is with the vast continent of Freemasonry. It has many "foreign countries within it; and he is the wise and happy Freemason who works patiently at the pleasant task of visiting and studying them. There are the foreign countries of philosophy, of jurisprudence and of history. No Freemason is really worthy of the name who does not understand something of how his new land is governed, of what it stands for and why.

And there is the foreign country of Symbolism of which this little book is far less a guide than a gateway.

As a Master Mason, a man has the right to travel in all the foreign countries of Freemasonry. There is none to say him nay. If he will but "learn the work" and keep himself in good standing, he may visit where he will. But it is not within the door of other lodges than his own that he will find the boundary line and the guideposts of those truly Masonic "Foreign Countries" to which he has been given the passport by his brethren. He will find gateways to those lands in the library, in the study club, in books and magazines; and, most and best of all, in the quiet hour alone, when what he has read and learned comes back to him to be pondered over and thought through. The "foreign country" of symbolism has engaged the thoughtful and serious consideration of hundreds of able Masonic students, as has that of the history of our Order. Not to visit them both; aye, not to make oneself a citizen of them both, is to refuse the privileges one has sought and labored to obtain. One asks for a petition, prays one's friend to take it to his lodge, knocks on the door, takes obligations, works to learn and finally receives the Master's Degree. One receives it, struggles for it, hopes for it . . . why? That one may travel in the far lands and receive the reward there awaiting...

Then why hesitate? Why wait? Why put it off? Why allow others to pass on and gain; while one stands, the gate open, the new land beckoning, and all the Masonic world to see?

That is the symbolism of the "foreign countries" . . . that is the meaning of the phrase which once meant, to operative Masons, exactly what it says. To

the Freemason who reads it aright it is a clarion call to action, to study, to an earnest pressing forward on the new highway. For time is short and the night cometh when no man can work!

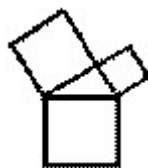
To the young Freemason, particularly, is the symbol a ringing appeal. To those who are old in the Craft, who have set their pace, determined their course and become satisfied with all they have managed to learn of the fraternity, with what little they have been able to take from it, "foreign countries" means countries which are foreign and nothing more. But to the young man just starting out as a Freemason . . . Oh, my brother, heed you the symbolism of the phrase and make your entry through the gateway, your limbs strong to travel, your mind open to learn. For if you truly travel in the Masonic foreign countries, you will receive Master's Wages beyond your greatest expectations. The way is open to the Freemason; not an easy way, perhaps, or a short way, but a clear way. Not for the old Mason, the man set in his ways, the man content with the literal meaning of the words, the "book Mason," the pin-wearer, not for them the foreign countries of symbolism, and Masonic knowledge.

But you, you who are new, you to whom Freemasonry is yet a wonder and a vision. a mystery and a glory . . . for you the gate is wide, for you the path is clear; for you the foreign countries beckon . . . hang you not back!

For at the end of the journey, when the last foreign country of Freemasonry has been travelled and learned and loved, you shall come to a new gate, above which there is a new name written . . . and when you have read it you will know the True Word of a Master Mason.

THE 47th PROBLEM

by: Unknown



Containing more real food for thought, and impressing on the receptive mind a greater truth than any other of the emblems in the lecture of the Sublime Degree, the 47th problem of Euclid generally gets less attention, and certainly less than all the rest. Just why this grand exception should receive so little explanation in our lecture; just how it has happened, that, although the Fellowcraft's degree makes so much of Geometry, Geometry's right hand should be so cavalierly treated, is not for the present inquiry to settle. We all know that the single paragraph of our lecture devoted to Pythagoras and his work is passed over with no more emphasis than that given to the Beehive of the Book of Constitutions.

More's the pity; you may ask many a Mason to explain the 47th problem, or even the meaning of the word "hecatomb," and receive only an evasive answer, or a frank "I don't know - why don't you ask the Deputy?" The Masonic legend of Euclid is very old - just how old we do not know, but its long antedates our present Master Mason's Degree. The paragraph relating to Pythagoras in our lecture we take wholly from Thomas Smith Webb, whose first Monitor appeared at the close of the eighteenth century.

It is repeated here to refresh the memory of those many brethren who usually leave before the lecture:

"The 47th problem of Euclid was an invention of our ancient friend and brother, the great Pythagoras, who, in his travels through Asia, Africa and Europe was initiated into several orders of Priesthood, and was also Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason. This wise philosopher enriched his mind abundantly in a general knowledge of things, and more especially in Geometry. On this subject he drew out many problems and theorems, and, among the most distinguished, he erected this, when, in the joy of his heart, he exclaimed Eureka, in the Greek Language signifying "I

have found it," and upon the discovery of which he is said to have sacrificed a hecatomb.

It teaches Masons to be general lovers of the arts and sciences." Some of facts here stated are historically true; those which are only fanciful at least bear out the symbolism of the conception. In the sense that Pythagoras was a learned man, a leader, a teacher, a founder of a school, a wise man who saw God in nature and in number; and he was a "friend and brother." That he was "initiated into several orders of Priesthood" is a matter of history. That he was "Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason" is of course poetic license and an impossibility, as the "Sublime Degree" as we know it is only a few hundred years old - not more than three at the very outside.

Pythagoras is known to have traveled, but the probabilities are that his wanderings were confined to the countries bordering the Mediterranean. He did go to Egypt, but it is at least problematical that he got much further into Asia than Asia Minor. He did indeed "enrich his mind abundantly" in many matters, and particularly in mathematics. That he was the first to "erect" the 47th problem is possible, but not proved; at least he worked with it so much that it is sometimes called "The Pythagorean problem." If he did discover it, he might have exclaimed "Eureka" but the he sacrificed a hecatomb - a hundred head of cattle - is entirely out of character, since the Pythagoreans were vegetarians and revered all animal life.

Pythagoras was probably born on the island of Samos, and from contemporary Grecian accounts was a studious lad whose manhood was spent in the emphasis of mind as opposed to the body, although he was trained as an athlete. He was antipathetic to the licentiousness of the aristocratic life of his time and he and his followers were persecuted by those who did not understand them.

Aristotle wrote of him: "The Pythagoreans first applied themselves to mathematics, a science which they improved; and penetrated with it, they fancied that the principles of mathematics were the principles of all things."

It was written by Eudemus that: "Pythagoreans changed geometry into the form of a liberal science, regarding its principles in a purely abstract manner and investigated its theorems from the immaterial and intellectual point of view," a statement which rings with familiar music in the ears of Masons.

Diogenes said, "It was Pythagoras who carried Geometry to perfection," also "He discovered the numerical relations of the musical scale."

Proclus states: "The word Mathematics originated with then Pythagoreans!"

The sacrifice of the hecatomb apparently rests on a statement of Plutarch, who probably took it from Apollodorus, that "Pythagoras sacrificed an ox on finding a geometrical diagram." As the Pythagoreans originated the doctrine of Metempsychosis which predicates that all souls live first in animals and then in man - the same doctrine of reincarnation held so generally in the East from whence Pythagoras might have heard it - the philosopher and his followers were vegetarians and revered all animal life, so the "sacrifice" is probably mythical. Certainly there is nothing in contemporary accounts of Pythagoras to lead us to think that he was either sufficiently wealthy, or silly enough to slaughter a hundred valuable cattle to express his delight at learning to prove what was later to be the 47th problem of Euclid.

In Pythagoras' day (582 B.C.) of course the "47th problem" was not called that. It remained for Euclid, of Alexandria, several hundred years later, to write his books of Geometry, of which the 47th and 48th problems form the end of the first book. It is generally conceded either that Pythagoras did indeed discover the Pythagorean problem, or that it was known prior to his time, and used by him; and that Euclid, recording in writing the science of Geometry as it was known then, merely availed himself of the mathematical knowledge of his era.

It is probably the most extraordinary of all scientific matters that the books of Euclid, written three hundred years or more before the Christian era, should still be used in schools. While a hundred different geometries have been invented or discovered since his day, Euclid's "Elements" are still the foundation of that science which is the first step beyond the common mathematics of every day. In spite of the emphasis placed upon geometry in our Fellowcrafts degree our insistence that it is of a divine and moral nature, and that by its study we are enabled not only to prove the wonderful properties of nature but to demonstrate the more important truths of morality, it is common knowledge that most men know nothing of the science which they studied - and most despised - in their school days. If one man in ten in any lodge can demonstrate the 47th problem of Euclid, the lodge is above the common run in educational standards!

And yet the 47th problem is at the root not only of geometry, but of most applied mathematics; certainly, of all which are essential in engineering, in astronomy, in surveying, and in that wide expanse of problems concerned with finding one unknown from two known factors. At the close of the first book Euclid states the 47th problem - and its correlative 48th - as follows:

"47th - In every right-angle triangle the square of the hypotenuse is equal to the sum of the squares of the other two sides." "48th - If the square described of one of the sides of a triangle be equal to the squares described of the other two sides, then the angle contained by these two is a right angle."

This sounds more complicated than it is. Of all people, Masons should know what a square is! As our ritual teaches us, a square is a right angle or the fourth part of a circle, or an angle of ninety degrees. For the benefit of those who have forgotten their school days, the "hypotenuse" is the line which makes a right angle (a square) into a triangle, by connecting the ends of the two lines which form the right angle.

For illustrative purposes let us consider that the familiar Masonic square has one arm six inches long and one arm eight inches long. If a square be erected on the six-inch arm, that square will contain square inches to the number of six times six, or thirty-six square inches. The square erected on the eight-inch arm will contain square inches to the number of eight times eight, or sixty-four square inches.

The sum of sixty-four and thirty-six square inches is one hundred square inches.

According to the 47th problem the square which can be erected upon the hypotenuse, or line adjoining the six and eight inch arms of the square should contain one hundred square inches. The only square which can contain one hundred square inches has ten-inch sides, since ten, and no other number, is the square root of one hundred. This is provable mathematically, but it is also demonstrable with an actual square. The curious only need lay off a line six inches long, at right angles to a line eight inches long; connect the free ends by a line (the Hypotenuse) and measure the length of that line to be convinced - it is, indeed, ten inches long. This simple matter then, is the famous 47th problem. But while it is simple in conception it is complicated with innumerable ramifications in use.

It is the root of all geometry. It is behind the discovery of every unknown from two known factors. It is the very cornerstone of mathematics.

The engineer who tunnels from either side through a mountain uses it to get his two shafts to meet in the center.

The surveyor who wants to know how high a mountain may be ascertains the answer through the 47th problem.

The astronomer who calculates the distance of the sun, the moon, the planets and who fixes "the duration of time and seasons, years and cycles," depends upon the 47th problem for his results. The navigator traveling the trackless seas uses the 47th problem in determining his latitude, his longitude and his true time. Eclipses are predicated, tides are specified as to height and time of occurrence, land is surveyed, roads run, shafts dug, and bridges built because of the 47th problem of Euclid - probably discovered by Pythagoras - shows the way.

It is difficult to show "why" it is true; easy to demonstrate that it is true. If you ask why the reason for its truth is difficult to demonstrate, let us reduce the search for "why" to a fundamental and ask "why" is two added to two always four, and never five or three?" We answer, "because we call the product of two added to two by the name of four." If we express the conception of "four-ness" by some other name, then two plus two would be that other name. But the truth would be the same, regardless of the name.

So, it is with the 47th problem of Euclid. The sum of the squares of the sides of any right-angled triangle - no matter what their dimensions - always exactly equals the square of the line connecting their ends (the hypotenuse). One line may be a few 10's of an inch long - the other several miles long; the problem invariably works out, both by actual measurement upon the earth, and by mathematical demonstration.

It is impossible for us to conceive of a place in the universe where two added to two produces five, and not four (in our language). We cannot conceive of a world, no matter how far distant among the stars, where the 47th problem is not true. For "true" means absolute - not dependent upon time, or space, or place, or world or even universe. Truth, we are taught, is a divine attribute and as such is coincident with Divinity, omnipresent.

It is in this sense that the 47th problem "teaches Masons to be general lovers of the art and sciences." The universality of this strange and important mathematical principle must impress the thoughtful with the

immutability of the laws of nature. The third of the movable jewels of the entered Apprentice Degree reminds us that "so should we, both operative and speculative, endeavor to erect our spiritual building (house) in accordance with the rules laid down by the Supreme Architect of the Universe, in the great books of nature and revelation, which are our spiritual, moral and Masonic Trestleboard."

Greatest among "the rules laid down by the Supreme Architect of the Universe," in His great book of nature, is this of the 47th problem; this rule that, given a right angle triangle, we may find the length of any side if we know the other two; or, given the squares of all three, we may learn whether the angle is a "Right" angle, or not. With the 47th problem man reaches out into the universe and produces the science of astronomy. With it he measures the most infinite of distances. With it he describes the whole framework and handiwork of nature. With it he calculates the orbits and the positions of those "numberless worlds about us." With it he reduces the chaos of ignorance to the law and order of intelligent appreciation of the cosmos. With it he instructs his fellow-Masons that "God is always geometrizing" and that the "great book of Nature" is to be read through a square.

Considered thus, the "invention of our ancient friend and brother, the great Pythagoras," becomes one of the most impressive, as it is one of the most important, of the emblems of all Freemasonry, since to the initiate it is a symbol of the power, the wisdom and the goodness of the Great Artificer of the Universe. It is the plainer for its mystery - the more mysterious because it is so easy to comprehend.

Not for nothing does the Fellowcraft's degree beg our attention to the study of the seven liberal arts and sciences, especially the science of geometry, or Masonry. Here, in the Third Degree, is the very heart of Geometry, and a close and vital connection between it and the greatest of all Freemasonry's teachings - the knowledge of the "All-Seeing Eye."

He that hath ears to hear - let him hear - and he that hath eyes to see - let him look! When he has both listened and looked, and understood the truth behind the 47th problem he will see a new meaning to the reception of a Fellowcraft, understand better that a square teaches morality and comprehend why the "angle of 90 degrees, or the fourth part of a circle" is dedicated to the Master!

GRAND MASTER'S POWERS

By: Unknown

No presiding officer, president or chairman of any secular body possesses the powers of a Grand Master. But it is a mistake to consider this high office as altogether without limitations. In the forty-nine Grand Jurisdictions in the Union the powers of the Grand East widely differ, albeit all have certain powers in common. All Grand Masters preside over their Grand Lodges; all can preside over any particular Lodge; all can call Special Communications' all can issue certain dispensations; all can arrest Charters of Lodges for cause. But in many details the powers of the Grand East differ almost as much as their longitudes.

To define and compare the extent and limitation of the powers of Grand Masters requires a complete study of Constitutions, laws, rules, edicts, decisions, landmarks, customs and practices. Masonry has a large body of unwritten law, as binding and as strictly followed as that which is written; he would be a wise student indeed who could claim to be wholly familiar with all the unwritten law of forty-nine Grand Jurisdictions.

Certain powers and limitations of powers of Grand Masters, however, are set forth in Constitutions of forty-seven of America's forty-nine Grand Lodges. It is these which, in the main, are here considered. But it is to be noted that lack of constitutional statement of any power, in any Grand Jurisdiction, does not necessarily mean that the Grand Master does not have it.

All Jurisdictions agree in the inviolability of the Ancient Landmarks. Those Jurisdictions which have adopted compilations of Ancient Landmarks this regard them as the foundation stone of all Masonic law. More than half of the forty-nine Jurisdictions have such compilations; these are:

Either Mackey's list of twenty-five, or Special lists adopted in the particular Grand Jurisdiction; most special lists merely amplify Mackey's, contracting or expanding it to a greater or lesser number.

Mackey's fourth to eight Landmarks, concerned with the Grand Master, read as follows:

4. The government of the Fraternity by a Grand Master.
5. The prerogative of the Grand Master to preside over every assembly of the Craft.
6. The prerogative of the Grand Master to grant dispensations for conferring degrees at irregular intervals.
7. The prerogative of the Grand Master to give dispensations for opening and holding Lodges.
8. The prerogative of the Grand Master to make Masons at sight.

In 19 Jurisdictions, no one in Grand Lodge may question a Grand Master's ruling; what he decides is final. In 22 Grand Jurisdictions an appeal from a Grand Master's decision may be made to Grand Lodge. In others the question is undecided, because it has never been tried. Grand Masters have certain suspending powers; in many Grand Jurisdictions these are strictly defined. Twelve Grand Jurisdictions specifically state that the Grand Master may suspend any Master of a particular Lodge; three permit him to suspend the Master and Wardens; three any elective Lodge officer; four, "any" Lodge officer. In all these the Grand Master must report to Grand Lodge, which passes finally on the matter. In certain Grand Lodges which do not hedge the Grand Master with any limiting definitions of power, he may suspend a Master, but it is by common consent, a belief that this is inherent in the powers of the office, not given by written law.

Doubtless any Grand Master could, and would, suspend a Master for just cause, whether or not the power is defined in the Constitution of his Jurisdiction. But to suspend a Grand Lodge officer, the Grand Master must, indeed, read his Constitution. In Utah and Missouri this may be done provided the Grand Master has the written consent of the Deputy Grand Master and the Grand Wardens, or any two of them. In North Dakota and Wisconsin, the Grand Master may suspend any Grand Lodge officer except the Deputy Grand Master and the Grand Wardens. In Kansas and New Mexico, he may suspend any elective officer of Grand Lodge. In Georgia and Tennessee, with the written consent of the Grand Wardens, he may suspend any appointive officer of Grand Lodge. In Idaho the Grand Master may suspend any member of the Grand Lodge. In Florida he may suspend the Grand Secretary and the Grand Treasurer.

Maine, Massachusetts, Minnesota, New Hampshire and Rhode Island give the Grand Master the power to suspend any “brother” from Masonry. Tennessee expressly forbids the Grand Master to suspend a brother without a trial and sentence. In the five Jurisdictions in which the Grand Master has his autocratic power over the individual, the suspension is reviewable by Grand Lodge at the next Stated Communication. It is probable that this power might be used in at least 3 more Jurisdictions, without authority of special enactment, merely because of the broad general power conferred in the Constitution, or the silence of that document on any powers. Several Grand Jurisdictions expressly prohibit suspending any law of Grand Lodge; Mississippi permits the suspension of certain by-laws. In the majority of Grand Jurisdictions, where suspension of laws is not permitted, it is doubtful that any Grand Master would assume the power, or that Grand Lodge would uphold him if he did! In several Grand Jurisdictions the general powers are so broad that the Grand Master can do practically anything he desires. In the Third Landmark, as recognized in New Jersey, it is stated:

“He may suspend during his pleasure, the operation of any rule or law of Masonry not a Landmark.”

The right of the Grand Master to “make a Mason at sight,” Mackey’s eighth landmark, has caused much discussion. The term is a misnomer, since the act is generally understood as being in the presence, and with the help, of a Lodge convened for the purpose by the dispensing power of the Grand Master.

16 Grand Jurisdictions expressly permit this in the written law, three of them providing that it must be done in a regularly constituted Lodge. In giving the power Kansas states. “It is one which should never be exercised.” Arkansas permits a Grand Master to communicate “the secrets of Masonry with or without ceremonies., the Grand Master might call to his assistance a Lodge, or Masons, or may act alone.” Arkansas also states, “the power should not be exercised in any case, except by dispensing with time.” Other Grand Lodges permit the act by their adoption of Mackey’s list of Landmarks. Four Grand Jurisdictions constitutionally forbid the making of Masons “at sight” by a Grand Master.

Can a Grand Master be tried? Most Grand Jurisdictions are silent on the subject, but as few have provided that he may; thus, in South Carolina, any Lodge may impeach the Grand Master on the expiration of his term in office; he is then tried by the Grand Lodge, in which a two thirds majority may

convict and pass sentence - what, is not stated. In Texas the “Grand Master may be suspended from office by this Grand Lodge, for sufficient cause, after due notice and a hearing.” Connecticut states that the Grand Master is exempted “from trial during the term of his office and afterwards, for any official act as Grand Master.”

At least four Grand Lodges expressly give the Grand Master a second vote, in the event of a tie. In certain Grand Jurisdictions in which the Masters of Lodges have the privilege of casting a vote in the event of a tie, it is assumed that the Grand Master possesses the same privilege.

Limitations of powers of Grand Masters in various Jurisdictions are at time confusingly contradictory. North Carolina states: “The Grand Master is the creature of the Grand Lodge, deriving all his authority from that body. . .” Kansas states: “The Grand Master is not the creature of the Grand Lodge; the office existed before the organization of Grand Lodges.” Pennsylvania gives the Grand Master power to “issue edicts, regulating the action of Lodges, or for the government of the same, their officers, and members.” And in Pennsylvania a Grand Master’s edict is Masonic Law.

Some Grand Jurisdictions define what a Grand Master may and may not do regarding physical requirements of candidates. When North Carolina and Kansas Lodges determined that a candidate is physically disqualified, the Grand Master may not grant a dispensation for him to get the degrees. In Texas the Grand Master “shall pass upon the physical qualifications of all candidates . . . having any physical maim or defect. . .”

In all Grand Jurisdictions the Grand Master may call the Grand Lodge in Special Communication. In some he must give 30 days’ notice, in others, reasonable notice, in still others, notice is left to his discretion.

Many interesting restrictions are written in the laws of the several Grand Jurisdictions. New Hampshire specifies that at the semi-annual communications of the Grand Lodge it is the duty of the Grand Master to “give, or cause to be given, exemplification of the Work and Lectures of each degree.” North Dakota says: “he may cause the ritual and lectures of any one of the symbolic degrees in Masonry to be exemplified before the Grand Lodge at the annual communication.”

Montana states: “The Grand Master has no authority to legislate by decision when the law is silent.”

Utah permits a Grand Master to “heal” or re-obligate a Mason irregularly made in a regular Lodge, but such “healing” must take place in a duly opened chartered Lodge.

In Massachusetts the Grand Master “is requested to make a detailed report of the financial condition of the Grand Lodge

in his annual address.” In practically all Jurisdictions, an annual report is “required” of the Grand Master.

Tennessee specifically states that the Grand Master has not the power to allow a Lodge to change any part of the ritual; then adds: “Nor should he answer questions pertaining to changes in the ritual but should refer them to the Board of Custodians.”

Texas lays on the Grand Master the duty of seeing that the “three principal officers (of a new Lodge, or a resurrected Lodge, long demised) are proficient in their respective duties and are collectively capable of conferring the three degrees, and that the Lodge is supplied with adequate equipment and a safe and secure lodgeroom and anteroom.” New York gives her Grand Master authority to withdraw any amount of money from the Grand Treasurer or from the

“Trustees of the Masonic Hall and Asylum Fund for the relief of Brethren in this Jurisdiction or in sister Jurisdictions in times of calamity and disaster.” The same power has been assumed time and time again by many Grand Masters, and is invariably upheld by the Grand Lodge.

North Carolina forbids a Grand Master to give any decision which “is to be kept secret from the Lodges, or suppressed from his report to the Grand Lodge.”

Tennessee permits a Grand Master “to reverse the action of a Subordinate Lodge in order to correct a known illegality.” The same Jurisdiction also provides that a Grand Master may “administer exclusion in the Grand Lodge for refusal to submit to its Rules of Order, contumacy to the authority of the Grand Master, or for other conduct not sufficiently lenient to require charges and trial, but too much so to be allowed to pass without notice.” Tennessee also provides that “only a Subordinate Lodge, not the Grand Lodge, may be opened for the purpose of laying a foundation stone.” Mississippi forbids her Grand Master to “exercise any of prerogatives to the injury of another person.”

To determine which Grand Master has the most uncontrolled power is beyond the scope of this Bulletin. In Virginia and the Constitution of Delaware the Grand Master's powers are not defined or limited; in Pennsylvania a Grand Master's edicts become law; in several Jurisdictions in which a Grand Master may suspend not only a Lodge, its Master and officers, but any individual brother, he possesses a potency as tremendous as it is seldom exercised. It is also to be noted that in those Jurisdictions which content themselves with the shortest and broadest constitutional definitions of a Grand Master's powers, the general conduct of Grand Masters has been an exemplary and as wise as in those Grand Jurisdictions in which the Grand Master's powers, prerogatives, rights and privileges are written in minute detail. All Grand Jurisdictions regard the Grand Master as the ruler of the whole Craft, as well as the Grand Lodge; a Lodge or a brother who questions the authority of a Grand Master is so infrequent as to be remarked. Lodging great power in the hands of the Grand Master seems to grow occupants of the Grand East who measure up to their tremendous responsibilities. Few, indeed, are they who do not take competent advice on all matters of importance before acting; very few are the Grand Masters who rule in an autocratic manner. Other organizations find it essential to fence presiding officers with rules, laws, inhibitions, reviews, checks, balances - making them more servants than masters. In Grand Lodges the Grand Master is to all intents and purposes as much "master" as is the Worshipful Master of his Lodge "master" in that organization. All of which is a fine tribute not only to the sterling men who work their slow way up to the Grand East, but to the gentle teachings of Freemasonry, which has so much more of "thou shalt" than "thou shalt not" in their philosophy.

HIRAM ABIF

by: Unknown

The word "Abif " (sometimes written "Abif. " but far less often than with the single "F ") has in one way or another caused considerable controversy among both Biblical and Masonic scholars.

Those who are familiar with Hebrew speak learnedly of its derivation from Abi or Abiw or abiv - the consonants W and V being approximations, apparently, of a Hebrew sound not easily rendered in English letters. Our familiar King James Bible translates the word two ways "Hiram my father's " and "Hiram his father " which in itself has led to some confusion as to whether our Hiram Abif was the only Hiram or the father of another. Scholars, however, are fairly well agreed that "my father " as a translation of "Abif " is correct if the words be understood as a title of honor. Hiram the Widow's Son was "father " in the same sense that priests of the church are so known; the same variety of father that was Abraham to the tribes of Israel.

Abif, then, is a title of respect and veneration, rather than a genealogical term. Just when the legend of Hiram Abif came into our symbolism is a study by itself of which only a few bare facts can here be included. Common understanding believes that Hiram Abif has always been in our system, and descended to us from the days of Solomon. But critical scholarship will have none of "common understanding " and demands proof; names, dates, places, documents before setting a date to any happening.

Our oldest Masonic manuscript (Regius Poem, dated approximately 1390) traces Masonry not to Solomon but to Nimrod and Euclid, in a still earlier time. In this is no mention of Hiram Abif. The Dowland manuscript, dated about 1550, mentions him but only as one of many.

Not until The King James version of the Bible appeared (1611) do we find Hiram Abif known as such with any degree of familiarity. Yet here a curious fact it to be found; sometime after the new Bible made its appearance - late in the sixteen hundreds, when the King James version had become well known - interest in King Solomon's Temple was so keen that many models were made and exhibited and handbooks about it printed and distributed. Such specific interest in this particular building from the then new book may easily have come from the familiarity of Operative and some Speculative

Masons with the Temple symbolism and, by inference, with Hiram Abif. Anderson's explanatory footnote of Hiram Abif in his Constitutions (1732) is as follows (spelling and capitalization modernized, and Hebrew letters omitted):

"We read (2 Chron. ii, 13) Hiram, King of Tyre (called there Hiram), in his letter to King Solomon, says, I have met a cunning man, le hiram Abi not to be translated according to the vulgar Greek and Latin, Hiram my Father, as if this architect was King Hiram's father; for his description, ver. 14, refutes it, and the original plainly imports, Hiram of my Father's, viz, the Chief Master Mason of my Father, King Abibalus; (who enlarged and beautified the city of Tyre, as ancient histories inform us, whereby the Tyrians at this time were most expert in Masonry) though some think Hiram the King might call Hiram the architect father, as learned and skillful men were wont to be called of old times, or as Joseph was called the father of Pharaoh; and as the same Hiram is called Solomon's father, (2 Chron. iv, 16) where 'tis said: Shelomoh lammelech Abhif Churam ghmasah. Did Hiram, his father, make to King Solomon. But the difficulty is over at once, by allowing the Abif to be the surname of Hiram the Mason, called also (Chap. ii, 13) Hiram Abi, as here Hiram Abif; for being so amply described (Chap. ii, 14) we may easily suppose his surname would not be concealed: And this reading makes the sense plain and complete, viz., that Hiram, King of Tyre, sent to King Solomon his namesake Hiram Abif, the prince of architects, decried (1 Kings vii, 14) to be a widow's son of the Tribe of Naphtali; and in (2 Chron. ii, 14) the said King of Tyre calls him the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan; and in both places, that his father was a man of Tyre, which difficulty is removed, by supposing his mother was either of the Tribe of Dan, or of the daughters of the city called Dan in the Tribe of Naphtali, and his deceased father had been a Naphthalize, whence his mother was called a widow of Naphtali; for his father is not called a Tyrian by descent, but his a man of Tyre by habitation; as Obed Edom the Levite is called Gittite, by living among the Gitties, and the Apostle Paul a man of Tarsus. But supposing a mistake in transcribers, and that his father was really a Tyrian by blood and his mother only of the Tribe either of Dan or of Naphtali, that can be no bar against allowing of his vast capacity, for as his father was a worker in brass, so he himself was filled with wisdom and understanding, and cunning to work all works in brass; and as King Solomon sent for him, so King Hiram, in his letter to Solomon, says: And now I have sent a cunning man, endued with understanding, skillful to work in Gold, silver, brass, iron, stone, timber, purple, blue, fine linen and

crimson; also to grave any manner of graving, and to find out every device which shall be put to him with thy cunning men, and with the cunning men of My Lord David thy father. This divinely inspired workman maintained this character in erecting the Temple, and in working the utensils thereof, far beyond the performances of Aholiab and Bezaleel, being so universally capable of all sorts of Masonry. "

In First Kings we read: "And King Solomon sent and fetched Hiram out of Tyre. He was a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in brass; and he was filled with wisdom and understanding and

cunning to work all kinds of brass. And he came to King Solomon and wrought all his work. " In Second Chronicles Hiram, King of Tyre, is made to say:

"And now I have sent a cunning man, endued with understanding, Hiram my father's, the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan, and his father was a man of Tyre, skillful to work in gold and silver, in brass. iron, in stone and in timber, in purple and blue and fine linen, and in crimson, and to find out every device which shall be put to him, with thy cunning men, and with the cunning men of David, thy father. "

Alas for those who would believe in the literal truth of the Legend if they could find but a single word to hang to; the end of the story of Hiram Abif is short and calm, not great or tragic. The Chronicler says " "And Hiram finished the work that he was to make for King Solomon for the house of God " and the writer of Kings is no less brief: "So Hiram made an end of doing all the work that he made King Solomon for the house of the Lord. "

This is not the place to speculate upon the formation of "The Master's Part " into our Third Degree - critical scholarship does not believe our ceremony was cast into anything like its present form prior to 1725 at the earliest. But Anderson would not have devoted so much attention to Hiram Abif without some good reason; it seems obvious that "in some form, " the story of Hiram Abif was of importance in 1723, and by inference, in the Lodges which formed the Grand Lodge which led to the writing of the Constitutions. Facts are stubborn and frequently run counter to our desires. We would like to believe in the verity of the legends which cluster around Hiram Abif, but we actually know very little about him. In addition to six Biblical references, Josephus quotes Menander and Duis in reference to him

two or three times, and refers independently as many more . . . and that is all; not very much on which to build our belief in his character, his greatness, his towering moral and spiritual entity.

On the other hand, it is perfectly possible to envisage any historic character at least in large outline by careful analogy with other contemporary characters, by reference to his time, his civilization, his opportunity, his work. Suppose that all we knew of George Washington was that he was General In Chief of the Revolutionary Army, lived at Mount Vernon, and was the first President of the United States. Much might be read of him merely from these three facts. Thirteen colonies, engaged in a struggle to the death for freedom, would not choose for a leader a man without experience in military affairs. The fact that the Revolution succeeded would tell us that his leadership must have been superb. That he was made First President of the new Republic would indicate with certainty that he had the confidence of the people as a soldier, a man, a leader, and consequently possessed a character to be admired and revered, otherwise he would not be so chose. Merely to look at Mount Vernon is to see a lover of beauty, a man of taste and education, one who loved the earth and its products; the great house speaks with emphasis of hospitality. Much more might be read of Washington from only these three facts, but enough has been said to show the process by which we may envisage something of Hiram Abif, even with only meager data.

Sacred history teaches much of the time of Solomon; of his queen, the daughter of Egypt; of Hiram, King of Tyre; of Adoniram, the tax collector; of officers Solomon set over various districts. We have a regal picture of Solomon's court, and lengthy and minute description of the Temple.

The chief builder, architect, master workman, give him what title you will, could hardly have mixed in such company, directed the greatest work in Israel's history, been received by Solomon from Hiram King of Tyre as the best he had to offer, and not been a man of parts, ability, skill, learning, culture. To think of him only as one "cunning to work all kinds of brass, " in other words, only as an artisan, is completely to misunderstand the too few words in Chronicles and Kings. Rather let us put our belief in the statement that Hiram Abif was "filled with wisdom and understanding " and recall

Solomon's many words of admiration for wisdom; he must have been a wise man indeed into whose charge Solomon the Wise was content to give his most ambitious undertaking. It is commonplace that genius is eccentric; those touched with the divine fire are often "different " from men of

more common clay. So, it is not surprising that one legend tells of intense loyalty, of firmness and fortitude under duress, reading into these characteristics an exalted and elevated character, quite in keeping with the architect and builder of the Temple.

The distinction between architect and builder is often hazy - it should be acute. Our ritual speaks of Hiram Abif as one "who by his great skill in the arts and sciences was so effectually enabled to beautify and adorn the Temple, " which seems to make him a mere adorer! Anything wholly fitted to its use becomes beautiful because of unity and completeness, yet it is also true that what is also useful as a building is not necessarily beautiful to the eye. Any square box of a house gives as secure a shelter as one beautiful in proportion. But complete beauty of building comes when the utility is combined with an appeal to sense and soul.

The Temple built by Hiram Abif was no mere shelter; it was the expression of Israel's love of God. To consider Hiram Abif as a mere decorator, beautifier, ornamentor is to deny the very thing for which he lived and - in the legend - gave his life.

Architect he was, in all that the best sense of the word implies; builder he was, in that he carried out his own plans. Of his physical being we have no details. The probability is that he stood about five feet six inches in height, was bearded, swarthy in countenance, had dark eyes, his hair likely long and curly, his shoulders broad - these were the characteristics of his people. Doubtless he was married and a father when he built the Temple. The men of the Twelve Tribes married early; an unmarried man was almost unknown, so be it he was not a cripple, maimed or diseased. Hiram Abif would have a reasonable amount of wealth; the chief workman which Hiram, King of Tyre, sent to King Solomon who "wrought all his work " would be no tyro, amateur or beginner; but a man famed for his art and science and craftsmanship, and thus, one who had already won fame and fortune before he was given this, the greatest task ever laid on the shoulders of a man of the time of Solomon.

Undoubtedly, he was regarded with awe and veneration by those workmen over whom he came to rule while building the Temple, and all their families and connections, because of his ability as a great artist.

Tribes which but a short time back had been tent-dwelling nomads, whose art was small and whose handiwork was of the crudest, must have

looked at one as skilled as Hiram Abif as at a magician, a miracle man, one equal to the very High

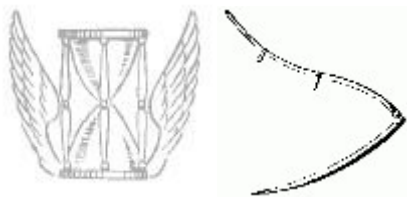
Priest himself. No wonder they called him Abif, "my father! "

Hiram Abif must have been, at least in private, treated by Solomon as a familiar friend, as much an equal as was possible for an Eastern Potentate of absolute power and authority. Consultations would be daily in the building of the Temple. Hiram Abif would be received as an honored guest at Solomon's table. If in public the Architect treated his lord and master with the profound respect which such as Solomon have always exacted from subjects high and low, it is probable that such asteroids were relaxed in private, so that there is nothing incongruous in our legendary picture of Solomon, King of Israel, Hiram, King of Trye, and Hiram Abif, acting together in concert as co-rulers - "our first three most excellent Grand Masters " - in governing the workmen and erecting the mighty structure which engaged their attention for seven years. It is easy to say this verbal picture is but a flight of fancy. It is less easy to draw a less attractive one in its place and make it appear true. While we know Chronicles and Kings and a few other ancient accounts almost nothing of the architect, we do - thanks to patient scholarship, much digging in the earth, and a reading of the literature of all times - know much of the people of Israel, how they worked and ate and lived and loved and labored. After all, it is less important that our mental picture of the illustrious Tyrian be absolutely accurate in small detail than that we keep a true image of a venerated character in our hearts. The color of his eyes and hair matter little; the hue of his conscience, everything. We are told of his knowledge of art and building, of brass and stone, of carving and sculpture - knowing other great artists who have devoted their lives to the creation of the beautiful, it is with some assurance that we liken Hiram Abif's character to the average of great workmen who have labored to produce beauty before the eyes of Him they worshipped.

Legendary though our story of Hiram is, and must ever be, our conception of the Architect can continue to be an inspiring fact, and we are the better men and Masons that it is such a man as this we are taught to represent.

HOURGLASS AND SCYTHE

by: Unknown



In nearly all Masonic rituals in the United States, these two emblems of the third degree are explained in practically the form given by Thomas Smith Webb:

“The Hour-Glass is an emblem of human life; behold! how swiftly the sands run, and how rapidly our lives are drawing to a close. We cannot, without astonishment, behold the little particles which are contained in this machine, how they pass away almost imperceptibly, and yet to our surprise, in the short space of an hour, they are all exhausted. Thus wastes man! today, he puts forth the tender leaves of hope; tomorrow, blossoms and bears his blushing honors which upon him; the next day comes a frost, which nips the shoot, and when he thinks his greatness is still aspiring, he falls, like autumn leaves, to enrich our mother earth.

“The Scythe is an emblem of time, which cuts the brittle thread of life and launches us into eternity. Behold, what havoc the scythe of time makes amongst the human race; if by chance we should escape the numerous evils incident to childhood and youth, and with that health and vigor arrive to the years of manhood, yet withall we must soon be cut down by the all-devouring scythe of time, and be gathered into the land where our fathers are gone before us.

Both these emblems seems to be inventions of the ingenious and resourceful American who left do tremendous an imprint upon our ceremonies. MacKensie, the English Masonic encyclopedist, says of the hourglass: “Used in the third degree by Webb - but not essential nor authorized in any way.

Of the scythe, he says: “Since the time of Webb, the scythe has been adopted in the American system of Freemasonry, as an emblem of the power of time in destroying the institutions of mankind. In England it is no regarded as of any typical meaning.”

Woodford, in Kenning’s Encyclopedia, says: “Hourglass - Said by some to be a Masonic symbol, Oliver inter alios, as an emblem of human life; but in our opinion, not strictly speaking so. Woodford does not mention the scythe.

Mackey, (Clegg revised edition) b credits the hourglass to Webb and states: "As a Masonic symbol it is of comparatively modern date." The familiar illustrations of these emblems, shown on many if not most Lodge charts, and in that collection of monstrosities which commercial companies have sold to confiding Lodges on lantern slides to illustrate the lectures, are based on the Doolittle pictures in the "True Masonic Chart" of Jeremy Cross.

Here the scythe appears in the drawing of the marble monument, held under the arm of the very chubby Father Time, who is provided with a most substantial pair of wings. It also appears as a separate illustration for the "scythe of time." In the same quaint work, the hourglass is illustrated with a pair of open wings.

If young in Freemasonry, both scythe and hourglass are very old. Old Testament days knew the sickle; ancient Egypt had reaping knives. Just when the knife or sickle was curved into the familiar two-handed tool with the crooked handle is less important than that it was early associated with a symbolic meaning, as an instrument for the reaping of humanity, the cutting off of life. Revelation 14-14 to 20 inclusive, is illustrative:

"And I looked, and behold a white cloud, and upon the cloud one sat like unto the Son of man, having on his head a golden crown, and in his hand a sharp sickle. And another angel came out of the temple, crying with a loud voice to him that sat on the cloud, Thrust in thy sickle, and reap; for the time is come for thee to reap; for the harvest of the earth is ripe. And he that sat on the cloud thrust in his sickle on the earth; and the earth was reaped. And another angel came out of the temple, which is in heaven, he also having a sharp sickle. And another angel came out from the altar, which had power over fire; and cried with a loud cry to him that had the sharp sickle, saying;

Thrust thy sickle, and gather the clusters of the vine of the earth; for her grapes are fully ripe. And the angle thrust in his sickle into the earth, and gathered the vine of the earth, and cast it into the great winepress of the wrath of God. And the winepress was trodden without the city, and blood came out of the winepress, even unto the horse bridles, by the space of a thousand and six hundred furlongs."

Ancient Greece and Rome knew three cruel fates; Clotho, Lachesis and Atropos. Clotho held the distaff from which the thread of life was spun by Lachesis, while Atropos wielded the shears and cut the thread when life was

ended. They were deemed cruel because neither she who held the staff of life, she who spun the thread nor she who cut it, regarded the wishes of any man.

In the Sublime Degree Freemasons hear a beautiful prayer, taken almost wholly from the Book of Job (14, to 14 inclusive). Just why the fathers of the ritual thought they could improve upon Job, and left out here a verse, thee substituted a word, is a sealed mystery. The phrases of the King James version seem intimately connected with the ritual of our hourglass and scythe of time:

Man that is born of a woman is of a few days and full of trouble. He cometh forth like a flower, and is cut; he fleeth also as a shadow, and continueth not. And dost thou open thine eyes upon such a one, and bringest me unto judgment with thee? Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? not one. Seeing his days are determined, the number of his months are with thee, thou hast appointed his bounds that he cannot pass; turn from him, that he may rest, till he shall accomplish, as an hireling, his day. For there is hope of a tree, if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branch thereof will not cease. Though the root thereof wax old in the earth, and the stock thereof die in the ground; Yet through the scent of water it will bud, and bring boughs like a plant. But man dieth, and wasteth away; yea, man giveth up the ghost, and where is he? As the Waters fail from the sea, and the flood decayeth and drieth up; so, man lieth down and riseth not; till the heavens be no more, they shall not awake, nor be raised out of their sleep. O that thou wouldest keep me secret, until thy wrath be past, that thou wouldest appoint me a set time and remember me! If a man die, shall he live again? All the days of my appointed time will I wait, till my change come."

"If a man die, shall he live again?" Job's cry of despair has rung down the centuries; it is one of Freemasonry's glories that her answer is as ringing! Her tragedy ends in hope; her assurances of immortality are positive. Ritual of hourglass and scythe, if read alone, is gloomy and disheartening, but not as parts of a whole which end in a certainty of immortality. Measurement of time has demanded the attention of learned men in all ages. Our modern clocks, watches and chronometers have a long and intricate history, and many ancestors quite unlike their descendants; among them the sun dial and hourglass. Just how old the instrument is which measures time by the slow dropping of liquid or running sand is not easily stated; ancient Egypt knew a water clock and Plato is said to have invented the "Clepsydra," in water drips from container to container, marking the passing of hours. The substitution

of sand for water must have occurred early, sand having the great advantage that it runs more slowly than water and does not evaporate in the process. The sealed semi-vacuum double bulbs of more modern days were then, of course, unknown.

Nor can the earliest symbolic relationship between the passage of hours and days and man's life both here and hereafter be stated; the connection between time and life is so intimate that it is difficult to believe that ideas of duration as a factor of life, as well as a practical matter of eating, sleeping, etc., did not arise coincidentally.

Both old and New Testaments have this poetry; Isaiah 38-10: "I said in the cutting off of my days, I shall go to the gates of the grave: I am deprived of the residue of my years." and John 5-25:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you; The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live."

The brethren who built upon the simple esoteric work of operative Lodges the magnificent system of philosophy, life and morals which is our Freemasonry, wrought with the viewpoint of their times. Yet the abiding spirit of the ritual is a reality, otherwise it would not have lived in men's hearts and worked its gentle miracles for so long a period. Apparently taking some somber pleasure from dwelling on mortality, decay, the evening of life, old age and death; these early Masonic ritualists nevertheless builded well when they endeavored to impress upon all brethren the vital importance of time. Indeed, time is so intimately interwoven in the degrees of Freemasonry (see Short Talk Bulletin, January, 1928) that it very obviously has a symbolic as well as moral significance.

Shakespeare wrote of "the inaudible and noiseless foot of time," and "time the nurser and breeder of all good." Richter denominated time "the chrysalis of eternity;" Franklin called it "the herb that cures all diseases." Tusser said: "Time tries the truth in everything," echoing Cicero's "Time is the herald of truth." Paine dug the meat from this nut in writing "Time makes more converts than reason." Freemasonry's ritual deals with time in a strictly limited sense; we speak of a definite number of years the temple was in building; of the days the Master was buried; of the scythe of time, which cuts the brittle thread of life; of the hour glass which marks the passing of life. But in the symbolic sense Freemasonry makes of time a vast conception, allied with the very fundamentals of God and the hereafter. Her whole teaching is of

the preparation for another and better life by a substantial and an honorable living of this one. Freemasonry makes a very clear distinction between everyday time, which all men share; - eight hours for labor, eight hours for God and a worthy brother, and eight hours for refreshment and sleep - and the time his immortal part must spend in the hereafter.

The scythe of time “cuts the brittle thread of life and launches us into eternity.” The immortal part of man “never, never, never, dies.” “Time, patience and perseverance will accomplish all things.” “Through the valley of the shadow of death, he may finally arise from the tomb of transgression to shine as the stars, forever and ever.”

Quotations might be multiplied; they will occur to all whom the ritual is familiar. Lucky the Master Mason who has grasped the deeper meanings of the hour glass and the scythe, and comforted is he who see behind their gloomy outlook a gleam of light; “In the night of death hope sees a star and love can hear the flutter of an angel’s wing,” as the great agnostic phrased it.”

The timelessness of time is a hard conception; that eternity has neither beginning nor ending is beyond the mental grasp even of great philosophers. Let a poet bring the unbringable within reach:

DURATION

Aweary of the endless days, my lot I wept
That life and love, too long, should pass so slow.
Some Power my eyelids touched, so that I slept
And stood upon a star. I saw below,
Alone in space, our tiny earthly sphere;
Its continents but islands in the deep;
Its tempest but a breeze; its mountains sheer,
 Low hill; its oceans only ponds, asleep.
The northern ice revolved about a stone,
A mighty boulder, grim and great and high;
An hundred miles it stretched its length, moss-grown;
An hundred miles it towered to the sky
So rapid spun the giant pigmy world
Years sped as seconds. By some mighty Law
Ten centuries in empty space were hurled
As I drew breath. A little bird I saw
Which rubbed its beak against the rock. “See, there
He sharpens it, “ a Voice said in my ear,

“Once every thousand years.” I watched
it wear the granite down until a
pole was clear.

When that gigantic task, by one
small bird In cycles of a
thousand years. at last Was
done again the Silent Voice I
heard: “But one day of
Eternity has passed!” I woke;
so much to do before day’s
end!

I heard the call to labor as a chime,
A song of instants I have yet to spend;
“Not life nor love is long, but only time!”

THE LEGEND OF THE LOST WORD

by: Unknown

The observation has been made that language is a growth; every word had to be created by man. Back of every word is some want or necessity of mind or body and the genius to make expression in some sign or sound that we call a word. "Some words are rough and rugged like the skins of wild beasts, other glitter and glisten like satin and gold. Words have been born of hatred and revenge, of love and sacrifice, of hope and fear, of agony and joy. In them mingle the darkness and the dawn. They are the garments of thought, the robes of reason, the shadows of the past, the reflection of the present and the crystallization of human history."

It has been said that the egocentric instinct in man has made "self-preservation the first law of nature," that growing out of or alongside of it is the gregarious instinct which has produced social governments and philanthropic enterprises. Deeper than these instincts there is in man a consciousness, however dim, in explicable forces and agencies, and an urge to realize their potency. In the childhood of the race this occasioned the thought of supernatural power in a word.

The word that causes the heavens on high to tremble, the word that makes the world below to quake.

Constitute the first two lines of a Babylonian hymn inscribed upon a clay tablet five thousand years ago, in which the wise priesthood of a great religion sang praises to the might and power of a word. Some Masonic writers have held that A U M, pronounced "oom," is the oldest omnific name of God in the world; that it came out of India, and that it has also been spelled A O M, but pronounced the same way. Frank C. Higgins has written a book on his name as the "Lost Word," and claims it is concealed in the terminal letters of the names of the three ruffians. To the best of my knowledge this concealment has not been satisfactorily explained.

In my opinion, Freemasonry is largely indebted to the Hebrews for the legend of The Lost Word. Shakespeare says, "What's in a name?" The Jews saw in a name "a sign standing for the personality, the achievements, the reputation, the character, the power and the glory of the one who wore it." Joseph meant "increaser," Moses meant "drawn out of water," Israel meant

"Prince of God." At the burning bush the ineffable name of God Almighty was communicated to Moses; so overwhelming was its glory that the people pronounced it in whispers.

The third commandment of the Decalogue, delivered from Mount Sinai, declared, "Thou Shalt not take the name of the Lord, thy God in vain." The priestly rule contained in Leviticus reads, "He that pronounceth the name of the Lord distinctly shall be put to death." At last only the high priest was permitted to utter the name, and that but once a year. On the day of atonement, and in the holy of holies, its utterance was accompanied by the beating of cymbals and the blowing of trumpets, so as to completely extinguish the sound of the human voice. Such were "the wrappings of secrecy and sanctity which the Jews threw about the name of God."

As they used no vowels in writing, all that was ever seen were four consonants, J H V H, the Tetragrammation or four lettered name of God which we call Jehovah. From the letters there was no clue to the pronunciation. No one could understand them any more than we could know that Mr. stands for Mister and Dr. stands for Doctor unless someone told us so.

According to tradition, the great catastrophe of the Babylonian captivity was that, through the death of the high priest without a successor, the name was lost. "At the end of that captivity priests and scribes began a search for the lost name which has continued without avail for two and one-half millenniums." The four consonants they had, but it is doubtful if anyone has been able to supply the sound of the vowels. It is believed that this four-lettered name of God is the Lost Word of Masonry today.

Like everything else in our science, it is a symbol.

It is the consummation of all Masonic symbolism because it stands for the Divine truth. Brotherly love and relief are but the means to an end; the final design of our Institution is its third principle tenet, the imperial truth. In some aspects truth seems relative, because it is not complete, but only partial. Now we see through a glass darkly, but the ultimates of truth are immutable and eternal, the Fatherhood of God and the immortality of the soul, "Down to this deep foundation Masonry digs for a basis of its Temple and finds an everlasting rock."

Dr. Joseph Fort Newton says:

"Freemasonry makes no argument, but presents a picture, the oldest, if not the greatest, drama in the world, the better to make men feel those truths which no mortal words can utter. It shows us the tragedy of life in its blackest hour, the forces of evil, cunning, yet stupid, which come up against the soul, tempting it to treachery, a tragedy which, in its simplicity and power, makes the heart ache and stand still. Then out of the thick darkness there rises, like a beautiful white star, that in man which is most akin to God, his love of truth, his devotion to duty, his willingness to go down into the night of death, if only virtue may survive and throb like a pulse of fire in the evening sky."

"Here is the ultimate and final witness of our Divinity and immortality, the sublime, death-defying moral heroism of the human soul." Translated into personal terms it is the Apostle Peter at his execution asking to be crucified head downward. It is the Spartan Leonidas at the Pass of Thermopylae, with a handful of men holding back the hordes of Persia and spelling out the salvation of the Greek Republic. It is the Swiss, Arnold von Winkelried, receiving the points of Austrian spears into his own breast and making his dead body a bridge of victory for his countrymen. It is the American, Nathan Hale, grieving that he had but one life to give, but one supreme sacrifice to make at the altar of our National Liberty. It is our operative Grand Master, the Tyrian Builder before the brute forces of death and destruction, surrendering his life but preserving his integrity.

Brother H.L. Haywood says: "The search for a lost word is not a search for a mere vocable of a few letters which one might write down on a piece of paper, it is the search for a truth." It is a quest for the highest possible life in the spiritual unfoldment of humanity; it is the seeking after the name, the power and the glory of God.

The purpose is the same whether this age-old legend of the quest be woven into a tragic tale like Eugene Sue's "Wandering Jew," or thrown about a mystic drama like Maurice Maeterlinck's "Blue Bird," or crystallized in an epic poem like James Russell Lowell's "Vision of Sir Launfal," whether it be a missing chord of music, the vacancy of a sanctuary, a design left unfinished by the death of the Master Builder, or the Lost Word in Masonry to be recovered through patience, perseverance and time. It always symbolizes a search for something good and beautiful and true.

At times of meditation and introspection there is something vaguely haunting in the Legend of The Lost Word; like the fleeting fragrance of a forest flower experienced in the past, the murmured music of a rippling brook heard

in childhood, the purple sheen of twilight on a distant hilltop, or some exquisite dream of infinite love in the long ago; forgotten, but trembling at the doorway of memory.

This quest is the central thought of Henry van Dyke's "The Other Wise Man," an inspirational story of beauty and charm, which tells of the days when Augustus Caesar was the master of many Kings and Herod reigned in Jerusalem.

Artaban, the Median, the fourth wise man; studied the constellations and certain prophecies of Zoroaster, Balaam and Daniel. Inspired by the appearance of a star in the sky, he sold his possessions and bought three gems; a sapphire, a ruby and a pearl; to bear as tribute to a new-born King. The other three wise men were to wait for him at the ancient temple of the seven Spheres. Because he tarried in a palm grove outside the walls of Babylon to minister to a Parthian Jew in the ravages of a fever, he did not reach the appointed place in time, and found a note which said, "We have waited past the midnight hour and can delay no longer. We go to find the King. Follow us across the desert." This meant that Artaban must sell his sapphire to buy camels and provisions for the journey. A ministry of mercy cost him the first jewel.

The third day after the wise men had laid at the feet of a child in a manger their gifts of gold, frankincense and myrrh, Artaban entered Bethlehem, weary but full of hope, bearing his Ruby and his Pearl. The streets were deserted, but from an open door of a low stone cottage he heard a woman's voice singing softly. He entered and found a young mother hushing her baby to sleep. She told him of the strangers from the east who had appeared and gone, that the man from Nazareth had taken the babe and its mother and fled away to Egypt. She placed food before him, the plain fare of humble peasants. The baby slumbered, as great peace filled the quiet room; but suddenly there came the noise of wild confusion in the street, the shrieking and wailing of women's voices crying: "The Soldiers of Herod! They are killing our children."

The mother's face grew white with terror, she huddled with her child in a dark corner of the room. Artaban's form filled all the doorway, and looking straight at the Captain he said: "I am alone in this place and am waiting to give this jewel to the prudent Captain who will leave me in peace." He showed the Ruby glistening like a great drop of blood in the palm of his hand.

The lines of greed tightened hard around the Captain's lips. He took the Ruby in his fingers and gave the order:

"March on, there is no child here, this house is still." Artaban turned his face to the East and prayed, "God of Truth, forgive my sin, I have said that which is not to save the life of a child." The voice of the woman said, very gently, "Because thou hast saved the life of my little one, may the Lord Bless thee and keep thee, lift up the light of His Countenance upon thee and give thee peace." Thus, he parted with his second jewel.

Down in Egypt Artaban found faint traces here and there of the holy family. Though he found none to worship, he found many to help. He fed the hungry, clothed the naked, healed the sick and comforted the captive. His years moved swiftly by; after thirty-three had gone, in his old age an irresistible impulse came upon him to go up again to Jerusalem. He had his Pearl and was looking for the King.

It was the season of the Passover when he reached the city. There was great excitement; multitudes were being swept as by a secret tide toward the Damascus Gate. He joined the throng and inquired the cause of the tumult and where they were going. "We are going," they answered, "Outside the city walls to a place called Golgotha where Jesus of Nazareth, the King of the Jews, is to be crucified."

How strangely the words fell on the tired heart of Artaban. At last he was to see the King and he still had his Pearl, in time, perhaps to offer it as ransom. A troop of Macedonian soldiers came down the street dragging a young girl into bondage and slavery for debts of her father who had died. Being of Artaban's country, she recognized the sign of the Priesthood, the Winged circle of Gold which he wore. Tearing away from the soldiers and throwing herself at his feet, she prayed, "Have pity upon me, save me from a fate that is worse than death."

Artaban trembled as a conflict entered his soul. It was the old conflict which had come to him in the Palm grove and again in the Stone cottage; the conflict between expectations of faith and the impulses of love. In the darkness of his mind it seemed clear that the inevitable comes from God. He took the Pearl from his bosom and placed it in the slave girl's hand, saying, "This is thy ransom. It is the last of my jewels which I kept for the King."

As he spoke the sky darkened, the earth quaked, the houses rocked, a heavy tile shaken from a roof fell and struck the old man on the temple. He lay breathless and pale.

As she bent over him there came a voice through the twilight, small and still, like music sounding from a distance. The old man's lips began to move; she heard him say, "Not so my Lord, for when I saw I Thee hungered and fed Thee, or thirsty and gave Thee to drink? Thirty and three years have I sought Thee, but I have never seen Thy face nor ministered to Thee, my King." Again, the maid heard the sweet voice, faintly, as from afar, but now it seemed as though she understood the words. "Verily I say unto thee, inasmuch as thou hast done unto one of the least of these my brethren, thou hast done it unto me."

At the end of the journey, in the presence of human need, in the expression of human sympathy, in the rendering of human service, he came face to face with his King and discovered his Lost Word. He heard a Divine voice saying, "Inasmuch" and "Well done, good and faithful servant."

The Lost Word symbolizes the kind of truth that cannot be acquired from reading books, that cannot be obtained by paying so much money and listening to so many college lectures. It symbolizes a truth that must be wrought out through the vicissitudes of life in personal experience.

If the Word stands for the personality, the attributes, the power and the glory of God, we must be satisfied with a substitute, because human life and ages of time are too short for a complete revelation of that high and holy name.

The whole design of Masonic science is a quest for the truth. "Divine truth is symbolized by the Logos, the Word, the Name." Through this symbol all the other symbols of Masonry guide a man onward and upward to God.

Over the hills to a valley of endless years,
Over roads of woe to a land without a tear,
Up from the haunts of men to the place
where angels are, This is the march of
morality, to a wonderful goal afar.

SO MOTE IT BE

LODGE AND GRAND LODGE ORGANIZATION

by: Unknown

To become a Freemason of his own free will and without solicitation, a man makes a written application, which is duly endorsed or recommended by brethren of the lodge to which he applies. His application is laid before the lodge for acceptance, or rejection. If accepted, the Worshipful Master appoints a committee, the duty of which is to satisfy itself of the applicant's fitness to be a Mason. After a certain period of time (usually a month), the report of the committee is read to the lodge, and a ballot taken on the application. A unanimously favorable ballot elects the applicant to receive the degrees, or, in some Jurisdictions, just the First Degree. He is initiated into the First or Entered Apprentice Degree, attains a suitable proficiency in the esoteric work, waits a month or more, is Passed to the Second or Fellowcraft Degree, again attains a suitable proficiency in its works, waits another month or so, and finally is Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason.

Before any of these steps can be taken, there must be what is called in some Jurisdictions a "just, perfect and regular lodge," in others a "just and regularly constituted lodge," to which the petitions can be made, and in which the degrees may be conferred.

Before such a lodge can come into existence, there must be a Grand Lodge, or governing body of all private, the particular, or the subordinate lodges (they are called by all three names in different places) to give a Warrant of Constitution, or Charter, to certain brethren, empowering them to work and to be a Masonic Lodge. The age-old question which has plagued philosophers; did the first hen lay the first egg, or did the first egg hatch into the first hen; may seem to apply here, since before there can be a Grand Lodge, there must be two or more private lodges to form it! But this Bulletin is written of conditions as they exist in the United States today - and indeed, in almost all the civilized world - and not of the historical conditions which pertained in 1717 when the four lodges in London formed the first grand Lodge!

Today no regularly constituted lodge can come into existence without the consent of an existing Grand Lodge. It is certain that other Grand Lodges

will be formed in the future, but they probably will not be many. Let us suppose that Commander Byrd should discover a habitable continent at the South Pole. This continent slowly fills up with adventurers, travelers and pioneers. Some of them will be Masons. They then ask the consent of some Grand Lodge permission to form a lodge Massachusetts, for instance, has five lodges in China.

Some English Brethren, let us suppose, receive a Charter for a lodge in Antarctica from the Mother Grand Lodge of England. Perhaps the Grand Lodge of Texas Charters another lodge in "Byrdland." After a while these lodges unite to form their own Grand Lodge; the Grand Lodges which have Chartered them relinquish jurisdiction, and a new Grand Lodge is born. But most civilized countries now do have Grand Lodges; the great formative period of Grand Lodges - the Eighteenth and Nineteenth Centuries - is practically over. Therefore we may consider that most of our hens are grown up and laying, and that the vast majority of new lodges which are hatched will grow up to be chicks of the mother, and not start out to form other Grand Lodges for themselves! It is not contended that no new Grand Lodges will ever be formed, but only that less will come into being in the future than have in the past.

A Grand Lodge, then, is formed of particular lodges; the Masters, or the Masters and Wardens of which, then represent their lodges in the meetings of the Grand Lodge.

The private or particular lodge usually comes into being when a certain number of brethren, in good standing, will petition a Grand Master to form a lodge. The Grand Master, if it his pleasure, issues a Dispensation to these brethren which forms them into a provisional lodge, or a lodge "Under dispensation." The powers of this Lodge Under Dispensation are strictly limited; it is not yet a "Regularly Constituted Lodge;" but an inchoate sort of organization, a fledgling in the nest. Not until the Grand Lodge has authorized the issuance of the Warrant, or Charter, does it begin to assume the status of a "regular" lodge, and not even then, until the new lodge is consecrated, dedicated and constituted by the Grand Master and his officers, or those delegated for the ceremony. The ceremony, by the way, is one which every Master Mason should make an effort to see, if possible. The Charter of the new lodge will name those who are to be its first Worshipful Master, Senior and Junior Wardens, who will hold office until their successors are duly elected and installed.

The Grand Lodge (consisting of the particular lodges represented by their Masters - in most cases also include the Senior and Junior Wardens, Past Masters; and Past Officers and Past Grand Masters of the Grand Lodge), is the governing body in its Jurisdiction. In the United States, Jurisdictional lines are coincident with the state lines; there are currently forty-nine United State Grand Lodges; the forty-ninth being that of the District of Columbia. Each Grand Lodge is supreme unto itself; its word is Masonic law within its own borders.

Grand Lodges adopt for themselves a Constitution and By-Laws for their own government, just as particular lodges adopt by-laws for their government. These documents are the body of law of the Grand Jurisdiction, which, however, rest upon the Old Charges and the ancient Constitutions (which have descended to us from the first Mother Grand Lodge). The decisions in mooted questions made by Grand Masters, or the Grand Lodge (or both); are usually based on the

Ancient Landmarks, Usages and Customs of the Fraternity.-."

In the interim between meetings of a Grand Lodge, the Grand Master is the Grand Lodge. His powers are arbitrary, absolute and almost unlimited; at least in theory. Most Grand Lodges provide that the acts of the Grand Master may be revised, confirmed or rejected by the Grand Lodge in its meetings; which is, of course, a check against any too radical moves. But, as a matter of fact, a brother rarely becomes a Grand Master without having served a long and arduous apprenticeship. Almost invariably he has been Master of his own lodge, and by years of service and interest in the Grand Lodge has demonstrated his ability and fitness to preside over the grand Lodge. The real check against arbitrary actions of the Grand Master is more in his Masonry than the law, more in his desire to do the right thing than in the legal power compelling him to do so.

Private lodge and Grand Lodge officers arrive at their respective stations either by election or appointment. In some lodges, all officers in the "line" are elective. In other lodges, only the senior officers (Master, Senior and Junior Wardens, Secretary and Treasurer) are elected, all other being appointed by the Master. The same is true of Grand Lodges; for instance, in the District of Columbia all officers are elected. In New Jersey, the Grand Master, Deputy Grand Master, Senior Grand and Junior Grand Wardens, Grand Secretary, Grand Treasurer are elected; all other Line officers are appointed by the Grand Master.

In particular lodges, as a general rule, appointed officers are re-appointed to one station higher each year; the highest appointed officer is then, usually, elected to the lowest elective office. This custom is broken, of course, when incumbents are no longer available, or when the lodge decides, for any reason, not to re-elect an officer. In the normal course of events, in most lodges, both particular and Grand Lodges, election or appointment at the "foot of the line" will eventually lead to the highest office, provided the officer works, is able, willing and demonstrates that he can fill the highest chairs. It is this system which is depended upon to give long experience and years of Masonic knowledge to future Masonic leaders.

The term of office for Masters and Grand Masters is one year; in some Jurisdictions, by custom and not by law, Grand Masters are elected two years in succession and in one he serves three consecutive terms. In some Jurisdictions, also, the "line" is not advanced, but Grand Masters are elected "from the floor." Occasionally the Master of a particular lodge will be elected for a second or third, or even greater number of years, but generally the "line" proceeds to "move up" at the annual elections.

Secretaries and Treasurers generally serve as long as they are willing; a lodge which has a good Secretary and Treasurer almost invariably re-elects the same incumbents year after year, which is also true of Grand Lodges. These officers, then, become the connecting links between different administrations, which makes for stability and smooth running, except in those rare instances in which a Secretary, from long service, comes to believe that "his" lodge and "his" Master should do "his" will, not their own. When the tail thus attempts to wag the dog, the remedy is found in the annual election! In Grand Lodges, decisions are reached in four ways:

"by Viva voce" or rising votes, by a showing of hands, votes by lodges and/or written ballot. The method is usually a matter of constitutional law; ordinary questions are decided by the least cumbersome method; difficult and involved questions by votes of/by lodges; elections and matters of grave import, such as expulsions, are usually by paper (secret) ballot.

The same holds true of the particular lodge; except of course that it cannot "vote by lodges" and that it uses the ball or cube instead of the paper ballot.

In the absence of a Master, the senior Warden presides and has, for the time being, the powers and duties of the Master; in his absence, the same

devolves upon the Junior Warden. Should all three be absent the lodge (1) either cannot be opened at all, or (2) can be opened by a Past Master, or (3) only by the Grand Master, or his Deputy acting in his stead. Which of these three

In these few pages, only the broad outlines of the organization of Lodges and Grand Lodges can be given. But enough has been written to indicate that the simple skeleton of the Fraternity has a complicated and involved body of law and procedure, that there is much to know, and much, therefore, which the individual Mason should make it his business to study.

In these words, we point out the way, and indicate the extent to which his inquiring mind should reach, and if followed they will have been written to a good purpose.

A MASTER'S WAGES

by: Unknown

". . . travel in foreign countries and receive Master's Wages."

Our Operative brethren received their Master's Wages in coin of the realm.

Speculatives content themselves with intangible wages - and occasionally some are hard pressed to explain to the wondering initiate just what, in this practical age, a Master's Wages really are.

The wages of a Master may be classified under two heads; first, those inalienable rights which every Freemason enjoys as a result of fees, initiation and the payment of annual dues to his Lodge; second, those more precious privileges which are his if he will but stretch out his hand to take.

The first right of which any initiate is conscious is that of passing the Tiler and attending his Lodge, instead of being conducted through the West gate as a preliminary step to initiation. For a time, this right of mingling with his new brethren is so engrossing that he looks no further for his Master's Wages. Later he learns that he also has the right of visitation in other Lodges, even though it is a "right" hedged about with restrictions. He must be in good standing to exercise it. It will be denied him should any brother object to his visit. If he is unaffiliated, in most Jurisdictions, he can exercise it but once in any one Lodge. If private business (such as election of officers or a lodge trial, etc.) is scheduled, the Master of the Lodge he would visit may refuse him entrance. But in general this right of visiting other Lodges is a very real part of what may be termed his concrete Master's Wages, and many are the Freemasons who find in it a sure cure for loneliness in strange places; who think of the opportunity to find welcome and friends where otherwise they would be alone, as wages of substantial character.

The opportunities to see and hear the beautiful ceremonies of Freemasonry, to take from them again and again a new thought, are wages not to be lightly received. For him with the open ears and the inquiring mind, the degrees lead to a new world, since familiarity with ritual provides the key by which he may read an endless stream of books about Freemasonry.

The Craft has a glorious history; a symbolism the study of which is endless; a curious legal structure of which law-minded men never tire' is so

interwoven with the story of the nation as to make the thoughtful thrill; joins hands with religion in the secret places of the heart in a manner both tender and touching. These "foreign countries" have neither gate nor guard at the frontier . . . the Master Mason may cross and enter at his will, sure of wages wherever he wanders within their borders.

Master's Wages are paid in acquaintances. Unless a newly-made Master Mason is so shy and retiring that he seeks the farthest corner of his Lodge Room, there to sit and shrink into himself, inevitably he will become acquainted with many men of many minds, always an interesting addition to the joy of life. What he does with his acquaintances is another story, but at least the wages are there, waiting for him.

No honest man insures his house thinking it will burn, but the insurance policy in the safe is a great comfort, well worth all that it costs. It speaks of help should fire destroy his home; it assures that all its owner has saved in material wealth will not be lost should carelessness or accident start a conflagration.

No honest man becomes a Freemason thinking to ask the Craft for relief. Yet the consciousness that poor is the Lodge and sadden the hearts of the brethren thereof from which relief will not be forthcoming if the need is bitter, is wages from which comfort may be taken.

Freemasonry is not, "re se," a relief organization. It does not exist merely for the purpose of dispensing charity. Nor has it great funds with which to work its gentle ministrations to the poor. Fees are modest; dues are often too small rather than too large. Yet, for the brother down and out, who has no coal for the fire, no food for his hungry child, whom sudden disaster threatens, the strong arm of the Fraternity stretches forth to push back the danger. The cold are warmed, the hungry fed, the naked clothed, the jobless given work, the discouraged heartened. Master's Wages, surely far greater than the effort put forth to earn them.

Relief is not limited to a brother's own Lodge. In most Jurisdictions there is a Masonic Home, in which, at long last, a brother's weary body may rest, his tired feet cease their wandering.

No Freemason who has visited any Masonic Home and there seen old brethren and their widows eased down the last long hill in peace and comfort; the children of Masons under friendly influences which insure safe launching of little ships on the sea of life; comes away thankful that there is such a

haven for him, should he need it, even if he hopes never to ask for its aid. Stranded in a strange place, no Freemason worries about getting aid. In all large centers is a Board of Masonic Relief to hear his story, investigate his credentials and start the machinery by which his Lodge may help him. In smaller places is almost invariably a Lodge with brethren glad to give a sympathetic hearing to his troubles. To the brother in difficulty in what to him is a "foreign country," ability to prove himself a Freemason is Master's Wages, indeed. Freemasonry is strong in defense of the helpless. The Widow and the orphan need ask but once to receive bounty. All brethren hope to support their own, provide for their loved ones, but misfortune comes to the just and unjust alike. To be one of a worldwide brotherhood on which widow and child may call is of untold comfort, Master's Wages more precious than the coin of gold.

Finally, is the right of Masonic burial. At home or abroad no Freemason, know to desire it, but is followed to his last home by sorrowing brethren who lay him away under the apron of the Craft and the Sprig of Acacia of immortal hope. This, too, is Wages of a Master.

"Pay the Craft their Wages, if any be due . . ."

To some the practical wages briefly mentioned above are the important payments for a Freemason's work. To others, the more intangible but none the less beloved opportunities to give, rather than get, are the Master's Wages which count them.

Great among these is the Craft's opportunity for service. The world is full of chances to do for others, and no man need apply to a Masonic Lodge only because he wants a chance to "do unto others as he would others do unto him." But Freemasonry offer peculiar opportunities to unusual talents which are not always easily found in the profane world. There is always something to do in a Lodge. There are always committees to be served - and committee work is usually thankless work. He who cannot find his payment in his satisfaction of a task well done will receive no Master's Wages for his labors on Lodge committees.

There are brethren to be taught. Learning all the "work" is a man's task, not to be accomplished in a hurry. Yet it is worth the doing, and in instructing officers and candidates many a Mason has found a quiet joy which is Master's Wages pressed down and running over.

Service leads to the possibility of appointment or election to the line of officers. There is little to speak of the Master's Wages this opportunity pays, because only those who have occupied the Oriental Chair know what they are. The outer evidence of the experience may be told, but the inner spiritual experience is untellable because the words have not been invented.

But Past Masters know! To them is issued a special coinage of Master's Wages which only a Worshipful Master may earn.

Ask any of them if they do not pay well for the labor.

If practical Master's Wages are acquaintances in Lodge, the enjoyment of fellowship, merged into friendship, is the same payment in larger form. Difficult to describe, the sense of being one of a group, the solidarity of the circle which is the Lodge, provides a satisfaction and pleasure impossible to describe as it is clearly to be felt. It is interesting to meet many men of many walks of life; it is heart-warming continually to meet the same group, always with the same feeling of equality. High and low, rich and poor, merchant and money-changer, banker and broom-maker, doctor and ditch-digger all meet on the level, and find it happy - Master's Wages, value untranslatable into money.

Ethereal as a flower scent, dainty as a butterfly's wing, yet to some as strong as any strand of the Mystic Tie all Freemasons know and none describe, is that feeling of being a part of the historic past. To have knelt at the same Altar before which George Washington prayed; to have taken the same obligation which bound our brethren of the Mother Grand Lodge of 1717; to be spiritually kin with Elias Ashmole; to feel friendly with Oliver, Preston, Krause, Goethe, Sir Christopher Wren, Marshall, Anthony Sayer to mention only a few; to be a brother of Craftsmen who formed the Boston Tea Party; to stand at Bunker Hill with Warren and ride with brother Paul Revere; to be an apprentice at the building of St. Paul's; to learn the Knot from a Comacine Master; to follow the Magister in a Roman "Collegium," aye, even to stand awed before those mysteries of ancient peoples, and perhaps see a priest raise the dead body of Osiris from a dead level to a living perpendicular - these are mental experiences not to be forgotten when counting up Master's Wages.

Finally - and best - is the making of many friends.

Thousands of brethren count their nearest and their dearest friends on the rolls of the Lodge they love and serve. The Mystic Tie makes for friendship

It attracts man to man and often draws together "those who might otherwise have remained at a perpetual distance."

The teachings of brotherly love, relief and truth; of temperance, fortitude, prudence and justice; the inculcation of patriotism and love of country, are everyday experiences in a Masonic Lodge. When men speak freely those thoughts which, in the world without, they keep silent, friendships are formed.

Count gain for work well done in what coin seems most valuable; the dearest of the intangibles which come to any Master Mason are those Masonic friendships than which there "are" no greater Master's Wages.

POT OF INCENSE

by: Unknown



Just when the pot of incense became an emblem of the third section of the Sublime Degree cannot be stated with certainty. It is, apparently, an American invention or addition; both McKensie and Kenning say that it is not used in the English work. The Monitor of Thomas Smith Webb, who worked such ingenious and cunning changes in the Prestonian work, gives the commonly accepted wording:

“The Pot of Incense is an emblem of a pure heart; this is always an acceptable sacrifice to the Deity; and as this glows with fervent heat, so should our hearts continually glow with gratitude to the great and beneficent author of our existence for the manifold blessings and comforts we enjoy.”

Jeremy Cross prints it among the delightfully quaint illustrations in the “True Masonic Chart” - illustrations which were from the not altogether uninspired pencil of one Amos Doolittle, of New Haven. However, the Pot of Incense came into American rituals, it is present in nearly all, and in substantially the same form, both pictorially and monetarily. If the incense has no great antiquity in the Masonic system, its use dates from the earliest, and clings to it from later, Biblical times, and in Egypt and India it has an even greater antiquity.

In the very early days, as chronicled in the Bible, incense was associated more with idolatry than with true worship; for instance: Because they have forsaken men and have burned incense unto other Gods, that they might provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; therefore my wrath shall be poured out upon this place, and shall not be quenched. (II Chronicles, 25-34).

To what purpose cometh there to me incense from Sheba, and the sweet cane from a far country? your burnt offerings are not acceptable, nor your sacrifices sweet unto me. (Jeremiah 6-20). Moreover, I will cause to cease in Moab, saith the Lord, him that offereth in the high places, and him that burneth incense to his Gods. (Jeremiah 35-48).

However, when the worship of JHVH (Which we call Jehovah) was thoroughly established, burning incense changed from a heathenish,

idolatrous custom to a great respectability and a place in the Holy of Holies. Leviticus 12-16, 13 sounds this keynote: And he take a censer full of burning coals of fire from off the altar before the Lord, and his hands full of sweet incense beaten small, and bring it within the vail:

And he shall put the incense upon the fire before the Lord, that the cloud of incense may cover the mercy seat that is upon the testimony, that he dieth not. Later, incense was associated with wealth and luxurious living, as in the Song of Solomon:

Who is it that cometh out of the wilderness like pillars of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense, with all the powders of the merchant? (3-6)/

Until the day break, and the shadows flee away, I will get me to the mountain of myrrh, and to the hill of frankincense. (406). Thy lips, O my spouse, drop as the honeycomb: honey and milk are under thy tongue; and the smell of thy garments is like the smell of Lebanon. Spikenard and saffron; calamus and cinnamon, with all trees of frankincense; myrrh and aloes, with all the chief spices. (4-14). In ancient Egypt incense was much used; sculptures and monuments of remote dynasties bear testimony to its popularity. Many a Pharaoh is depicted with censor in one hand, the other casting into it the oastils or osselets of incense. In embalming the Egyptians used all the various gums and spices "except" frankincense, which was set apart and especially consecrated to the worship of the Gods. In India incense has always been a part of the worship of the thousands of Gods and Goddesses of that strange land. Buddhism has continued its use to this day as a part of the ceremonies of worship - as, indeed, have some Christian churches - and in Nepal, Tibet, Ceylon, Burma, China and Japan it is a commonplace in many temples. The list of materials which can be incorporated into incense is very long; the incense of the Bible is of more than one variety, there being a distinction between incense and frankincense , although a casual reading of these two terms in many Biblical references makes them seem to be any sacrificial smoke of a pleasant odor. Ordinarily it was made of various vegetable substances of high pungency; opobalsamum, onycha, galbanum and sometimes pure frankincense also, mixed in equal proportion with some salt. Frankincense, a rare gum, is often coupled with myrrh as an expensive and therefore highly admiring and complimentary gift; recall the Wise Men before the infant Jesus:

“And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his Mother, and fell down, and worshipped him: and when they opened their treasures, they presented him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh. (Matthew 2-11).” Where or how the use of incense arose, of course is a sealed mystery as far as evidence goes. Modern science, however, enables a reasonable guess to be made.

Of the five senses, smell is the most closely associated with memory and mood. To neither sight nor sound does the emotional part of personality respond as it does to odor. The scent of certain flowers so surely spells grief to many that they will leave a room in which tube roses or lilies fill the air with scent. Certain odors are so intimately identified with certain experiences that they become for all time pleasant, or the reverse; few who have smelled ether or iodoform from personal experience in hospitals enjoy these, in themselves not unpleasant smells; any man who has loved outdoor life and camping cannot smell wood smoke without being homesick for the streams and fields; he who made love to his lady in lilac time is always sentimental when he again sniffs that perfume, and the high church votary is uplifted by the smell of incense.

In the ceremonials of ancient Israel doubtless the first use of incense was protections against unpleasant odors associated with the slaughtering of cattle and scorching of flesh in the burnt offering. At first, but an insurance against discomfort, incense speedily became associated with religious rites. Today men neither kill nor offer flesh at an altar, but only the perfume of “frankincense and myrrh.”

The Masonic pot of incense is intimately associated with prayer, but its symbolic significance is not a Masonic invention. Psalms 141-2 reads: “Let my prayer be set forth before thee as incense; and the lifting up of my hands as the evening sacrifice.” Revelations 8-3 reads: “And another angel came and stood at the altar, having a golden censer; and there was given unto him much incense, that he should offer it with the prayers of all saints upon the golden altar which was before the throne.”

The association of a sweet smell in the air, which scattered after it gave pleasure with prayers to an Unseen Presence is easy to understand, even that it arose in primitive minds. Prayer was offered and rose on high - so its utterers hoped. It was never seen of men. It returned not. It's very giving gave pleasure. These statements are as true of burning incense as of prayer.

What is less obvious, although the ritual is plain enough on the subject, is that it is not only incense, but a “pot” which is the Masonic symbol. If the sweet savor of incense is like unto a prayer, so is the pot from which it comes like unto the human heart which prays.

Now prayer may come from an impure as well as from a pure heart. But incense is invariably sweet in smell, and so the pot from which it comes is an emblem of a heart pure, sweet and unsullied. Just what “purity” is as applied to a heart is a moot question. Very unfortunately the word “pure” has been debased - the word is used advisedly - in certain dogmas to mean “ignorant” - as a “pure” young girl; a “pure” woman. According to this definition a female may be a virago, a cheat, a liar, slander her neighbors, steal, even commit a murder; but, if she is a virgin, she is “pure.”

Masonically, the word means nothing of the kind. In 1921 M.W. George H. Dern, Past Grand Master of Utah (Now

Secretary of War) contributed some thoughts on “Monitorial Symbolism of the Third Degree and Its Application to Everyday Life” to columns of “The Builder.” Originally written for the Committee on Masonic Education of the Grand Lodge of Utah, these paragraphs were at once so practical and so pungent that the (then) great Masonic Journal gave them wider circulation.

Quoting the Ritual about the Pot of Incense, M.W. Brother Dern said: “A sentiment so lofty is not easily applied to the practical, prosaic events of a busy day. To have a pure heart is to be true to yourself, true to your best ideals, and honest with your thoughts. “To Thine Own Self Be True. . . Thou Canst Not Then Be False To Any Man.” Living a life of deceit and double-dealing never made anyone happy. Riches or pleasures acquired in that way bring only remorse, and eventually the soul cries out in anguish for that peace of mind, which is man’s most precious possession, and which is the companion of a pure heart.

“Purity of heart means conscientiousness, and that means sincerity. Without sincerity there can be no real character. But sincerity alone is not enough. There must go with it a proper degree of intelligence and love of one’s fellows. For example, a man may believe that the emotion of pity and the desire to relieve the necessities of others is intrinsically noble and elevating, and he indulges in indiscriminate giving, without realizing the evil consequences, in the way of fraud, laziness and inefficiency and habitual dependence that his ill-considered acts produce upon those whom he intends

to benefit. Again, a man may be perfectly sincere in talking about the shortcomings of another, and he may justify himself by saying that he is telling nothing but the truth. But, merely because they are true is no reason why unpleasant and harmful things should be told. To destroy a reputation is no way to aid a brother who has erred. Better far overlook his mistakes, and extend him a helping hand.

“Without multiplying examples, let it be understood that the truly conscientious man must not simply be sincere, but he must have high ideals and standards, and moreover, he must not be satisfied with those standards. Rather he must revise them from time to time, and that means self-examination, to see if he possesses the love and courage that must go with sincerity in order to make progress in building character. For in this direction again there must be constant progress. To be content with what we have accomplished is fatal. As James A. Garfield once said, “I must do something to keep my thoughts fresh and growing. I dread nothing so much as falling into a rut and feeling myself becoming a fossil.” Many words in the ritual have changed meanings since they were first used. The Masonic term “profane,” for instance, originally meant “without the temple” - one not initiated, not of the craft. Today it means blasphemous, which is no part of the Masonic definition of the word. “Sacrifice” in our Monitor seems to come under this classification.

In the Old Testament, a sacrifice before the altar was the offering of something - burned flesh, burning incense, pure oil or wine - which involved the sacrificer giving something valuable to him; the sacrifice was an evidence before all men that the sacrificer valued his kinship with the Most High more than his possession of that which he offered.

In our ritual the word has lost this significance. The pot of incense as an emblem of a pure heart “which is always an acceptable sacrifice to the Deity” can hardly connote the idea that a Mason desires to keep his “pure heart” for himself, but because of love of God is willing to give it up. Rather does it denote that he who gives up worldly pleasures, mundane ideas and selfish cravings which may interfere with “purity of life and conduct” as set forth in other parts of the ritual, does that which is acceptable to the Great Architect.

Masonically, “pure” seems to mean honest, sincere, genuine, real, without pretense and “sacrifice” to denote that which is pleasing to the Most High.

So read, the Masonic pot of incense becomes an integral part of the philosophy of Freemasonry, and not a mere moral interjection in the emblems of the third degree. For all of the magnificent body of teaching which is self-revealed, half concealed in the symbolism of Freemasonry, nothing stands out more plainly, or calls with a louder voice, than her insistence on these simple yet profound virtues of the human heart lumped together in one phrase as “a man of higher character” . . .in other words, one with a “pure heart,” “pure” meaning undefiled by the faults and frailties of so many of the children of men.

THE POWERS OF THE WORSHIPFUL MASTER

by: Unknown

Grand Lodges differ in their interpretation of some of the "ancient usages and customs" of the Fraternity; what applies in one Jurisdiction does not necessarily apply in another. But certain powers of a Master are so well recognized that they may be considered universal. The occasional exceptions, if any, but prove the rule. The Master may congregate his lodge when he pleases, and for what purpose he wishes, "provided" it does not interfere with the laws of the Grand Lodge. For instance, he may assemble his lodge as a Special Communication to confer degrees, at his pleasure; but he must not, in so doing, contravene that requirement of the grand Lodge which calls for proper notice to the brethren, nor may a Master confer a degree in less than the statutory time following a preceding degree without a dispensation from the Grand Master.

The Master has the right of presiding over and controlling his lodge, and only the Grand Master, or his Deputy, may suspend him. He may put any brother in the East to preside or to confer a degree; he may then resume the gavel at his pleasure - even in the middle of a sentence if he wants to! But even when he has delegated authority temporarily, the Master is not relieved from responsibility for what occurs in his lodge. It is the Master's right to control lodge business and work. It is in a very real sense "his" lodge. He decides all points of order and no appeal from his decision may be taken to the lodge. He can initiate and terminate debate at his pleasure, he can second any motion, propose any motion, vote twice in the case of a tie (not universal), open and close at his pleasure, with the usual exception that he may not open a Special Communication at an hour earlier than that given in the notice, or a Stated Communication earlier than the hour stated in the by-laws, without dispensation from the Grand Master. He is responsible only to the Grand Master and the Grand Lodge, the obligations he assumed when he was installed, his conscience and his God.

The Master has the undoubted right to say who shall enter, and who must leave the lodge room. He may deny any visitor entrance; indeed, he may deny a member the right to enter his own lodge, but he must have a good and

sufficient reason therefore, otherwise his Grand Lodge will unquestionably rule such a drastic step arbitrary and punish accordingly. "Per contra," if he permits entry of a visitor to whom some member has objected, he may also subject himself to Grand Lodge discipline. In other words, his "power" to admit or exclude is absolute; his "right" to admit or exclude is hedged about by pledges he takes at his installation and the rules of the Grand Lodge.

A very important power of the Master is that of appointing committees. No lodge may appoint a committee. The lodge may pass a resolution that a committee be appointed, but the selection of that committee is an inherent right of the Master. He is, "ex officio," a member of all committees he appoints. The reason is obvious; he is responsible for the conduct of his lodge to the Grand Master and the Grand Lodge. If the lodge could appoint committees and act upon their recommendations, the Master would be in the anomalous position of having great responsibilities, and no power to carry out their performance. The Master, and only the Master, may order a committee to examine a visiting brother. It is his responsibility to see that no cowan or eavesdropper comes within the tiled door. Therefore, it is for him to pick a committee in which he has confidence. So, also, with the committees which report upon petitioners. He is responsible for the accuracy, fair-mindedness, the speed and intelligence of such investigations. It is, therefore, for him to say to whom shall be delegated this necessary and important duty.

It is generally, not exclusively, held that only the Master can issue a summons. The dispute, where it exists, is over the right of members present at a Stated Communication to summons the whole membership.

It may now be interesting to look for a moment at some matters in which the Worshipful

The Master, and only the Master appoints the appointive officers in his lodge. In most Jurisdictions he may remove such appointed officers at his pleasure. But, he cannot suspend, or deprive of his station or place, any officer elected by the lodge. The Grand Master or his Deputy, may do this; the Worshipful Master may not.

A Master may not spend lodge money without the consent of the lodge. As a matter of convenience, a Master frequently does pay out money in sudden emergencies, looking to the lodge for reimbursement. But he cannot spend any lodge funds without the permission of the lodge. Some

Jurisdictions do allow the lodge by-laws to permit the Master to spend emergency funds up to a specified amount without prior consent of the lodge.

A Master cannot accept a petition, or confer a degree without the consent of the lodge. It is for the lodge, not the Master, to say from what men it will receive an application, or a petition; and upon what candidates degrees shall be conferred. The Master has the same power to "reject" through the "black cube" as any member has, but no power whatever to "accept" any candidate against the will of the lodge.

The lodge, not the Master, must approve or disapprove the minutes of the preceding meeting. The Master cannot approve them; had he that power he might, with the connivance of the secretary, "run wild" in his lodge, and still his minutes would show no trace of his improper conduct. But the Master may refuse to put a motion to confirm or approve minutes which he believes to be inaccurate or incomplete; in this way he can prevent a careless, headstrong Secretary from doing what he wants with his minutes! Should a Master refuse to permit minutes to be confirmed, the matter would naturally be brought before the Grand Lodge or the Grand Master for settlement.

A Master cannot suspend the by-laws. He must not permit the lodge to suspend the by-laws. If the lodge wishes to change them, the means are available, not in suspension; but, in amendment. An odd exception may be noted, which has occurred in at least one Grand Jurisdiction, and doubtless may occur in others. A very old lodge adopted by-laws shortly after it was constituted, which by-laws were approved by a young Grand Lodge before that body had, apparently, devoted much attention to these important rules. For many years this lodge carried in its by-laws and "order of business" which specified, among other things, that following the reading of the minutes, the next business was balloting. As the time of meeting of this lodge was early (seven o'clock) this by-law worked a hardship for years, compelling brethren who wished to vote to hurry to lodge, often at great inconvenience.

At last a Master was elected who saw that the by-law interfered with his right to conduct the business of the lodge as he thought proper. He balloted at what he thought was the proper time, the last order of business, not the first. An indignant committee of Past Masters, who preferred the old order, applied to the Grand Master for relief. The Grand Master promptly ruled that "order of business" in the by-laws could be no more than suggestive, not mandatory; and that the Worshipful Master had the power to order a ballot on a petition at the hour which seemed to him wise, provided - and this was

stressed - that he ruled wisely, and did not postpone a ballot until after a degree, or until so late in the evening that brethren wishing to vote upon it had left the lodge room.

A Worshipful Master has no more right to invade the privacy which shrouds the use of the "Black Cube" (or Ball), or which conceals the reason for an objection to an elected candidate receiving the degrees, than the humblest member of the lodge. He cannot demand disclosure of action or motive from any brother, and should he do so, he would be subject to the severest discipline from the Grand Lodge.

Grand Lodges usually argue that a dereliction of duty by a brother who possesses the ability and character to attain the East, is worse than that of some less informed brother. The Worshipful Master receives great honor, has great privileges, enjoys great prerogatives and powers. Therefore, he must measure up to great responsibilities. A Worshipful Master cannot resign. Vacancies occur in the East through death, suspension by a Grand Master, expulsion from the Fraternity. No power can make a Master attend to his duties if he desires to neglect them. If he will not, or does not attend to them, the Senior Warden presides. He is, however, still Senior Warden; he does not become Master until elected and installed.

In broad outline, these are the important and principal powers and responsibilities of a Worshipful Master, considered entirely from the standpoint of the "ancient usages and customs of the Craft." Nothing is said here of the moral and spiritual duties which devolve upon a Master.

Volumes might be and some have been written upon how a Worshipful Master should preside, in what ways he can "give the brethren good and wholesome instruction," and upon his undoubted moral responsibility to do his best to leave his lodge better than he found it. Here we are concerned only with the legal aspect of his powers and duties.

Briefly then, if he keeps within the laws, resolutions and edicts of his Grand Lodge on the one hand, and the Landmarks, Old Charges, Constitutions and "ancient usages and customs" on the other, the power of the Worshipful Master is that of an absolute monarch. His responsibilities and his duties are those of an apostle of Light!

He is a gifted brother who can fully measure up to the use of his power and the power of his leadership.

THE RUFFIANS

by: Unknown

As every Mason knows, at the heart of our mysteries lies a legend, in which we learn how three unworthy craftsmen entered into a plot to extort from a famous Mason a secret to which they had no right. It is all familiar enough, in its setting and sequence; and it is a part of his initiation which no Mason ever forgets.

In spite of its familiarity, the scene in which the Ruffians appear is one of the most impressive that any man ever beheld, if it is not marred, as it often is, alas, by a hint of rowdy. No one can witness it without being made to feel there is a secret which, for all our wit and wisdom, we have not yet won from the Master Builder of the world; the mystery of evil in the life of man.

To one who feels the pathos of life and ponders its mystery, a part of its tragedy is the fact that the Great Man, toiling for the good of the race, is so often stricken down when the goal of his labors is almost within his reach; as Lincoln was shot in an hour when he was most needed. Nor is he an isolated example. The shadow lies dark upon the pages of history in every age.

The question is baffling: Why is it that evil men, acting from low motives and for selfish aims, have such power to throw the race into confusion and bring ruin upon all, defeating the very end at which they aim? Is it true that all the holy things of life - the very things that make it worth living - are held at the risk and exposed to the peril of evil forces; and if so, why should it be so?

If we cannot answer such questions, we can at least ask another nearer to hand. Since everything in masonry is symbolic, who are the ruffians and what is the legend trying to tell us? Of course, we know the names they wear, but what is the truth back of it all which it will help us to know? As is true of all Masonic symbols, as many meanings have been found as there have been seekers.

It all depends on the key with which each seeker sets out to unlock the meaning of Masonry. To those who trace our symbolism to the ancient solar worship, the three Ruffians are the three winter months who plot to murder the beauty and glory of summer, destroying the life-giving heat of the sun. To those who find the origin of Masonry in the Ancient Mysteries of Egypt, it is a

drama of Typhon, the Spirit of Evil, slaying Osiris the Spirit of Good, who is resurrected, in turn rising triumphant over death.

Not a few find the fulfillment of this oldest of all dramas in the life and death of Jesus, who was put to death outside the city gate by three of the most ruthless Ruffians - the Priest, the Politician and the Mob. Which of the three is the worst foe of humanity is hard to tell, but when they work together, as they usually do, there is no crime against man of which they have not been guilty.

A few think that Masonry, as we have it, grew out of the downfall of the Knights Templar, identify the three Assassins, as they are called in the Lodges of Europe, with three renegade Knights who falsely accused the Order, and so aided King Phillip and Pope Clement to abolish Templarism, and slay its Grand Master, A very few see in Cromwell and his adherents the plotters, putting to death Charles the First.

It is plain that we must go further back and deeper down if we are to find the real Ruffians, who are still at large. Albert Pike identified the three Brothers who are the greatest enemies of individual welfare and social progress as Kingcraft, Priestcraft, and the ignorant Mob-Mind. Together they conspire to destroy liberty, without which man can make no advance.

The first strikes a blow at the throat, the seat of freedom of speech, and that is a mortal wound. The second stabs at the heart, the home of freedom of conscience, and that is well-nigh fatal, since it puts out the last ray of Divine Light by which man is guided. The third of the foul plotters fells his victim dead with a blow on the brain, which is the throne of freedom of thought.

No lesson could be plainer; it is written upon every page of the past. If by apathy, neglect or stupidity we suffer free speech, free conscience, and free thought to be destroyed either by Kingcraft, Priestcraft or the Mob-Mind; or, by all three working together - for they are Brothers and usually go hand in hand - the Temple of God will be dark, there will be no designs upon the Trestlboard, and the result will be idleness, confusion and chaos. It is a parable of history - a picture of many an age in the past of which we read. For, where there is no light of Divine Vision, the Altar fire is extinguished. The people "perish" as the Bible tells us; literally they become a mob, which is only another way of saying the same thing. There are no designs on the Trestleboard; that is, no leadership, - as in Russia today, where the herd-mind runs wild and runs red. Chaos comes again, inevitably so when all the

lights are blown out, and the people are like ignorant armies that clash by night.

Of the three Ruffians, the most terrible, the most ruthless, the most brutal is the ignorant Mob-Mind. No tyrant, no priest can reduce a nation to slavery and control it until it is lost in the darkness of ignorance. By ignorance we mean not merely lack of knowledge, but the state of mind in which men refuse, or are afraid, to think, to reason, to enquire. When "The Great Freedoms of the Mind" go, everything is lost!

After this manner Pike expounded the meaning of the three Ruffians. who rob themselves, as they rob their fellow craftsmen, of the most precious secret of personal and social life. A secret let it be added, which cannot be extorted, but is only won when we are worthy to receive it and have the wit and courage to keep it. For, oddly enough, we cannot have real liberty until we are ready for it, and can only become worthy of it by seeking and striving for it.

But some of us go further, and find the same three Ruffians nearer home - hiding in our own hearts. And naturally so, because society is only the individual writ larger; and what men are together is determined by what each is by himself. If we know who the ruffians really are, we have only to ask; what three things waylay each of us, destroy character, and if they have their way either slay us or turn us into ruffians? Why do we do evil and mar the Temple of God in us? Three great Greek thinkers searched until they found the three causes of sin in the heart of man. In other words, they hunted in the mountains of the mind until they found the Ruffians. Socrates said that the chief ruffian is ignorance - that is, no man in his right mind does evil unless he is so blinded by ignorance that he does see the right. No man, he said, seeing good and evil side by side, will choose evil unless he is too blind to see its results. An enlightened self-interest would stop him. Therefore, his remedy for the ills of life is knowledge - more light, and a clearer insight. Even so, said Plato; it is all true as far as it goes. But the fact is that men do see right and wrong clearly, and yet in a dark mood they do wrong in spite of knowledge. When the mind is calm and clear, the right is plain, but a storm of passion stirs up sediments in the bottom of the mind, and it is so cloudy that clear vision fails. The life of a man is like driving a team of horses, one tame and the other wild. So long as the wild horse is held firmly all goes well. But, alas, often enough, the wild horse gets loose and there is a run-away and a wreck.

But that is not all, said Aristotle. We do not get to the bottom truth of the matter until we admit the fact and possibility - in ourselves and in our fellows - of a moral perversity, a spirit of sheer mischief, which does wrong, deliberately and in the face of right, calmly and with devilish cunning, for the sake of wrong and for the love of it. Here, truly, is the real Ruffian most to be feared - a desperate character he is, who can only be overcome by Divine Help.

Thus, three great thinkers capture the Ruffians, hiding somewhere in our own minds. It means much to

have them brought before us for judgment, and happy is the man who is wise enough to take them outside the city of his mind and execute them. Nothing else or less will do. To show them any mercy is to invite misery and disaster. They are ruthless, and must be dealt with ruthlessly and at once. If we parley with them, if we soften toward them, we our-selves may be turned into Ruffians. Good but foolish Fellowcraft-fts came near being intrigued into a hideous crime. "If thy right eye offend, pluck it out," said the greatest of Teachers. Only a celestial surgery will save the whole body from infection and moral rot. We dare not make terms with evil, else it will dictate terms to us before we are aware of it.

One does not have to break the head of a Brother in order to be a Ruffian. One can break a heart. One can break his home. One can slay his good name. The amount of polite and refined ruffianism that goes on about us every day is appalling. Watch-fulness is wisdom. Only a mind well tiled, with a faithful inner guard ever at his post, may hope to keep the ruffian spirit out of your heart and mine. No wise man dare be careless or take any chances with the thought, feelings and motives he admits into the Lodge of the mind, whereof he is Master.

So let us live, watch and work, until Death, the last Ruffian, whom none can escape, lays us low, assured that even the dark, dumb hour, which brings a dreamless sleep about our couch, will not be able to keep us from the face of God, whose strong grip will free us and lift us out of shadows into the Light; out of dim phantoms into the Life Eternal that cannot die.

Brothers and Men of Tyre: The Three Ruffians and Their Role in the Hiramic Legend

by: Steven Joyce

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Freemasonry is often described as “a system of morality, veiled in allegory and illustrated by symbols” (Wilmshurst, 1927). It utilizes this format in an effort to offer its members an opportunity for self-improvement and self-discovery. Central to the initiatory process of Freemasonry is the allegory of the Hiramic Legend which is not only portrayed, but also experienced by the candidate. There are many of these allegories presented by various initiatory systems which are enacted or taught through the medium of a tragic tale in which there is a central figure which serves as an exemplar for the aspirant to imitate (Wilmshurst, 1927).

The “system of morality” offered by Freemasonry has at its core a lexicon of symbols tied together through a series of degrees which allows its members access to the lessons offered within its particular tradition. It has been suggested that the true secret of the Craft is the message unlocked by an understanding and personal interpretation of these symbols. It is speculated that the message being offered cannot truly be communicated so it must therefore be experienced in order to permit the information to be transferred from one to another (Guenon, 2004). It is through the vehicle of the allegory of the Hiramic Legend that the aspirant can directly experience the lessons and within the events of the drama discover these secrets for himself (Powell, 1924).

The Hiramic Legend is presented in the form of an allegory and rightly so. An allegory is used to present ideas in which the apparent meaning of the characters and events are used to symbolize a deeper moral or spiritual meaning (CED, 2014). Within the allegory of the Legend are several characters, central of which is Hiram Abiff. It is somewhat easy to find many interpretations of the virtues he symbolizes and the lessons his example offers. What is also important is that as an allegory utilizes its characters to convey a message it should also be essential to examine several other characters in the Hiramic Legend whose importance may be overlooked, but

yet serve to offer vital lessons for consideration. It is to this end that we will examine the role of the “Three Ruffians”, brothers and men of Tyre, who serve as the villains of the story but also serve as symbols of a more cautionary nature.

The emergence of the Hiramic Legend utilized in the Third Degree may trace its origins as early as 1723 as they were mentioned in Anderson’s Book of Constitutions and it is argued that it may have existed by the formulation of the first Grand Lodge in 1717 if not earlier (Horne, 1972). Researchers with the Grand Lodge of British Columbia and Yukon (2008) have identified that the three Ruffians were first mentioned in Samuel Pritchard’s *Masonry Dissected* but they were not named:

“In the Building of Solomon’s Temple he was Master-Mason, and at high 12 at Noon, when the Men was gone to refresh themselves, as was his usual Custom, he came to survey the Works, and when he was enter’d into the Temple, there were Three Ruffians, suppos’d to be Three Fellow-Crafts, planted themselves at the Three Entrances of the Temple, and when he came out, one demanded the Master’s Word of him, and he reply’d he did not receive it in such a manner, but Time and a little Patience would bring him to it : He, not satisfied with that Answer, gave him a Blow, which made him reel ; he went to the other Gate, where being accosted in the same manner, and making the same Reply, he received a greater Blow, and at the third his Quietus. (Pritchard, 1730, p. 9)

These Ruffians were identified by name in 1760 by Serjeant in his work *Three Distinct Knocks* (Serjeant, 1760) and unlike Pritchard, who identified the working tools used as “a Setting Maul, Setting Tool and Setting Beadle”, Serjeant names the Twenty-Four Inch Gauge, Square and Setting Maul as the instruments utilized. Later publications, such as *Jachin and Boaz*, (credited to Pritchard) also utilize these names and working tools (Pritchard, 1762). Preston’s *Illustrations of Freemasonry* (1773) does not mention them, nor were they named in Finch’s *Masonic Tretise* and while the incident is recounted, the manner in which the Ruffians injured Hiram is not named either (Finch, 1802).

As the Craft utilizes the allegory of the murder of Hiram Abiff to communicate a “deeper moral or spiritual meaning”, the question of the importance of these three characters becomes more important to explore. Several authors have offered speculations on the symbolism of these three Fellowcrafts and perhaps these theories offer the Masonic student some

avenues to investigate other lessons offered by the legend. This drive to understand this may be best understood by the question posed in the Short Talk Bulletin, The Ruffians:

“Why is it that evil men, acting from low motives and for selfish aims, have such power to throw the race into confusion and bring ruin upon all, defeating the very end at which they aim? Is it true that all the holy things of life - the very things that make it worth living - are held at the risk and exposed to the peril of evil forces; and if so, why should it be so? (Masonic Service Association, 1927)

Albert Pike has made several references to the symbolism of the Ruffians as well as to the weapons they chose to utilize in the recounting of the murder of Hiram Abiff. Pike identified the three Brothers who are the greatest enemies of individual welfare and social progress as Kingcraft, Priestcraft, and the ignorant Mob-Mind. Together they conspire to destroy liberty, without which man cannot advance in self-improvement (De Hoyos, 2008).

Pike asserts that the first Ruffian represents Royalty which “fears the patriot” and sends these men “to the scaffold.” As such, the twenty-four inch gauge or rule (from the Latin *regula*, meaning to govern) is an appropriate symbol. Hiram is struck across the throat with the rule to symbolize the silencing of the freedom of speech which silences discussion, places a hold on the press and forbids dissent (De Hoyos, 2008, p. 255). The second Ruffian represents the Priesthood which seeks to control inquiries and students of philosophy through the condemnation of heresy. Hiram is struck on the breast, the area of the heart, with the square. Here Pike posits that the square (from the Latin *norma*, meaning a “rule of conduct”) is representative of Canon Law which “claims the right to define and enact what all men shall believe.” He offers that the angle of a square is symbolically where the spiritual and temporal powers of the Church unite.

As the heart is the seat of convictions, faith and conscience so the blow is struck to suppress thoughts, opinions and liberty (De Hoyos, 2008). Lastly, the third Ruffian represents the Mob-Mind. This is a force which is organized and directed by a singular will which is both blind and unreasoning. It is the symbol of brute force as embodied in military despotism and in anarchy.

It is here that Hiram is struck with the Maul in the forehead, seat of the intellect, stifling thought and “constitutional freedom” (De Hoyos, 2008). For Pike, the symbolism would seem to be more than just an inner process, but

also a commentary on how the individual has a role in society and their responsibility toward the greater good.

Pike in his *Book of the Words* (1992) examines the etymology of the names of the Ruffians. Here he surveys the meanings of the names Jubela, Jubelo and Jubelum as well as the derivations of Abiram, Akirop and Abibal. There is also some speculation on the alternate names of Romvel, Hobren and Gravelot. The most current common names, utilizing their Hebrew equivalents, can be split into Yu-bal and a,o,um. He defines these as “Yu (yod)” meaning “Deity”, “bel” meaning the god Baal and the signifier of a, o or um (Pike, 1992, p. 85).

This is further denoted in Steinmetz’s work which follows later. The other, less common names of Abiram (“Rebellious Chief”), Abibal (“Son of Baal”) and Akirop (“a scorpion”) may allude to the astronomical theories of their symbolism and play a part in the 9th and 10th Degrees of the Lodge of Perfection, specifically in Peckham’s “Cerneau” Scottish Rite (De Hoyos, 2015). The remaining names of Romvel, Hobhen and Gravelot he speculates may allude to the possibility that the Legend is an allegory of the Cromwellian rebellion with Romvel being an anagram for Cromwell, Hobhen and anagram for Bohun (from the Bohuns whose arms were quartered on the shield of the Earl of Essex) and Gravelot a reversal of “Televerg” representing Argyle (Pike, 1992, p. 87).

Manly Hall would seem to agree somewhat with Pike. In his work, *The Secret Teachings of all Ages* (1928) Hall reiterates Pike’s interpretation of the symbolism of the Ruffians as well as adds some of his own thoughts as to their relevance within the allegory. The three murderers represent the laws of the inferior world – birth, growth and decay – which “ever frustrate the plan of the Builder.” In his work *The Lost Keys of Freemasonry* (1923) Hall presents the idea that the three ruffians are symbolic of “the three expressions of our own lower self which are in truth the murders of the good within ourselves” (Hall, 1923, p. 21). They symbolize thought, desire and action. When purified and transmuted they allow for the manifestation as spiritual thought, constructive emotion and useful daily labor for carrying on the Master’s work. This is manifested in the Legend as the three kings (Solomon, Hiram of Tyre and Hiram Abiff). When perverted (as symbolized by the ruffians) it creates a “triangular prison” which man must remain until he liberates these energies through a higher understanding (Hall, 1923, p. 22). Hall also directs the reader’s attention to Pike’s allusion to the Ruffians representing the winter

signs of the zodiac – Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces. As according to Hall Hiram also represents the Sun, these Ruffians – as representatives of the winter signs – represent the winter months where the Sun is slain and awaits resurrection in the Spring. He further makes an assertion that there is a connection to the Christian Mysteries where the Sun (Christ) is struck by Libra (the state), Scorpio (the church) and Sagittarius (the mob) and then carried through the darkness by the signs of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces and buried over the brow of a hill (the vernal equinox) (Hall, 2003).

George Steinmetz takes the exploration in a different direction. He begins by examining the etymology of the names of the Ruffians. He asserts that each of the cities of Canaan had one god it revered above all other gods. Baal was the local nature god of Tyre, thus "Baal" or "Bal" appearing in a name identifies the bearer as a "man of Tyre." He further asserts that an identical prefix would indicate family connection, while the dissimilar suffixes denote the individuals.

Incidentally, such ritual which refers to the "peculiarity" of these names is incorrect. They were not "peculiar" and may well have been as common as the English "Smith." "Similarity", he states, is the correct expression. (Steinmetz, 1982, p. 111).

Further, it is significant that they are depicted as "brethren" and "men of Tyre" as this also serves as an important symbolic purpose. It would seem to indicate that they are from the same parentage and worshipers of Baal. Steinmetz states that Baal is a material god. This establishes a distinction between them and "men of Israel" who are worshipers of Jehovah, who is a spiritual God. He further asserts that it is important to the consistency of the allegory that Tyrians perpetrate the deed, which he claims is a symbolic impossibility for "men of Israel." It is emphasized by the roll-call in which all the names answering present are Hebrew, while the only ones absent are Tyrian. (Steinmetz, 1982, p. 111).

Steinmetz then aligns each of the Ruffians with the three elements of the three Degrees, the material, the intellectual and the spiritual. The "First" typifies material desires and greed which prompt the attempt to gain selfish benefits regardless of the rights of others. He strikes with the working tool which symbolizes the material or physical. The "Second" symbolizes the intellectual which incites the attitudes of mind. He is symbolic of intolerance, bigotry, hatred and envy. He strikes with the working tools which symbolizes the intellectual or psychical. The "Third" strikes the fatal blow with a setting

maul. Unlike the other two working tools, this one is noticeably absent from Masonic symbolism in the third Degree. Steinmetz posits that this working tool must have at some time been included and due to its use here it would seem to allude that it was a working tool of the third Degree, which is the spiritual degree of Masonry. (Steinmetz, 1982, p. 112).

He presents that the working tools of a Master Mason are "all the implements of Masonry especially the trowel." That being given, an investigation would show that there are six, which Steinmetz asserts is inconsistent with the numerology of the Lodge. If we include the setting maul, then the number would be seven. He offers a catechism for the symbolic explanation of the setting maul:

A setting-maul is an instrument made use of by operative masons to coerce the unwieldy stone into its proper position in the building; but we, as Free and Accepted Masons are taught to make use of it for the more noble and glorious purpose of impelling ourselves into our proper positions in that building of which we are to form a part. A more recondite exposition is seen in the Constructive and Destructive actions of Universal Law. In the hands of the ignorant and unskilled workman it becomes an instrument of death and destruction, but in the hands of the enlightened and skillful craftsman it becomes a Constructive instrument with which the recalcitrant stone is forced into its proper position. (Steinmetz, 1982, p. 103).

This may serve to explain why some gavels are fashioned in the shape of a maul rather than in the usual hammer shape. In the hands of a Worshipful Master the gavel may either bring harmony into the Lodge, or it may break the "stone" which is the individual Mason with whom he is trying to place in his "proper position." He does not dismiss the importance of the trowel.

He notes that its triangular shape represents the coming together of the two planes of existence (physical and intellectual) which allow for the perception of the existence of the third (spiritual) True "brotherly love" is a spiritual attribute, and it is only the trowel which can spread the "cement of brotherly love and affection." (Steinmetz, 1982, p. 103).

Jim Tresner, a noted Masonic author, offers yet another take on the symbolism of these three men. He presents the theory that the Hiramic Legend can be considered within the context of the medieval mystery play. Also known as "miracle" or "morality" plays, they were performed in the Middle Ages as assigned to various guilds for presentation as part of their

traditional duties. While some exhaustive research has been done to determine if the Legend is a descendant of these plays (Horne, 1972) it has not been definitively proven. While this may be the case, it still deserves some consideration as a context or lens through which we may view the lessons being offered. Tresner further suggests that the Legend be viewed in the context of a classical tragedy given within the format of a mystery play. He offers the following as the rules of a classical tragedy:

- Everything which happens must be motivated by the character of those involved; chance, accident or coincidence must play no part in it.
- Once given the opening situation and the character of the people the action and events must be predictable and inevitable. Once set in motion, a tragedy unwinds, in Cocteau's terms, "like an infernal machine." We know what is going to happen, we wish with all our might that it might not happen, and it happens.
- The tragic hero falls, not by chance, but because of the flaw in his character of which he was unaware.
- Because of the tragic flaw he crosses some invisible line or offends against some divine principle which leads to his fall.
- After the action of the fall, it is permissible that chance or circumstance may lead to the discovery of the act, although such chance was generally understood to be the working of Divine Will.
- He is destroyed by the fall but in the process comes to a fuller understanding of himself and his own character. (Tresner, n.d.)

Viewed through this lens, the Hiramic Legend is a mystery play, offering a moral lesson by way of an allegory. It is through the vehicle of a classic tragedy that the lesson is uncovered. As Tresner offers, "the action comes about because of the character or personality of those involved, there is a tragic fall and death and the hero comes to a new understanding of himself." (Tresner, n.d.) With this new set of definitions in mind, our focus does not fall on Hiram. He does not fall due to a flaw, but due to his character. This then draws our attention in a different direction – to Jubalum. Tresner offers the following as the reasons for this shift:

- His flaw is impatience and a lack of faith and trust.
- He gains insight into his character when he contemplates his role in the death of Hiram.

- He pronounces his own sentence and accepts his own death. (Tresner, n.d.)

Given these conditions, the character of Jubalum presents the following lessons for the student to consider:

If we see Hiram as the hero, the one from whom we are to learn, then about the only lesson is the importance of integrity, even unto death. True and important, but somewhat obvious. If we see Jubelum as the one from whom we are to learn, the lessons include these: putting our own self-interests above the goal which is to be achieved leads to poor decisions and destruction; giving way to our animal side, even for an instant, leads to consequences which may be possible to undo; all positions in life are positions leading to integrity and honor...; since the building of the Temple represents the building of our own lives, we must be careful not to subvert that building for short-term goals; there is no such thing as an unimportant action or decision, there are only actions or decisions whose importance is not known or understood; of all wrong actions, the most wrong are the ones which violate what should be our own insight and understanding; if we spend much time thinking about what is 'due to us' or 'what we've earned', we are almost certain to become resentful and impatient. (Tresner, n.d.)

With this in mind, there would seem to be a possible deeper lesson to be learned through the allegory of the Hiramic Legend. It is not just a lesson of integrity but also the importance of understanding one's own flaws, to think before one acts and to think more of the bigger picture rather than focus on short term gains.

The allegory of the Hiramic Legend remains somewhat shrouded in mystery. Many scholars have conducted research to determine its origins and its purpose. In addition to the possible moral lessons the allegory provides, it has been speculated (Horne, 1972) that it mirrors other mythical and historical stories as well. Several possibilities include:

- A connection to the legend of the Apprentice Pillar
- An extension of the Dionysian Mysteries
- A representation of the murder of Thomas Becket
- The murder of the Templar Carolus de Monte Carmel
- A connection to the Cromwellian rebellion
- A descendant of the Compagnonnage Legend

It is also interesting to note that there was a central Legend prior to that of Hiram which featured Noah as the central character. This was found in the Graham Manuscript (1726) which did not feature three Ruffians, but the three sons of Noah.

The symbolic importance of the Ruffians is sometimes lost in our presentation of the Legend. This may be due in part to our focus on Hiram and possibly due to the lack of emphasis within our own Work. In a 1919 cipher published by the Grand Lodge of New York, the following was offered as a description of the Ruffians to the candidate:

“Thus it is with man. Strong in youth and confident in his strength, he starts to execute the designs which he has drawn upon the great trestle-board of his life; but at the very outset he meets his first enemy, J-a, in his own evil persons – in envy, hate, licentiousness, debauchery, defacing the beautiful mirror of his soul by their baneful influence. But these may overcome; and still strong in faith and hope, he presses forward on life’s journey to meet his second and still stronger enemy, his J-o, fitly represented by sorrow and misfortune, by disease or poverty, by the coldness of faithless friends or the hostility of open enemies. Weary and faint from the conflict, still struggling for the right, upward looking with eyes of faith, those enemies be subdued, he meets the evening of his days, his third and terrible enemy, his J-m. To him, this enemy is Death – Death, from whom there can be no escape – Death, before all must yield, whether they be the young, the beautiful, or the gifted – meet a relentless enemy, insisting on having his victim.” (King Solomon and his Followers, 1919, p. 224)

Freemasonry works to “make good men better” through the vehicle of “a system of morality, veiled in allegory and illustrated by symbols.” As such, the Craft communicates its incommunicable secrets through this vehicle to permit the work of inner transformation to occur. Whether the symbolism of the Ruffians serves as a commentary on society, as a mystical tale of the turning of the seasons, or the inner conflicts within us is a matter for the individual to determine for themselves. What is important is that the roles these three men play in the allegory of the Hiram Legend should not be overlooked as minor characters, but important symbols in their own right, with an important place in the path of our individual Masonic journey or transformation.

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SPRIG OF ACACIA

by: Unknown



Any discussion of the Acacia, important to Freemasonry as one of its fundamental and most beautiful symbols, should begin with clearing away a little of the "rubbish of the Temple " which results from the careless writing of unlearned men. So much has been published about the Acacia which simply is not so that it is no wonder that Freemasons are frequently confused as to what the plant really is, how it came to be a symbol of immortality, and what its true place in religious history may be.

We cannot accurately denote a particular plant or tree as "the Acacia plant " or "the Acacia tree " for the same reason that we cannot accurately specify "the Rose bush " or "the pine tree. " There are too many varieties of roses, too many kinds of pine trees to distinguish one from the other merely by the definite article.

As botanists know more than four hundred and fifty varieties of Acacia, "the acacia can be only the most general of terms, meaning them all. " So perhaps it is not to be wondered at that we find one Masonic writer speaking of the "spreading leaves of the Acacia tree " and another talking of "the low thorny shrub which is the Acacia. " We have no certainty that the trees and shrubs now growing in Palestine are the same as those which flowered in Solomon's era. So that it is not impossible that "Acacia totilis (in Arabic, Essant) " and "Acacia Seyal (In Arabic Sayal) " grew to greater size three thousand years ago than they do now. But authorities doubt that the Acacia which grows low, as a bush, and which in all probability must have been the plant which one of the three plucked from the ground as the "Sprig of Acacia, " ever grew large enough to supply boards three feet wide. Wynn Westcott says: "The Acacia is the only tree of any size which grows in the deserts of Palestine, but it has been doubted that even it ever grew large enough to provide planks one and one-half cubits in width. "

Scholars are united in saying the "Shittah Tree " of the Old Testament is an Acacia; and that "Shittim ", the plural, refers to Acacia. In Joel (3-18), one of the poetic and beautiful prophecies of the Old Testament, we read:

"And it shall come to pass in that day, that the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, and all the rivers of Judah shall flow with waters, a fountain shall come forth of the house of the Lord, and shall water the valley of Shittim. "

Commentators place the "valley of Shittim " as possibly the Kidron of Ezekiel; but certainly as some dry, thirsty valley where the Acacia, which flourished where other plants perished from lack of water, was known to grow; another reason for thinking the original Acacia which Freemasons revere was the smaller shrub, rather than the large tree. Inasmuch as Akakia " in Greek signifies "Innocence, " it was wholly natural for Hutcheson (Spirit of Masonry, 1795) to connect the Masonic plant with the Greek definition. He said:

"We Masons, describing the deplorable state of religion under the Jewish Law, speak in figures; "Her Tomb was in the rubbish and filth cast forth of the Temple, and Acacia wove its branches over her monument; " "akakia " being the Greek word for innocence, or being free from sin, implying that the sins and corruptions of the old law and devotees of the Jewish altar had hid religion from those who sought her, and she was only to be found where innocence survived under the banner of the Divine Lamb; and as to ourselves, professing that we were to be distinguished by our "Acacy, " or as true "Acacians, " in our religious faith and tenets. "

It is now well understood that Hutcheson, great as is the debt we owe him, was too anxious to read a Christian interpretation into everything Masonic to be considered as infallible. While the coincidence of the Greek word our name for the Shittah-Tree is suggestive, it hardly seems sufficient to read "innocence " into the symbol when it already has so sublime a significance.

Mackey considers the acacia also as a symbol of initiation, because sacred plants were symbolical of initiation in many of the Ancient Mysteries, from which Freemasonry derived so much. The modern Masonic scholar is rather apt to pass over this meaning, he is also thinking that a symbol already so rich needs no further meanings to make it important and beautiful.

Apparently, the beginning of the association of the acacia with immortality is in the legend of Isis and Osiris, one of the oldest myths of mankind, traced back into Egypt many thousands of years before the Christian era. Its beginnings, like those of all legends which have endured, are shrouded in the mist which draws a veil between us and the days before history.

According to the legend, Osiris, who was at once both King and God of the Egyptians, and was tricked by his brother Typhon (who was very jealous of Osiris), during the King's absence on a beneficent mission to his people. Later, at a feast provided for the King-God's pleasure, Typhon brought a large chest, beautiful in workmanship, valuable in the extreme, and offered it as a gift to whoever possessed a body which best fitted the chest. When Osiris entered the box, Typhon caused the lid to shut and fastened; after which the whole was thrown into the Nile.

Currents carried it to Byblos, Phoenicia, and cast it ashore at the foot of an acacia tree. The tree grew rapidly and soon encased the chest holding the body of Osiris. When Isis, faithful queen, learned of the fate of her husband she set out in search of the body. Meanwhile the King of the Land where the acacia concealed the body, admiring the tree's beauty, cut it down and made of its trunk, a column. Learning this, Isis became nurse to the King's children and received the column as her pay. In the tree trunk, preserved, was the body of Osiris.

During their long captivity at the hands of the Egyptians; what more natural than that the Israelites should take for their own a symbol already old, and make of the "Shittah-Tree " a symbol of immortality, just as had been done in Egypt? It is perhaps too much to say that Israelites were the first to plant a sprig of acacia at the head of a grave as a symbol of immortality. But that they did so in ancient times is stated by many historians. Dalcho assigns a novel reason for this practice; that as the Codens, or Priests, were forbidden to step upon or over a grave, it was necessary that spots of internment be marked, and, the acacia being common, it was elected for the purpose.

Mackey disagrees with Dalcho as to these reasons for marking a grave with a living plant. Perhaps the origin of the custom is not important; certain it is that all peoples in almost all ages have planted or laid flowers on the graves of those they love, as a symbol of the resurrection and a future life. The lily of the modern church, the rosemary, which is for remembrance, the

sprig of acacia of the ancient Israelites and the modern Mason, have all the same meaning upon a grave - the visual expression of the dearest hope of all mankind.

It is both curious and interesting to learn that many trees, in many climes, have been symbols of immortality. India gave to Egypt the lotus, long a sacred plant; the Greeks thought the myrtle the tree of immortal life, and the mistletoe, which survives in our lives merely as a pleasant diversion at Christmas, was held by the Scandinavians and the Druids as sacred as we consider the acacia.

Association of a plant and immortality is emphasized in the New Testament - see John 12:24:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat falls into the ground and die, it abideth alone; but if it dies, it bringeth forth much fruit. "

Also, familiar passages from St. Paul (First Corinthians 15:36,37) used so much in funeral services:

"Thou fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die; and that which thou sowest, thou sowest not that body that shall be, but bare grain, it may chance of wheat, or of some other grain . . . " Finally we find in our own stately prayer in the Master's Degree, such a coupling up of a tree and life immortal; "For there is hope of a tree if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branches thereof will not cease. " - which of course, is taken from Job 14:7. Thus there is ample historical recognition of the connection between that which grows and dies and grows again, and the idea of immortality; we do not have to consider the undoubted fact that "shittah-trees " cut to form beams of house, often sprouted branches even when they had no roots, nor our own thought of almost any variety of pine as "the evergreen, or ever living " tree, to see that there is much background behind the symbol.

It is one of the glories of Freemasonry that so much has been made of the symbol, so dear and deep a meaning vested in it, that it has almost equaled the square as Freemasonry's nearest and dearest. All that was mortal on Tyrian lay murdered in a grave "dug six feet due east and west. " The genius of the Temple was no more. No more designs upon the trestleboard; no more glorious architecture to come from that mighty brain; no more holding of meetings with Solomon and Hiram in the Sanctum Sanctorum - the Widow's Son was dead!

Of those who search one finds a sprig of acacia. Oh, immortal story; thrice immortal ritual makers, who coupled together a resurrection and a sprig of green! True, he whose mother was of the Tribe of Naphtali was destroyed, but his genius lived, his spirit marched on, his virtues were recorded in stone and in the hearts of those who built on Mt. Moriah's heights.

For at least two hundred years and probably much longer the sprig of acacia has held Freemasonry's premier teaching. The grave is not the end. Bodies die and decay, but something "which bears the nearest affinity to that which pervades all nature and which never, never, dies, " rises from the grave to become one of that vast throng which has preceded us. Error can slay, as can evil and selfish greed, but not permanently. That which is true and fair and fine cannot be destroyed. Its body may be murdered, its disappearance may be effected, the rubbish of the Temple and a temporary grave may conceal it for a time, but where is interred that which is mortal, there grows an evergreen or ever living sprig of acacia - acacia none the less that it may be a spiritual sprig, a plant not of the earth, earthly.

When he who was weary, plucked at a sprig of acacia, he had "evidence of things not seen. " When we toss the little sprig of evergreen which is our usual cemetery "sprig of acacia " into the open grave of one of our brethren who has stepped ahead upon the path we all must tread, we give evidence of belief in a "thing not seen. "

For never a man has seen the spirit of one who has gone, or visioned the land where no shadows are. If we see it in our dreams, we see by faith, not eyes. But we can see the acacia - we can look back through the dragging years to the legend of Osiris and think that even as the acacia grew about his body to protect it until Isis might find it, so does the acacia of Freemasonry bloom above the casket from which, in the solemn words of Ecclesiastes "the spirit shall return unto God who gave it. "

SUBLIME

by: Unknown

Learned students of art have discovered that the word "Sublime " as applied to the degree of Master Mason is not one of those matters which are of an antiquity of "Time Immemorial." It seems to have made its appearance in print first about 1801. Today, its use is practically universal.

That the degree "Is" sublime, in all the highest meanings of that much abused word, is not a matter for discussion or proof; it is sublime if we feel it as sublime; it is just an ordinary ceremony if that is all it is to us. Sublimity is not in the thing, but in us.

The Forty-Seventh Problem of Euclid in its absolute perfection is sublime to a mathematician, to a six year old child or a savage who cannot count beyond ten, it is less than nothing. The most beautiful sunset which ever thrilled the senses of color could not be sublime to a blind man, nor can harmonies of Beethoven or Wagner be sublime to a man born deaf. If the Master Mason degree is sublime, it is because of what it is and what it does to a man's heart.

The Master Mason's degree is immensely different from the two preceding ones. It has the same externals as far as entry and closing are concerned; it uses also a circumambulation, a passage from Scripture, has an obligation and a bringing to more light - "All The Light Which Can Be Communicated To You In A Blue Lodge." But its second section departs utterly from the architectural symbolism of the first two degrees, and concerns itself with a living, a dying and a living again. It is at once more human and more spiritual than the preceding degrees. It strikes in upon the heart with the force and effect of a great bell, heard in a silent place; no thoughtful man receives, or ever sees this degree, with any understanding of its symbolism, who does not feel a sense of awe and wonder that a mind of man could conceive it, put it together, place so much of wisdom in so simple a vehicle, give so much light in so few words and in so short a time.

The Master's degree as whole is a symbol of old age; of wisdom and experience. It is a symbol of preparation for that other life which it so grandly promises. It brings to the initiate the symbolism of the Sprig of Acacia, and tells him in one breath that a man must stand alone, even while he must lean

upon the Everlasting Arms. It lays before him the whole drama of man's longing for a Something Beyond; it tells the tale of what ignorance and brute strength may do to destroy knowledge and virtue, even while it shows that, never can darkness overcome light, never can evil win over what is good, never can error prevail over truth.

There are those who find in the symbolism of the Third Degree a promise of the resurrection of the body. None can blame them; the symbolism is there. Nor can one blame the miner who digs in the earth after the outcroppings of an ore, for believing that the ore is all he can expect to find; even when a later delver in the earth goes through the ore and finds a diamond. If, to a devout and orthodox Christian the Master Mason degree is symbolic of the resurrection of the body, that doctrine of bodily resurrection is in itself a symbol of a spiritual raising. Each of us, then, may interpret this part of the degree in according to the light which is given him, and no man has either the wisdom or the right to say, "That Interpretation is True, This One False."

There have been some twenty or more interpretations of the whole degree; they range all the way from the story of the Garden of Eden to a sort of cipher drama of the violent death of King Charles the First. Modern students, however, are reasonably well agreed that the Hiram Legend is a retelling of the immortality of the soul; it belongs with the story of Isis and Osiris, and the most beautiful of the early religious myths, the Brahminic story of Ademi and Heva. Thus interpreted, the soul, mind or spirit; after it acquires knowledge, is subjected to temptation. It must bargain with conditions, make a pact with evil, compromise with reality, or suffer. Every life demonstrates the truth of this; we are all tempted to compromise with the best that is in us for the sake of expediency. Not infrequently, we, as did a Certain Three, think to win knowledge, power, place, and reward for themselves; not by patient effort, but by force alone.

In the sublime degree there is no compromise. Those who seek unlawfully are bidden to wait until they are found worthy . . . but there is no suggestion of yielding to their importunity if they will not. Nor do they wait. For a time, it appears that force is superior to righteousness, that evil can overcome good. But only for a time. And while, indeed, That Which Was Lost has never been recovered, yet the manner of its losing has been an inspiration to all men in their search for it ever since; a just retribution overtook the evil and the consequences of wrong doing are set forth unequivocally.

It is difficult to write about that which is sublime, translate it into words of everyday, and at the same time comply with the statutory requirements. All Master Masons will forgive the seeming vagueness of these references; indeed, they should not find them vague. But in any attempt to translate the symbolism into words, it loses in two ways; first, as any symbol must lose (can you describe a rose so that it appears beautiful or put the majesty of a mountain or the magnitude of the ocean in a phrase?); second, because the appeal of the symbol is to the heart, the soul or the spirit; when one attempts to make of it also an appeal to the mind, the spirit symbolism becomes clouded over with materiality; the bloom is gone from the petal; the butterfly is crushed.

The moral lessons in the degree are many; the virtue of loyalty is most obvious and, perhaps, least important, symbolically. That truth wins in the end; that evil does not flourish; that strength of heart is greater than strength of arm; that it is by the spirit of brotherhood, not by one man alone, that which has fallen can be raised; that in his greatest extremity man has but One to Whom to turn; that beyond brotherhood the soul stands always, and must always stand, alone before God, when no prayers save its own may avail; That he who would win true brotherhood must give proof of his fitness to be a brother; these, and many more can be read from the degree by the most casual minded.

But there is a deeper lesson, for him who is minded to dig far enough. There are certain matters which can be proved by logic, and by experiment. Thus, we know not only by vision, by experience and by counting on the fingers that two added to two make four, but also by demonstrating this fact by mathematics.

It is entirely obvious to all scientists that the laws of nature are constant; they do not vary between here and there. But it is not demonstrable! We are confident that the laws of motion and gravitation as we see them demonstrated on earth and in the solar system, are the same in some far off planet of an unknown sun, in some other solar system of the existence of which we do not even know. But we cannot prove it.

In this sense we cannot prove either God or Immortality. A God who could be proved to a finite mind by a finite means would be a finite God, and The Great Architect we believe to be infinite. The crux of the whole controversy between those who profess a science and those who profess a religion, has been over this demand on the part of those scientists that

religion reduce God to figures and prove Him by a Rule; while the follower of a religion founded entirely on faith demands that the scientist forego his reason and believe without proof!

In other words, one all Mind demands that one all Soul work and talk wholly in terms of Mind. One all Soul insists that Mind forget its reason and its logic and deal wholly in belief and faith. But a man is not only Mind, nor is he only Immortal Soul.

The ego is made up of both. When they become at war with each other we have either a religious fanatic or an atheist. Luckily for most of us, there is no conflict; we believe the things of the heart because of proofs the mind cannot understand, just as we know the demonstrable truths of science with expositions which mean nothing to a heart.

The esoteric meaning the Sublime Degree of Master Mason is not at all for the mind. To the mind it is not a proof of anything. But it truly is the Forty Seventh Problem of Euclid of the heart!

As that strange and wonderful mathematic wonder contains the germ of all scientific measurement, so does the symbolism of the Third Degree contain the germ of all doctrines of immortality, all beliefs in a hereafter, all heart certainty of a beneficent Creator Who has us in His Holy Keeping.

There have been those who, fearing that Freemasonry was about to set up a doctrine and a church to teach it, have frowned upon Freemasonry because of this symbolism. But note carefully, there is not in all the Master Mason Degree any suggestion of creed or dogma or even of a "Way to Heaven." The Mohammedan who believes that the way to Allah is to kill a Christian or two, will find no contradiction of his queer faith in the Master Masons degree. The Christian who sincerely believes that only by Baptism can he be "Saved" will find nothing in the Master Mason degree to hurt that faith. The Spiritualist who feels that unseen friends are waiting to receive him and carry him forward, can be a good Master Mason. The Third Degree teaches not how to win immortality, not how to get to heaven, not any particular way to worship the Great Architect; it teaches that immortality is; that God is; and leaves to others the fitting of those ineffable truths into what frames they please.

How could the degree be otherwise than sublime? It contains the greatest thought, the most intense hope, the most sincere prayer which all mankind possesses. From the dawn of humanity man has tried to see God.

He has believed in God. He has struggled toward the light, often stumbling, often failing; but always stretching forth hands upward, winning his slow way to a little better spiritual comprehension of the Great Mystery.

The Sublime degree of Master Mason is at once a promise and a performance; an exposition and a demonstration; a doing and a believing of the loftiest aspirations in the heart of humanity. Of course, it is sublime; and, equally of course, many who fail to see its inner meaning do not find it so. The beauty of the unseen sunset is there only for eyes which can see. The man who finds the degree otherwise than sublime must blame the man, not the degree. For it is not of the earth, earthy; there is in this ceremony and its simple but awful words, something as much beyond the minds of the generations of men who made it, as there is in its mystery. Something Beyond the comprehension of those who give it, and they, fortunate among men . . . who receive it and take it to their hearts.

TOOLS

by: Unknown



Power is the ability to act so as to produce change and cause events. Purpose is the idea or object kept before the mind as an end of effort or action.

Modern science has uncovered so much power that thoughtful men fear it will work for the destruction of civilization unless a commensurate humane purpose is developed for its direction. The day and generation in which we live pulsates with power, the world is held in place by dynamic appositions, the universe is vibrant with force and man is a part of the Divine energy. The greatest thing in God's created universe is man. In him, according to the teachings of Freemasonry, is the Eternal Flame, the indestructible image of the living God. The power of man cannot be defined, cannot be fenced in, because it transcends all finite standards of measurement.

Power directed by a bad purpose is positive destruction. Alexander the Great was the most powerful man of antiquity. With an Army of 35,000 men he flung himself against a Persian horde of over one million. He conquered the world, but could not master himself. Intent on lust and luxury, dissipation and destruction, his purposes were bad, and at the age of forty-two he died in a drunken fit. Charles the First of England insisted on the Divine right of Kings. He had his courts decree that the King could do no wrong, he filled the Tower of London with political prisoners, tortured and decapitated his enemies, claimed the right of life and death over his subjects. and exercised the unlimited power of an absolute monarch. His purposes were bad, and under Oliver Cromwell his career was canceled, the executioner swung his axe and the head of Charles the First rolled in the dust.

These were unusual men occupying exceptional positions, but the power of destruction is terrific in the most ordinary life. Czolgocz, the Polish anarchist, was a man of low order in the social scale; without wealth, without influence and without education; from the casual viewpoint ignorant, insignificant and weak. His mind was a breeding ground of crazy purposes, but he had sufficient destructive power to shoot William McKinley and assassinate the Chief Magistrate of the greatest nation on earth.

Power directed by a good purpose is constructive, and results in achievement. It keeps the cars on the tracks and the wires in the air; it turns the wheels of man's industry and carries the commerce of continents as upon a mighty shoulder.

Warren Hastings was born in 1832; his mother was a servant girl who died when the baby was two days old; his father deserted him, so he grew up as a charity child. He had a hungry mind and obtained an education as best he could. When eighteen years of age he shipped for India, working for his own passage. He had a purpose in his life and there came a power that enabled him to establish the Bengal Asiatic Society, to found colleges out of his own funds and in his own name. Disraeli and English supremacy in India was the direct result of this man's work. Today the memory of Warren Hastings is linked with the greatness of the British Empire.

David Livingston was a humble Scotchman, the son of a weaver and himself a worker at the spinning wheel. Into his soul there came a great purpose of life, and he went to South Africa as a missionary. He was frail of body, never physically strong, but with a purpose there came to him a power to brave danger and endure privations. For a period of twenty years he blazed a trail of light through a dark continent, destroyed the slave trade in Negroes, and convinced the world that the salvation of Africa was a white man's job. In that commission he surrendered his life on his knees in supplication to God. His body was carried thousands of miles by a black man through jungles, over rivers, across land and seas; last summer at West Minster Abbey I stood before his mortal remains buried and honored in the sepulcher of Kings.

In his early manhood Abraham Lincoln stood before a slave market in New Orleans. Upon the block was a young woman, stripped to the waist. He heard the auctioneer describe her fine points and estimate her value. He became conscious, not simply of a black form, but a life divinely given. His soul responded to the challenge of a supreme purpose and he said: "If I have a chance to strike this institution, I will strike it hard." Through the years there came to him the power to blaze out the path and light up the way for a new baptism of human freedom, finally to seal that purpose with a martyr's blood and ascend to the throne of God with four million broken fetters in his hands. Now the whole world joins in a myriad-voiced chorus of love and honor to his memory. In every land and under every clime he is exalted and glorified as a mighty champion of human rights.

History preserves in the clear amber of immortality the record of men, who, set on fire by some sublime purpose and dedicate the power of their lives to its prosecution.

The lesson is definite and practical. The twenty-four inch gauge and the common gavel speak to every Mason the language of constructive purpose and personal power. They mean that a Mason should cherish his ideals, the beauty that forms in his mind, the music that stirs in his heart, the glory that drapes his purest purpose, for out of these things he has the power to build for himself and a new world in which to live.

FELLOWCRAFT

The Level is an instrument used by operative Masons to prove horizontals. It is trite to say that it is a symbol of equality. The Declaration of American Independence proclaims that all men are "Created Equal." With most of us this is a glittering generality, born of the fact that we are all made of the same dust, share a common humanity and walk on the level of time until the grim democracy of death blots out all distinctions, and the scepter of the prince and the staff of the beggar are laid side by side.

It is apparent that men are not equal, and cannot be equal either in brain or brawn. There is no common mold by which humanity can be reduced to a dead level. The world has various demands requiring different powers; brains to devise great and important undertakings; seers to dream dreams and behold visions; hands to execute the designs laid down upon the Trestleboard; scientists to adorn the mind and reveal the glories of the universe; poets to inspire the soul and play music on human heart strings; pioneers to blaze out the path, and prophets to light up the way to a land where the rainbow never fades.

The equality of which the Level is a symbol is one of right and not one of gift and endowment. It stands for the equal right of every man to life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness; the equal right of every man to be free from oppression in the development of his own faculties. It means the destruction of special privilege and arbitrary limitation.

Freemasonry presided over the birth of our Republic and by the skill of its leaders wrote into organic law of this land the immutable truth of which the Level is a symbol. In a Masonic Lodge George Washington was taught that the Level is a symbol of equality. In the darkest hour of the Colonial cause, the soldiers, in a moment of despair and desperation, would have placed on

Washington's head the crown of a King. Hayden says, "The overthrow of the rump of Parliament by Cromwell, the breaking up of the imbecile directory by Napoleon were difficult tasks compared to the ease with which the divided Continental Congress could have been dispersed." Washington was not fighting for Royal Rank, nor for coronation. As a champion of human rights, he was fighting for exact justice and equality of opportunity, and so the kingship and the crown were rejected with indignation and contempt.

I remember reading a story of the great flood that came upon the Ohio. In the gray of the morning some men saw a house floating down the river and on its top a human being. Going to the rescue, they found a woman whose life they wished to save, but she said, "No! In this house I have three dead babies I will not desert; I am going out with them." To most of us that act would verge on the immorality of suicide; to her it was the expression of a mother's love deeper than despair and death; her conduct corresponded with her conscience. We cannot place ourselves in her circumstances and in charity should refrain from judgment.

Jean Valjan was a great hulk of a man, young and strong, ignorant and big hearted, tramping the streets of Paris in search of work, trying to care for a widowed sister and her family of seven little ones. There was no work to be had. He could not bear to hear the voices of starving children so he came home late at night, thinking they would be sleep. But hunger gnawed, and when he came in, they were wide-awake and cried, Oh Uncle Jean, have you any work? Oh, Uncle Jean, we are so hungry!" Madness seized the man; he went to the nearest bakery, broke the window and stole a loaf of bread. Jean was arrested and sent to Toulon as a galley slave. In the eyes of the law he had committed the immoral act of theft. But his eyes saw pinched-up faces, his ears heard cries of hunger and, regardless of consequences, his conduct corresponded with his conscience in a deed of moral heroism.

Back of all the temporary circumstances and conditions of men and transitory moral codes evolved by human minds are certain positive standards of morality which the Divine Intelligence has impressed upon every particle of matter and every pulsation of energy. They are the same for all mankind, regardless of place, time, race or religion. Of these standards the try-square is the Masonic mouthpiece. Freemasonry is defined as a beautiful system of morality.

It is a woven tapestry of great moral principles and purposes. Whenever a Mason fails to live up to the best that is in him, whenever he blots out the

Divine light of his conscience, whenever he is recreant to right as God gives him to see the right, he is false to the trying square of his profession, for by this symbol Freemasonry teaches a morality that masters manners, molds mind and makes mighty manhood.

The plumb is an instrument used by operative Masons to try perpendiculars. In speculative Freemasonry it is a symbol of righteousness, that is, an upright life before God and man. It has been said that, in the art of building, accuracy is integrity. If a wall not be perpendicular, as tested by the plumb line, it is a menace to the stability of the structure. Likewise if a Mason is ignorant of this symbol as an active principle in his life, he is a danger to the standing of the Fraternity in the community where he lives.

Righteousness is not a sanctimonious word. It means rectitude of conduct, integrity of character, and deathless devotion to the truth. The Psalmist asked, "Lord, who shall abide in Thy Tabernacle?" and this was his answer: "He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness and speaketh the truth in his heart." When correctly understood, the truth symbolized by the Plumb constitutes a challenge to courage.

In the sixteenth century Giordano Bruno taught a plurality of worlds; for this he was accused of heresy. He was tried, convicted and imprisoned in a dungeon for seven years. He was offered his liberty if he would recant, but Bruno refused to stain the sanctity of his soul by denying that which he believed to be true. He was taken from his cell and led to the place of his execution, clad in a robe on which representations of devils had been painted. He was chained to a stake, about his body wood was piled, fagots were lighted and on the spot in Rome where a monument now stands to his memory he was consumed by the flames. Without the hope of heaven or the fear of hell he suffered death for the naked truth that was in him. The Great Light of Freemasonry contains this promise:

"The righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance." Men of tremendous power, men of creative genius have passed into oblivion, but the righteousness of pure and noble character, of unselfish and Divinely inspired life finds perpetuation in the clear amber of immortality. Of the righteousness the Plumb is a symbol in Freemasonry.

Unrighteousness has wrought the destruction of peoples and civilizations, but "Righteousness exalteth a nation." Symbols are not academic playthings; they are intended to provoke and sustain thought.

Fellowcraft Working Tools present to the mind basic ideas of equality, morality and righteousness.

MASTER MASON

All the implements of Masonry are assigned to the use of the Master Mason. The principal one is the Trowel, an instrument used by operative Masons to spread the cement which unites the building into one common mass. In Speculative Freemasonry it is a symbol of brotherhood.

Paul stood on the Mars Hill and said to the Athenians, "God hath made of one blood every nation of men." That is not an expression of sentiment but the announcement of a fact, whether men desire or deny it, whether men cherish it in their hearts or crucify it. Man's ignorance does not change the laws of nature nor vary their irresistible march. God's laws vindicate themselves; they crush all who oppose and break into pieces everything that is not in harmony with their purpose. In the light of this truth it can be safely asserted that no nation, no civilization can long endure which does violence to the Divine fact of human brotherhood.

Fraternity is the basis of all-important movements for the common good and the general welfare of society. Freemasonry has been called a "society of friends and brothers employing symbols to teach the truth." The Trowel is a Masonic symbol of love, and with it we are to spread the cement of brotherly affection. Next to faith in God, the greatest landmark in Freemasonry is the "Brotherhood of Man." We call each other "Brother," but we sometimes fail to realize that brotherhood is a reciprocal relationship. It means that if I am to be a brother to you, then you must be a brother to me. It is exceedingly practical; is it not only for grateful gifts and happy hours, but for use when the soul is sad, when the heart is pierced and pained, when the road is rough and rugged, and the way seems desolate and dreary. The sentiment of brotherhood in a man's heart is a futile thing unless he can find avenues for its external expression. So far as I have been able to discover, there are three such avenues.

The first is sympathy. Not intellectual sympathy that passes by on the other side of the street and expresses sorrow, but a red-blooded sympathy that lifts a man up who has fallen down and speaks the light of a new hope into his face. Dr. Hillis said that sympathy is the measure of a man's intellectual power. Sympathy is more than this; it is a measure of a man's heartthrob and soul vision. The great painters, poets, preachers, physicians

and patriots whose names illuminate the pages of history, excelled their contemporaries in this one quality of human sympathy.

The second avenue is service. I have read somewhere, most likely in one of the writings of Dr. Joseph Fort Newton, a statement that all over the vast Temple of Freemasonry, from foundation stone to the highest pinnacle, is inscribed in letters of living light the Divine truth that labor is love, that work is worship and that not indolence but industry is the crowning glory of a man's life whether he be rich or poor. In all the annals of human progress the men who have accomplished works which have lived after them, which have come up through cycles of time a blessing to succeeding generations, had not before their eyes Gold or Fame, or Selfish aims or Sordid gain; but had hung upon the walls of their minds great ideals of human service to which they remained devoted until the light faded and the day closed.

The third avenue is sacrifice, the most radiant word in the history of our race. The sacrifices of father and mother for the education of the child, the sacrifices of son and daughter for the old folks back home, the sacrifices of the patriot for the homeland and the Flag, the sacrifices of the great servants of humanity; have through the ages made music in the souls of men. He who would take sacrifice out of human life would steal from maternity its sacred sweetness, expunge the wrinkles from the face of Abraham Lincoln, and obliterate the stripes of red in our National Flag.

Every advance in civilization involves a victim.

Before the progress of the world stands an Altar and on it a sacrifice.

Back in the centuries Socrates, with a cup of hemlock poison to his lips, offered himself upon the Altar of human sacrifice for the Divine right of liberty in man.

The words of Patrick Henry before the Virginia Assembly: "The next gale that blows from the north will bring to our ears the resounding clash of arms. I know not what course others may take, but as for me, give me liberty or give me death," lifted the soul of Colonial America up to the coronation of a supreme sacrifice and made this Republic of the West a possibility.

In the world crisis, American soldiers and sailors, as the champions of civilization, laid their all, their hopes, their aspirations, their ambitions, their home ties and affections upon the altar of human sacrifice to insure our National safety, defend our National honor, and vindicate the ideals of American independence on the battlefields of Flanders and France.

In a little country school I was taught that our National Flag stands for the graves of men and the tears of women, for untrammelled conscience and free institutions, for sacred memories and great ideals; that its red stands for the blood that bought it, its white for the purity of the motive that caused it to be shed, its blue for loyalty ascending to the sky, and its stars for deeds of bravery brighter than the stars of a faultless night. But when I think of George Washington and Gen. Joseph Warren, and Capt. John Paul Jones, and that heroic band of Masonic patriots in the American Revolution, and cast the utility of our Craft against the background of its history, I can see its stripes of red baptized in the sacrificial blood of our Fraternity, and its stars of glory illuminated by the deathless light that shines from a Masonic Altar.

In Freemasonry we are familiar with the ancient drama of sacrifice made in the name of faith, fortitude and fidelity.

These three; sympathy, service and sacrifice are the avenues for the external expression of the sentiment of brotherhood in man's heart. In proportion as we are inspired by this ideal and use these avenues of expression, our Fraternity will contribute to human good and happiness, and answer the end of its institution.

Tools have been called "The evangelists of a new day."

They are teachers not less than college and cathedral. Just as the Twenty-four inch Gauge and Common Gavel stand for purpose and power; the Level, Square and Plumb present basic ideas of equality, morality and righteousness; so, the Trowel is Freemasonry's symbol of unity and brotherhood among men.

THE "OTHER" WORKING TOOLS -- THE CHISEL, THE SKIRRET, AND THE PENCIL

By Jorge Sanchez

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The preponderance of triads, or sets of three items, strikes the newly made Mason. In Freemasonry, there seems to be three of everything: three Degrees, three Principal Officers, three Greater Lights, three Lesser Lights, three Immovable Jewels; the list could go on and on. In fact, Freemasonry abounds in so many symbolic triads it is even more striking when a set of Masonic symbols does not come in a group of three. In most U. S. jurisdictions, there are three working tools only in the Fellow Craft Degree; the Entered Apprentice degree has two working tools, and the Master Mason Degree but one. In other countries, notably other English-speaking countries, each Degree has a triad of working tools. Under the United Grand Lodge of England, and in most English-speaking Lodges which work Emulation or some similar or related ritual, the third working tool of an Entered Apprentice is the Chisel, and the Master Mason's working tools are the Skirret, the Pencil and the Compasses.

Why this difference? In 1832, a meeting known to Masonic history as the Baltimore Convention changed many key practices of U. S. Masonry due to the anti-Masonic sentiments caused by the Morgan Affair. Most Grand Lodges in the English speaking world -- in Canada, Australia, and elsewhere - - are descended from the Grand Lodge of Scotland or the United Grand Lodge of England, and so many Masonic practices in the English-speaking world are very similar; the differences occur in the United States. These "other" masonries have other working tools, which teach important lessons; without considering them, our Masonic journey is truly incomplete. This paper will look at the working tools of the First and Third Degree, paying special attention to the Chisel, the Skirret, and the Pencil, with a discussion of the Trowel, which will be of interest to Canadian brethren.

Under the United Grand Lodge of England, the first two working tools of the Entered Apprentice-- the 24-inch Gauge and the Common Gavel -- are the same as in the United States. It is important to note, that although the explanation of the 24-inch Gauge is very similar to what Masons in the United States know, the explanation of the Common Gavel is slightly different in another Grand Jurisdiction: Scotland. The Scottish ritual explains the Gavel "teaches us that skill without exertion is of little avail, that labour is the lot of man, for the heart may conceive, and the head may devise in vain, if the hand be not prompt to execute the design." This is an interesting contrast to the more commonly known interpretation of the Common Gavel as serving to "divest the heart and soul of the vices and superfluities of life," the Scottish Gavel explanation emphasizes the need for exertion and effort in a timely manner to accomplish our goals.

Although the 24-inch Gauge and the Common Gavel may be familiar to U. S. Craft Masons, the Chisel is not. Emulation ritual explains that the Chisel "points out to us the advantages of education, by which means alone we are rendered fit members of regularly organized Society." This equation of the chisel with education is especially interesting, since we often think of education as a cumulative endeavor, through which we amass certain knowledge, skills, and qualifications. The Chisel, of course, is a tool of great sharpness that cleaves unnecessary rock from the usable stone. The idea that education might pare away the unnecessary while leaving us with only what is vital is a profound and almost paradoxical idea that merits contemplation. Oddly, the chisel seems to be a tool of paradoxes: small, yet powerful; emblematic of education by elimination, and not accumulation. It makes sense, though, when you consider the paradoxical nature of a candidate's preparation: "neither naked nor clad, barefoot nor shod," and, I would add, unable to see and yet not lost. The chisel points, in some sense, to the paradoxical nature of life: just as we "neither naked nor clad, barefoot nor shod," can be small, yet powerful.

The three English Working Tools of a Master Mason are wholly foreign to the American Mason. Although the Compasses has special significance to the Master Mason, the Emulation ritual ascribes and reinforces the use of this valuable tool as taught to the Entered Apprentice in the United States. Emulation states that "the Compasses remind us of [God's] unerring and impartial justice, Who, having defined for our instruction the limits of good and evil, will reward or punish as we have obeyed or disregarded His Divine

commands." The circumscribing aspect of the Compasses is here reiterated, with a special emphasis on the idea of justice, and that if we fail to subdue our passions we will be judged for it, even if we escape earthly punishment.

As stated before, while the Compasses are familiar to every Master Mason in the United States, the Skirret and Pencil are not, but neither are their lessons only apt for those who have been raised to the Sublime Degree. The Emulation ritual explains that the Skirret "is an implement which acts on a centre pin, whence a line is drawn to mark out ground for the foundation of the intended structure." This is the operative use of the Skirret, and the ritual goes on to explain that, for the speculative mason, "the Skirret points out that straight and undeviating line of conduct laid down for our pursuit in the Volume of Sacred Law."

The Skirret is a tool to be used in the preparations for laying a foundation. It is similar to a spool of thread with a handle. The loose end of the thread has a loop or ring which will catch the centre pin. The Skirret's thread is allowed to unwind and is kept taut. Once the desired length is reached, a piece of chalk or other marking implement may be used to mark the foundation, the Skirret's thread keeping the chalk in a straight line all the while. It serves a similar purpose to a ruler used when drawing a straight line on a piece of paper. The genius of the Skirret is, in part, its versatility. With the thread wound up, it takes up little space, and could even be carried in the pocket of an apron. When the Skirret's thread is affixed to a centre pin and allowed to unwind, it becomes longer than any practicable ruler or straightedge could be, and just as sure. When we consider these qualities in relation to the Volume of Sacred Law, the Skirret becomes the tool which helps us to understand how the Volume of Sacred Law applies to our own lives. Most of the Volumes of the Sacred Law -- be it the Bible, Tanach, Koran, Vedas, Zend Avesta -- were written millennia ago, in cultures and contexts very different from our contemporary world. And yet we are instructed that the Volume of the Sacred Law as "the rule and guide of our faith." How do we apply the stories and laws of ancient books to our daily life? Through the use of reason and faith, which is here represented by the Skirret.

The third working tool of the Third Degree is the Pencil. For many of us, the pencil was the first writing implement we took into our hands. After playing with finger-paints and crayons, our first arithmetic and writing lessons were done with a pencil. The Canadian Rite ritual explains that the pencil "teaches us that all our words and actions are not only observed but

recorded by the Most High, to whom we must render an account of our conduct through life." The pencil reminds us that our actions not only have consequences on earth but also write a record of our conduct by which we will ultimately be judged. If we look at the Pencil more literally, it is, like the Compasses and Skirret, a tool of planning. The Compasses and Pencil can be used to draw designs upon the Trestleboard, and the Skirret then helps the Master Mason prepare the ground for the foundation, before the first Fellow Craft tries the first squared stone, even before the first Apprentice descends to the quarry with gauge, gavel, and chisel in hand. As Masters, we are now overseers of the work -- we are Masters not just of the Craft, but of ourselves. Apprentices are rough ashlar, selected for the building but completely unprepared, unworked. Fellow Crafts are perfect ashlar, made ready by the hands of the workmen and tried by the plumb, square, and level. Masters, however, are stones ready to become part of the building itself. A Master, ideally, has subdued his passions, learned his work, and is now complete. Masonry, if done correctly, will have done its work on the Master, and then the Master takes a step back, to guide the Apprentices and Fellow Crafts; he is part of the Temple, and he will now direct the rest of the Temple to be built. In the same way, Masters are expected to be able to oversee the work of building the Temple in their own souls. It is no longer sufficient to chip away upon the stone, or to try ourselves by Fellow Craft's tools; now, as Masters, we must actively plan and contemplate the building, using the Compasses, Skirret, and Pencil.

Although the Third Degree is the culmination and completion of the Craft Degrees, we see many times in the ritual suggestions that the Third Degree is also a degree of commencement, and of a return to the beginning or foundation of our Masonic journey. The Compasses, Skirret, and Pencil are the tools used before all others. They are tools of planning and design; we are masters of that which we can control; as Masters, we ought to be stones, tried and true, fitting and ready for the Temple, while also helping govern the craft with wisdom, providing strength and support for the other workmen, and adorning the Craft with the beauty of the fine work we will leave behind.

The Trowel is the Master Mason's unique working tool in the United States, he being invested with all the implements of Masonry as well. The ritual tells us that operative Masons used it "to spread the cement that unites the building into one common mass," and that speculative Masonry uses it "to spread the cement of brotherly love and affection which unites us into one

sacred band or society of friends and brothers, among whom should exist no contention, except that noble contention, or rather, emulation, of who best can work and best agree." Considered so, the Trowel is an excellent complement to the Compasses, Skirret, and Pencil. While the Compasses, Skirret, and Pencil are used before the first stone is hewn, the Trowel is used to complete the building, both literally and symbolically, uniting the stones and the brethren as well as the disparate elements which make up our very selves.

If the Entered Apprentice's degree symbolizes the physical and the Fellow Craft's degree the spiritual, with the Master Mason's degree introducing some sense of balance, then it would make sense that the complete complement of a Master's working tools would be tools both of beginning, which the 24-inch Gauge, Gavel, Chisel, Compasses, Skirret, and Pencil all are, and tools of finishing, which the Plumb, Square, Level, and Trowel are.

In most English, Canadian, Australian, and Scottish lodges, the trowel is unknown, and in American Lodges, Pencils are absent and Skirrets unidentifiable. Although we all share a common Masonic heritage, these differences indicate a diversity of Masonic practice. One of the greatest things about Masonry is the chance to travel, both within our own jurisdictions and within the greater Masonic world. These are just a few of the differences that we can notice if we travel to a Canadian Rite lodge, or a lodge working Emulation ritual in downtown London.

Canadian Rite lodges would be well-served to consider the Trowel, just as lodges in the United States would profit from considering Compasses, Skirret, and Plumb. In many ways, the best set of working tools for the Master Mason would be all four: tools of planning as well as tools of completion, since Master Masons must oversee the construction of the Temple from start to finish, from the laying of the first stone in the North East comer, to the final touches that complete the edifice of our Temple, our Craft, our lodges, and ourselves.

THE WORKING TOOLS

MASONIC EDUCATION COURSE

From: SONS OF LIGHT by K. Linton

Developed by W. Bro. Kent Henderson

Dip. T., B. Ed., Grad. Cert. Ed., Grad. Dip. Ed., M. Ed, Diploma of Masonic Education (5th. Aust.) Past Junior Grand Deacon, A. F. & A. Masons of Victoria, Australia.

There are three working tools in each of the three degrees, referring to the three phases in man's nature. This emphasis is repeated right throughout our three degrees: three degrees. three principal officers, three movable jewels, three ornaments, three pieces of furniture, three pillars and three ruffians.

Each of the nine tools has a moral significance: the Twenty-four Inch Gauge, the Common Gavel and the Chisel of the First Degree are the tools of preparation; the Square, Level and Plumb Rule of the Second Degree are the tools of proof; the Skirret, Pencil and Compasses of the Third Degree are the tools of plan.

First, the workman, knowing little of the ultimate design, has to learn the use of the tools of preparation which enables him to shape the stone. The skilled craftsman. knowing what is required by the plan, has to test the work, and for this purpose he must have a full knowledge of the tools of proof; the Master has to prepare the plan for the skilled craftsman, and for this purpose he uses the tools of plan.

The apprentice takes the rough stone from the quarry and on it he uses the tools of preparation to achieve the Rough Ashlar. The craftsman takes the Rough Ashlar and under his skillful hand It becomes the Perfect Ashlar and is placed in the building according to the plan of the Master.

Each of us are the living stones, which are to form the Temple not made with hands, and so that the Temple may be perfect, each one of us has to be so, for the Temple will only be as good as the stones that form it. Masonry is more than a ritual; it is a way of living. It offers us a method and a plan, by which we may build a character so strong and true that nothing, not even death, can destroy it. If we act justly, love mercy and walk humbly before God, then we can serenely await the solemn moment when we must quit this transitory scene with a clear conscience and a trust in the mercy of God.

The Twenty-four Inch Gauge represents the twenty-four hours of the day, part to be spent in prayer to Almighty God, part in labour and refreshment and part in serving a friend or brother in time of need, without detriment to ourselves or connections. This is a reminder to the Initiate that he is mortal, that he has so many years of life, with so many days to each year, and so many hours to each day. It is only the immortals that do not have to concern themselves with time, for to them it no longer exists; for us mortals each day has twenty-four hours. Later we may learn the secrets of immortality, but first we must make full use of our mortality. In other words, time and space are given to us with all their limitations to prepare ourselves for the ampler freedom of afterlife. Time is but the gateway to eternity, and by learning to use our time, we prepare ourselves for eternity.

The first lesson for the Initiate is time, and how to use it, and that time is divided into three parts: for God, for our neighbour and for ourselves. The first is emphasised throughout our ritual; we put our trust in God, our Lodge opens and closes with prayer. Prayer is the alpha and omega, the beginning and the end, but we must not stop at prayer, the definite act of homage to the Great Architect, but carry out His will through the whole day.

The second is our duty to our neighbour, and that does not mean to take good care of ourselves and if we have a few crumbs left over to scatter them to the poor. It means that we give and go on giving to our neighbour, but do not make our own family suffer in consequence of that giving. In other words, remember our neighbour, but do not neglect our own family in the process. The words "without detriment to yourself or connections" have been quite a stumbling block, and the cause of deprecation among superficial thinkers. It is, however, only superficial thought that is scandalised. There must be some order in the fulfilment of our obligations, and a man has no right to neglect his family in order to wear a jewel, even of Masonic charity. And giving does not mean just giving cash out of a large superfluity. There is no real gift without the giver feeling it. There are many different kinds of gifts; some have cash from their pocket, others have advice, encouragement and sympathy from the heart, and others again may provide help in some sort of practical work or service.

Our duty to ourselves has two parts: Work and refreshment. Without work the gifts that we have been given are wasted -- the great gifts of talent of mind and body, which have been entrusted to our keeping. The finest steel will rust and lose its temper if it is not used, and the finest intellect will

become dulled, and the finest muscles waste, if neither are put to use as planned by our Maker. Excess never yet spelled efficiency. So refreshment is enjoyed. Refreshment, like recreation, means nothing if not renewal. The very word "recreation" means creating again; or, in other words, a renewal of our strength and power.

The Gavel, we are told, represents the force of conscience, which, of course, is the voice of our own soul, or as our ritual puts it "the voice of nature" and the "centre from which we cannot err". It is this inner voice that is ever ready to warn us when without it we would err. If we let conscience guide us, and are prompt to heed it, we will find its voice becoming stronger and clearer with every day of our lives; but, if we fail to heed it, failure becomes a habit, and its voice will eventually become so weak that it is barely audible, so that finally there is no warning at all and its owner becomes a really evil person.

Conscience, like the Gavel, will "knock off all superfluous knobs and excrescence's" so that the rough stone of our character will become the Perfect Ashlar fit for the Temple.

The Chisel is the last of the three working tools of the First Degree, and rightly so, because the Chisel should never leave our hand. As our ritual tells us: "the Chisel points out the advantages of education, by which means alone we are rendered fit members of every civilised society". "Points out the advantages of education" -- and is that not the whole theme of the Second Degree? There we are exhorted to extend our researches into the hidden mysteries of nature and science. "Science" in that use is the ancient word for knowledge, and education is the acquisition of knowledge, the way to which lies up the Winding Staircase. As the workman, with the aid of a chisel gives form and regularity to the shapeless mass of stone, so education by cultivating ideas and polishing rude thoughts transforms the ignorant savage into the civilised being.

The Chisel furthermore demonstrates the advantages of discipline. The mind like the diamond in its original state is unpolished, but by grinding away the external coat we are enabled to discover the latent beauty of the stone. Thus education discovers the latent beauties of the mind, and draws them forth to range over the field of matter and space in order to display the summit of human knowledge, our duty to God and man.

After drawing the candidate's attention to the Chisel, we then exhort him to make a daily advancement in Masonic knowledge. He is then ready for the Second Degree.

The tools of the Fellowcraft -- the Square, Level and Plumb Rule are amply explained in a previous chapter, so I will here content myself with several additional remarks.

The Square, of course, is one of the most important tools in Freemasonry for, besides being the first working tool in the Second Degree, it is also the Second Great Light.

The true Level is the surface of a fluid at rest, and we shall find the true Freemason when we find a man who has passions and desires like our own, but who is master of his own soul, who can endure the worst calamities of misfortune and not become bitter, and who can meet the greatest good fortune and still keep his feet on the ground; as Rudyard Kipling said:

"and treat those two impostors just the same".

Men differ in nature, heredity and opportunity, but above all, in the ability to make full use of their talents or to overcome their disabilities. We can all, however, do our best with what means we have; the greater a man's wealth, or the greater his intelligence and ability, then the greater his responsibility. We must work with the full length of our cable tow.

So Masonry teaches us equality of regard. On the floor of the Lodge all men are equal and brothers – equal in our regard, and brothers in the great brotherhood of man.

The Plumb Rule is the emblem of integrity, and with the man of integrity we can entertain no doubt. We know how he will act, and what he will do, because he stoops to nothing mean or petty, a debt of a few cents is just as sure to be paid as one of a thousand dollars; where his attendance is expected there he will be. The man of integrity is ruled by duty and loyalty, and will never take an unfair advantage.

The Plumb Rule consists of a weight hanging freely at the end of a line; the principle that actuates it is the influence of gravity. No matter where it is placed, it always points to the centre of the earth. So it is in the spiritual world, but here it points unerringly to God.

A man of integrity does not envy the wealth, the power, or the intelligence and good fortune of another, nor does he despise those less

fortunate than himself. He harbours no avarice, injustice, malice, revenge, nor an envy and contempt of mankind, but holds the scales of justice with equal poise.

In the Third Degree, the Skirret is an implement which acts on a centre pin, whence a line is drawn to mark out the ground for the foundation of the intended structure. Symbolically, the Skirret points out that straight and undeviating line of conduct laid down for our pursuit in the Volume of the Sacred Law; and so to "square", "level" and "upright" we must add "straight". "Straight" is defined as the shortest distance between two points; and in our dealings with God, our neighbour and ourselves, we find that the shortest path is that which is straight. We can easily be tempted to take an easier path and so forsake the straight, perhaps at first just a little, but that "little" can become a habit. To keep on the straight requires restraint, which is rarely easy.

A criminal usually begins with a small theft or perhaps just a lie, just something small, but it is that "little" that leads a long way round. A lie often requires another, till we find that we have strayed a long way from the truth. As Shakespeare said: "Oh, what a tangled web we weave, when first we practise to deceive."

A cross-examining counsel, however clever and able, is often beaten by the witness who persistently speaks the truth, no matter how simple and unsophisticated the latter may be. The straight path may lead uphill, or it may lead down the valley; it may cross the grass in the meadow, or it may follow that stony path on the side of the hill, where the sharp edges cut our feet and each step is stained with blood; but it will lead the shortest way to the rest that should come to the traveler.

Life does not consist of one moment of impact by one solitary force, it consists of very many moments with the influence of a great number of forces, each one pulling away from the straight and narrow path, but, if our direction is rightly set, our path will be safe. With the Skirret to guide him, the Mason works with a spiritual balance; accidental influences, however powerful, will be overcome and the goal will be reached.

With the Pencil the skillful artist delineates the building in a draft or plan for the instruction and guidance of the workmen. Our building has been delineated in a draft or plan for our instruction and guidance by the Great Architect of the Universe. It is for us to understand what is meant by each

detail of the design, so that our life, when considered in the time to come, and in the light of that plan, will be judged by its conformity to that plan.

We all know that in the erection of a building, just how easy it is to misread the plan, and how we need a good light. We have only to seek, and we will find the light that we need. The light of a Master Mason is but darkness visible, that is, ignorance realised, for there is no greater darkness than ignorance not realised.

The Compasses remind us of His unerring and impartial justice, who, having defined for our instruction the limits of good and evil, will reward or punish us as we have obeyed or disregarded His divine commands. They remind us to so limit our desires in every station of life, that, rising to eminence by merit, we may live respected and die regretted.

Dr. Mackey tells us that the Volume of the Sacred Law gives us light on our duty to God, the Square on our duty to our neighbour, and the Compasses on our duty to ourselves, which great duty is that of circumscribing our passions and keeping our desires within bounds.

It is worthy of note that, while the Square is a rigid angle, the Compasses are infinitely adjustable; this surely suggests to us that the circles of our sympathy and understanding can be adjusted as circumstances demand. If the circle is taking in just one other, whose confidence we treasure, we must remember that his secrets we must keep as our own; if our circle is extended further it will include all the members of the Lodge, and still further it can include all members of the Craft.

THE IMPORTANCE OF: THE LEGEND OF HIRAM ABIFF

by: Conrad Hahn, P.G.M.

This Short Talk Bulletin has been adapted from a speech given by the late Most Worshipful Brother Conrad Hahn, in 1972, while serving as the Executive Secretary of the Masonic Service Association.

The legend of "Hiram, the widow's son," is the foundation of Freemasonry's ritualistic drama of the third, or Master's Degree. While it would be improper to reveal the details of the drama as it is presented in the lodge room, or to make public the ritualistic secrets and symbolism which it contains, the story of Hiram is so well known and has been referred to in Masonic writings so frequently that it has become a part of the cultural heritage of civilized men everywhere.

Briefly stated, the Hiram legend is as follows: When Solomon, King of Israel, undertook the building of the Temple in Jerusalem, he sent to Hiram, King of Tyre, for materials and assistance. In exchange for agricultural products like corn and wine and oil, King Hiram sent Solomon cedar trees cut from the forests of Lebanon and a skilled and cunning worker in metals. These facts may be found in the Old Testament, especially in Chapter 7 of I Kings and Chapter 2 of 11 Chronicles, where the skilled artisan, named Hiram, is referred to as the "son of a widow of the tribe of Naphtali" whose husband was "a man of Tyre."

This much of the Masonic legend of Hiram comes from the Bible; but the story known to Masons has a tragically different development. Hiram, called Abif (which is simply a Hebrew expression for "father," a term of respect), worked for King Solomon at Jerusalem, not only in casting all the metallic ornaments for the Temple, but also as a Master of the Works, a superintending architect.

More than 85,000 workmen were employed in the building of the Temple; it took approximately seven years to complete. To those workmen who labored faithfully on the project was promised the status of Master Workman, or Mason, upon its completion.

But some time before the Temple's completion, some of the workmen became dissatisfied and demanded the promotion which they had been promised. Not being organized like modern employees and being used to the harsher and more brutal modes of direct action characteristic of the more primitive times in which they lived, they sought the higher wages and fringe benefits of a Master Workman by conspiring to extort them from Hiram Abif.

In spite of their violent threats, Hiram steadfastly refused to yield to their demands. Reminding them of their obligations to King Solomon and his God, he resolutely insisted that they honor the contracts by which he and they were bound. Three of them, more brutal than the rest, conspired to attack Master Hiram to force the concessions they were demanding; but he, being faithful to his trust, was more adamant in his refusal, and they in their wrath slew him in the unfinished Temple.

That, essentially, is the legend of Hiram which has become in Masonry one of the most impressive ritualistic dramas of all time. Historically minded Brethren continue to wonder from whence it came and whose imagination and gifts of language transmitted it into the matchless drama which furnishes the core of "the sublime degree of Master Mason."

Certainly, the tragedy of Hiram is not to be found in the Bible. If only one Hiram is referred to in the Old Testament, the story of his assassination is not corroborated in either I Kings or 11 Chronicles; for there we read as follows: "So Hiram finished all the work he did for King Solomon on the House of the Lord."

Dr. Joseph Fort Newton, the most gifted and inspiring of Masonic writers fifty years ago, chose to believe that the tragic story of Hiram was long in the possession of operative Masons from the Middle Ages down to the dawn of Speculative Masonry in the 17th and 18th centuries. This I seriously doubt, since no mention of Hiram is to be found in any of the Old Charges and Gothic Constitutions, or in any of the remnants of old ritualistic practices to be found in the records of operative lodges which date from 100 years or more before the founding of the first Grand Lodge, which marks the beginning of the era of modern Speculative Freemasonry in 1717. Had there been even a shred of evidence that the Hiramic legend existed in Masonry before that date, I feel sure that Dr. James Anderson would have known of it and used it in the legendary history of the Craft which he published in The Constitutions of the Freemasons in 1723.

Furthermore, modern Masonic scholars have shown rather conclusively that there was no tri-gradual system of initiation during the period of operative Masonry, that there was no third or Master Mason Degree as a rite or ceremony before the creation of the Premier Grand Lodge in 1717. The first recital of the Hiram legend as the dramatic cornerstone of a third or Master Mason's degree appears in an expose of the ritual of Freemasonry entitled *Masonry Dissected*, written by a Samuel Prichard and published in London in 1730.

Consequently, it seems a logical conclusion to assume that the Master Mason Degree, and with it, the legend of Hiram Abif, were introduced into Freemasonry when it became a speculative, or philosophic organization.

Just where did the legend of Hiram come from? No one really knows; scholars have yet to discover its origins and its introduction into Freemasonry. My own scholarly prejudices lead me to believe that it's a re-working of some mediaeval mystery play, whose original may yet be discovered in a private library or the rubbish of an ancient building.

Mystery plays were the most popular form of public entertainment in the Middle Ages. Each guild or trade had its own preferred dramas; most of them were Biblical in origin. They were produced, staged and acted by members of the guild, first in churches, and then in public squares, to which they were banished when the plays became too boisterous and irreverent for the sacerdotal authorities.

These drams were called mysteries, not because they treated of witches, ghosts, or detectives, but because they were produced by craft guilds or "mysteres," which is variant of the French word "mestaire," a craft or guild. So, the plays became known in England as mysteres, or mysteries, because they were produced by "mestaires," or guilds. The expression, "the mysteries of Freemasonry," therefore, originally meant the ritualistic ceremonies, or work of the Lodge.

To Masons who thirst for historical certainty about Hiram Abif and his position in Masonic ritual, I can only give a dusty answer. It's not really important.

It's a mistake to consider the Hiram legend as history. There was a Hiram Abif in history, but our Third Degree is not interested in him as such. The drama of Hiram is a conflict of a man with other men, of an individual against evil forces embodied in other men.

Hiram Abif is the dramatized symbol of the human soul-of mine, of yours, of every man. The work he was engaged in is symbolic of the work which you and I are committed to perform in the supervision, organization and direction of our lives from birth to dissolution. The enemies that Hiram meets are really symbols of those lusts and passions and failures of the spirit which in ourselves and others make war on our characters and spiritual aspirations.

In my opinion, this symbolic increment to the Hiram legend was added by one of the Speculative Masons of the early Eighteenth Century, by someone with the education and philosophical attainments of a man like Dr. John Theophilus Desaguliers or another Rosicrucian adept.

Hiram's death was also his triumph — as the resurrection of truth over ignorance is always a victory, in spite of its being buried for a while in the rubbish of scorn and deliberate persecution.

This is the real importance of the legend of Hiram, that it still stirs men to serve the Truth by steadfastly maintaining the necessity of their noblest aspirations, even to apparent defeat in death, out of which can arise a more perfect Living Perpendicular!

Edwin Booth, the famous actor and loyal Mason, was no mean judge of the essence of tragedy; he evaluated the Hiram legend in these words:

"In all my research and study, in all my close analysis of the masterpieces of Shakespeare, in my earnest determination to make those plays appear real on the mimic stage, I have never, and nowhere, met tragedy so real, so sublime, so magnificent as the legend of Hiram. It is substance without shadow-the manifest destiny of life which requires no picture and scarcely a word to make a lasting impression upon all who understand. To be a Worshipful Master, and to throw my whole soul into that work, with the candidate for my audience and the Lodge for my stage, would be a greater personal distinction than to receive the plaudits of people in the theaters of the world."

And that should tell us, if we are Master Workmen, what we should do with the legend of Hiram when we work in "the mysteries of Freemasonry." We must make it truly sublime!

The Masonic Service Association of the United States of America

MASTER MASON

"Are you a Master Mason?"

Every member of the Fraternity has answered this challenge affirmatively, even if only passively, during the ceremonies of opening and closing a lodge. What the words have actually meant to every individual Brother is anybody's guess; but it is a safe assumption that the reply was at least intended to signify membership in the world's oldest fraternal organization.

Unfortunately, too many members have never gone beyond that definition of a Master Mason. They know that they "took" the three degrees: The last was the Master Mason degree. Upon its completion, they were acknowledged as regular members. They knew that they were now "Masons".

To be sure, every member has been made aware of some of the legends, symbolism, and philosophy of freemasonry during his initiatory experiences. This is one of the great achievements of the immemorial phrases of Masonic ritual; even the least attentive and absent member remembers the glimpses he had of the "genius of Freemasonry". The lapse of time, however, tends to erase those vivid impressions, so that the non-attender comes to think of a Master Mason merely as a member of a club or society.

This is a problem for Masonic education, - for the individual "mentor", "intender", or committee on instruction or information. It is not the subject of this Short Talk Bulletin, however. This essay is an attempt to amplify the average Brother's concept of a Master Mason, and as such it may be helpful in correcting the "average" impressions sketched above.

Historically, the Term Master Mason comes from the operative builders' organizations of the Middle Ages, although the concept of a master, or skilled boss of the workmen, is as old as civilization. The Roman builders were directed by their most skillful craftsmen, the magister of the collegia. References to Master Mason occur in English building records as early as the thirteenth century: at that time, they were still given Latin names. e.g., magister cementarius (master of the stone-cutting masons) and magister operacionum (master of the works), or general contractor.

Detailed rules existed for the government of the masons connected with a lodge, which originally designated the shed or structure in which stonemasons dressed the stones for a large undertaking. The Regius Poem (c. 1390) is a compilation of some of these rules which had been in existence for a long time.

The supervision of the masons was the business of the principal and second master masons, who, upon assuming these offices by appointment from the King or clerics who had ordered the building of a structure were required to take a solemn oath to enforce the regulations.

The master mason had to see that the work started promptly and to report to the master of the works and the "keeper of the rolls" any faults or defects of the workmen. Fines for defective work were imposed as a result of his reports. The hiring of workmen was done with his advice and consent. He had to make certain that a craftsman was "worthy and well-qualified".

Generally speaking, the master mason had authority over the workmen and the actual construction of the building, while his colleague, the "keeper of the rolls" was chiefly concerned with accounts and finance; but the master mason necessarily had a share in the responsibility for expenditures and accounts, since he decided such things as the kind of stones to be used, from which quarries they were to be bought, as well as quantities and prices of other tools and materials, like sand and lime for mortar.

In fact, many a master mason achieved that rank because of his early experiences as a purveyor of stones and building materials. He had been able to accumulate the necessary capital, experience, and influence to become a freeman burgess, and to learn the mason's trade as one of its principal suppliers. Sometimes a master mason had achieved his rank because of his administrative skill in securing and organizing a dependable labor force.

Nevertheless, most master masons achieved their eminence by learning the masons' trade "from the bottom up". They may have made money on the side by furnishing building stones or other supplies, but they possessed the builder's skills and secrets to such a degree that they achieved distinction primarily by merit. Some of them were actually skillful architects and designers, whose gifts stimulated a wide-spread demand for their services. Like so many creative artists of the Middle Ages, these unusual master masons had more than one string on their bow, for they were good surveyors, accountants, superintendents of property, and civil servants as well as stone

dressers and spreaders of mortar. One of them, as a matter of fact, William of Wykeham, became Bishop of Winchester in 1367.

At that time, however, a master mason was a man who had accumulated sufficient skill and capital to set himself up in business as a contractor or superintendent of the works. The title of "master" was conferred not by a lodge of masons, but by the City Council or its agency for regulating trade. To become a "master" a workman had to purchase his "freedom" to make contracts, by becoming a burgess, i.e., a municipal taxpayer with a certain civic obligations, like going "watch and ward" duty and supplying military arms or service if it became necessary. The capital for such advancement usually came from "side" activities, such as dealing in stone or being in a position to make contracts for building or supplying labor.

Few operative masons became masters. It required more money and ability than the average stonecutter or layer possessed. Even Master masons differed widely in their earning power and financial success. The building projects in the early Middle Ages were too few to require a large force of specialized administrative builders.

Master masons were naturally paid more for their labors than "rough masons" or apprentices. Attempts were made regularly to fix the wage scales of all types of artisans and workmen, but it was the masters who most frequently enjoyed bonuses and rewards. The master of a large building project not only received daily wages which might rise as high as six times those of the ordinary laborer; he would also receive extra payments, sometimes so regularly in both amount and time of payment that they may have been part of his official "salary". No wonder the phrase, "a masters wages", carried overtones of considerable prestige into modern Speculative Masonry!

Sometimes a reward was paid not in money, but in the form of a robe or livery. such an honorarium rarely was paid to any but a master mason in a responsible position, like the architect or superintendent of the work. At the building of Eton College in 1445-46."cloth was purchased for the liveries of the chief mason, of the warden, and of the purveyors"- the sub-contractors.

In some cases, the attention of the master mason was not needed constantly: he could work elsewhere with the permission of the authorities who had engaged him. In such cases, his remuneration was usually an annual fee, plus a per diem wage for each day that he was present and

working at the building. The position of such a master mason was appointed for life, he was given "social security" in the form of maintenance in sickness and old age.

The importance of master masons varied with the size and cost of the structures they were working on. The master builder of a cathedral, however, was a highly skilled workman and administrator. He had to have the ability to draw plans and elevations. He had to be able to compute the quantities of material and labor needed; he had to manage his workmen effectively and fairly. since he had the final authority to "hire and fire, he had to know good work from bad work, good masons from poor ones. He had to administer with justice and "equal regularity". A master mason was a man of worth and dignity.

During the seventeenth century, from the days of Queen Elizabeth to the institution of "constitutional" monarchs in England after the reign of James II, masons' lodges underwent a considerable change, and early in the eighteenth century they evolved into their modern fraternal form, especially with the organization of Grand Lodges from 1717 on.

Lodges were still associations of stoneworkers and masons, but the cessation of cathedral building, and the expansion of overseas trade lessened the importance of the masons' companies to the point where they had to change to survive. From the active trade associations whose primary function was the regulation of workers and their qualifications, as well as their working conditions, wages, rights, and responsibilities, they gradually became mutual benefit societies concerned largely with charity and relief for the destitute and unemployed.

It was during this century that non-operative members began to be accepted in ever-increasing numbers, largely to build up the financial reserves for the lodges' philanthropic designs. Especially welcome were members of the professional, educated, and titled classes, not merely because they could afford the higher "entry" fees for accepted masons, but also because they could help to restore the waning prestige of the craft associations.

Up to this time, a Fellow of the Craft was a workman who had passed two stages of admission. There were no more. A Master Mason was a Fellow of the Craft who had bought his status, not from the lodge, but from the Town Council of its trade incorporators. So far as a lodge was concerned, a Fellow of the Craft and a Master were practically the same thing.

With the change from operative to Speculative Freemasonry, however, the lodges began to record members in three different categories: apprentices, fellowcrafts, and masters. Since accepted masons could not become operative master masons, lodges began to grant the title of Master to non-operative masons in their ranks. The only requirement seems to have been the payment of another fee: no special ceremony was performed to make such accepted masons Masters.

So far as can be determined from records and historical papers, the ceremonies of the Master Mason degree were a product of the transformation achieved by modern Speculative Freemasonry. In the change from operative craft lodges of skilled stonemasons to lodges of accepted Masons, the status of master masons declined from that of outstanding leadership in skills and management to that of mere membership in a fraternal organization. Part of our modern problem about the answer to the question, "Are you a Master Mason?" is a built-in weakness which has been inherited from the practices of operative masons in the period of transition.

Part of the problem undoubtedly lies in the failure of modern Freemasonry to make the title of Master Mason truly "proud" and "sublime". We may surmise that this is one reason why Speculative Freemasonry adopted the ceremonies of the third degree so rapidly and universally during the first decades of the Grand Lodge era. They are impressive; they do give the initiate a distinct impression of the grandeur and the lofty possibilities of Freemasonry's ultimate designs. This may also be the reason that additional rites and degrees proliferated so rapidly in the first century of modern Freemasonry.

But ceremony and ritual, no matter how superbly executed, are not enough to really make a man a Master Mason. An operative master of the craft has to acquire certain skills, specific knowledge, and practical experience over a period of years before he could qualify for the title of master mason. A speculative Master, or overseer of the work, must likewise demonstrate in his own life the qualities and experiences which alone can make him a symbolic Master of the builders of Brotherhood. Ritual and ceremony can help him to define and to recognize those spiritual skills. The important question, therefore, is not "Are you a Master Mason?" It is the more searching and difficult query, "What is a Master Mason?"

Reverence for the Great Architect of the Universe is a first characteristic. It cannot be exemplified merely in a lodge. It must be a way of thinking and

acting, which manifests itself at a man's place of business, in his home, at the club, -- in his activities to promote and encourage the work of a church or synagogue.

Benevolence is the next significant quality; but it must be more than dutiful acts of charity and relief which alleviate the distress of a fallen brother, his widow, or his orphans. Benevolence means literally "well wishing", which to a Master Mason means an attitude of helpful interest to every member of the whole family of mankind.

Tolerance also characterizes the true Master Mason -- not merely the tolerance which suffers or endures that which is inimical or distasteful, but that spirit of "bear ye one another's burdens" which permits real understanding of and sympathy for those with whom we disagree. One reason that Freemasonry is so concerned about freedom, political as well as spiritual, is that Freemasonry knows the absolute necessity of mutual tolerance if men are to live in freedom and justice.

Respect for knowledge and the skills dependent thereon is the significant lesson of the Fellowcraft degree. But such respect is part of a larger reverence which the true Master Mason accords to excellence in every form. And the true Master Mason has the courage to define and to insist on excellence, whether he is dealing merely with the ritual labors of his lodge, or with the performance of his fellow-workers in business, government, and community affairs. But since excellence alone can recognize the excellent, he reverences all knowledge and experience which have helped men everywhere to achieve excellence. the true Master Mason is not satisfied with the "average": he dares to be better than that.

An operative master mason was trained individually to be an architect or overseer of the work. He was a man of worth and dignity. The Speculative Master Mason must also be trained individually to be a master of the moral and spiritual skills of the Builders of Brotherhood. His excellence must make him a man of worth and dignity.

Are you a Master Mason?

SECRECY

by: Unknown

An old Greek philosopher, when asked what he regarded as the most valuable quality to win and the most difficult to keep, he replied:

"To be Secret and Silent." If secrecy was difficult in the olden times, it is doubly difficult today, in the loud and noisy world in which we live, where privacy is almost unknown.

Secrecy is, indeed, a priceless but rare virtue, so little effort is made to teach and practice it. The world of today is a whispering gallery where everything is heard, a hall of mirrors where nothing is hid. If the ancient worshipped a God of silence, we seem about to set up an Altar to the God of Gossip.

Someone has said that if Masonry did no more than train its men to preserve sacredly the secrets of others confided to them as such - except where a higher duty demands disclosure - it would be doing a great work, and one which not only justifies its existence, but entitles it to the respect of mankind.

Anyway, no Mason needs to be told the value of secrecy.

Without it, Masonry would cease to exist, or else become something so different from what it is as to be unrecognizable. For that reason, if no other, the very first lesson taught a candidate, and impressed upon him at every turn in unforgettable ways, is the duty of secrecy.

Yet, strictly speaking, Masonry is not a secret society, if by that we mean a society whose very existence is hidden. Everybody knows that the Masonic Fraternity exists, and no effort is made to hide that fact. Its organization is known; its Temples stand in our cities; its members are proud to be known as Masons. Anyone may obtain from the records of a Grand Lodge, if not from the printed reports of Lodges, the names of the members of the Craft. Nor can it be said that Masonry has any secret truth to teach, unknown to the best wisdom of the race. Most of the talk about esoteric Masonry misses the mark. When the story is told the only secret turns out to be some odd theory, some fanciful philosophy, of no real importance. The wisdom of Masonry is hidden,

not because it is subtle, but because it is simple. Its secret is profound, not obscure.

As in mathematics, there are primary figures, and in music fundamental notes, upon which everything rests, so Masonry is built upon the broad, deep, lofty truths upon which life itself stands. It lives, moves, and has its being in those truths. They are mysteries, indeed, as life and duty and death are mysteries; to know them is to be truly wise; and to teach them in their full import is the ideal at which Masonry aims.

Masonry, then, is not a secret society; it is a private order. In the quiet of the tiled lodge, shut away from the noise and clatter of the world, in an air of reverence and friendship, it teaches us the truths that make us men, upon which faith and character must rest if they are to endure the wind and weather of life. So rare is its utter simplicity that to many it is as much a secret as though it were hid behind a seven-fold veil, or buried in the depths of the earth.

What is the secret in Masonry? The "Method" of its teaching, the atmosphere it creates the spirit it breaths into our hearts, and the tie it spins and weaves between men; in other words, the lodge and its ceremonies and obligations, its signs, tokens and words - its power to evoke what is most secret and hidden in the hearts of men. No one can explain how this is done. We only know that it is done, and guard as a priceless treasure the method by which it is wrought. It is the fashion of some to say that our ceremonies, signs and tokens are of little value; but it is not true. They are of profound importance, and we cannot be too careful in protecting them from profanation and abuse. The famous eulogy of the signs and tokens of Masonry by Benjamin Franklin was not idle eloquence. It is justified by the facts, and ought to be known and remembered:

"These signs and tokens are of no small value; they speak a universal language, and act as a password to the attention and support of the initiated in all parts of the world. They cannot be lost so long as memory retains its power. Let the possessor of them be expatriated, ship-wrecked or imprisoned; let him be stripped of everything he has in the world; still these credentials remain and are available for use as circumstances require.

"The great effects which they have produced are established by the most incontestable facts of history. They have stayed the uplifted hand of the Destroyer; they have softened the aspirates of the tyrant; they have mitigated

the horrors of captivity; they have subdued the rancor of malevolence; and broken down the barriers of political animosity and sectarian alienation.

"On the field of battle, in the solitude of the uncultivated forests, or in the busy haunts of the crowded city, they have made men of the most hostile feelings, and most distant religions, and the most diversified conditions, rush to the aid of each other, and feel a social joy and satisfaction that they have been able to afford relief to a brother Mason."

What is equally true, and no less valuable, is that in the ordinary walks of everyday life they unite men and hold them together in a manner unique and holy. They open a door out of the loneliness in which every man lives. They form a tie uniting us to help one another, and others, in ways too many to name or count. They form a network of fellowship, friendship, and fraternity around the world. They add something lovely and fine to the life of each of us, without which we should be poorer indeed.

Still let us never forget that it is the spirit that gives life; the letter alone is empty. An old home means a thousand beautiful things to those who were brought up in it. It's very scenery and setting are sacred. The ground on which it stands is holy. But if a stranger buys it, these sacred things mean nothing to him. The spirit is gone, the glory has faded. Just so with the lodge. If it were opened to the curious gaze of the world, its beauty would be blighted, its power gone.

The secret of Masonry, like the secret of life, can be known only by those who seek it, serve it and live it. It cannot be uttered; it can only be felt and acted. It is, in fact, an open secret, and each man knows it according to his quest and capacity. Like all the things most worth knowing, no one can know it for another, and no one can know it alone. It is known only in fellowship, by the touch of life upon life, spirit upon spirit, knee to knee, breast to breast and hand to hand.

For that reason, no one need be alarmed about any book written to expose Masonry. It is utterly harmless. The real secret of Masonry cannot be learned by prying eyes or curious inquiry. We do well to protect the privacy of the lodge; but the secret of Masonry can be known only by those who are ready and worthy to receive it. Only a pure heart and an honest mind can know it, though they be adepts in all signs and tokens of every rite of the Craft.

Indeed, so far from trying to hide its secret, Masonry is all the time trying to give it to the world, in the only way in which it can be given, through a certain quality of soul and character which it labors to create and build up. To the making of men, helping self-discovery and self-development, all the offices of Masonry are dedicated. It is a quarry in which the rough stones of manhood are polished for use and beauty.

If Masonry uses the illusion of secrecy, it is because it knows that it is the nature of man to seek what is hidden and to desire what is forbidden. Even God hides from us, that in seeking Him amid the shadows of life we may find both Him and ourselves. The man who does not care enough for God to seek Him will never find Him, though He is not far away from any one of us.

One who looks at Masonry in this way will find that his Masonic life is a great adventure. It is a perpetual discovery. There is something new at every turn, something new in himself as life deepens with the years; something new in Masonry as its meaning unfolds. The man who finds its degrees tedious and its Ritual a rigmarole only betrays the measure of his own mind.

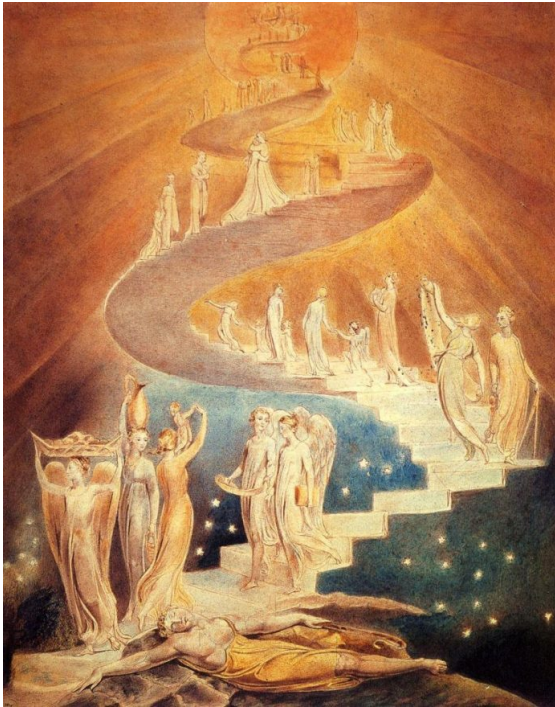
If a man knows God and man to the uttermost, even Masonry has nothing to teach him. As a fact the wisest man knows very little. The way is dim, and no one can see very far. We are seekers after truth, and God has so made us that we cannot find the truths alone, but only in the love and service of our fellow men. Here is the real secret, and to learn it is to have the key to the meaning and joy of life.

Truth is not a gift; it is a trophy. To know it we must be true, to find it we must seek, to learn it we must be humble; and to keep it we must have a clear mind, a courageous heart, and the brotherly love to use it in the service of man.

A STAIRWAY AND A LADDER

by William Moseley Brown, PGM

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*"I hold it truth with him who sings
To one clear Harp in divers tones
That men may rise on stepping stones
Of their dead selves to higher things."*

– Alfred, Lord Tennyson

In these lines, the poet has expressed a fundamental Masonic teaching. What more vivid imagery could be used to illustrate the lesson of Hiram Abif's legend than these words, especially the lines: "That men may rise on stepping stones / Of their dead selves to higher things"? Note the words *dead* and *higher*. What is the plain implication of these words of our text?

First, the old self must undergo death before the new self can take its place. This figure of regeneration is used not only in Freemasonry, but also in most of the ancient mysteries as well as in religions, ancient and modern. They all teach the virtue of "climbing" or rising in some manner above the conditions and circumstances in which we find ourselves at any given time. In Masonry (which is not, however, a religion) we find the same idea taught by the symbols of a Stairway and a Ladder. The Stairway plays a prominent part in the Fellowcraft Degree, as does the Ladder in the Entered Apprentice Degree.

Second, while there is no suggestion that there is anything phoenix-like in human development, the idea of self-immolation and self-sacrifice is a plain teaching of the Masonic Fraternity. Looking a little closer, we find that the individual is both the sacrifice and the sacrificer simultaneously. There is no suggestion that the process in his case resembles the incident of Abraham's sacrifice of his son Isaac, nor is there the notion of anything like suicide. Indeed, the individual becomes a sort of High Priest who presides over the very act of sacrificing himself, as is implied here. In other words, we find

ourselves by making of ourselves a sacrifice for others. And the human being is the only creature who can do this and for whom this can be done.

Third, there is the idea of ascent, that is, that we should climb ever higher and higher. There is no limit to our climbing or self-improvement except perfection itself. The essential thing is that we should keep climbing. This is the same idea expressed by Longfellow in his poem, *Excelsior*: “A youth who bore mid snow and ice / A banner with the strange device, *Excelsior! Excelsior!*”

Fourth, there is the inevitable law of life and death that everyone must reckon with. In one branch of Masonry, we are reminded of “*Memento mori*” (liberal translation, “We are born to die”). This motto appears in the meeting places of many European lodges. In Sweden occurs the variation: “No life without death: no death without life.” Here, then, is the inevitable teaching of the two greatest events in a human being’s experience. Further, there is no more reason to assume that death is final, any more than that life is so. Either conclusion is as much a product of human reasoning – logic – as is any other.

Fifth, there is no such thing as “pulling oneself up by one’s bootstraps.” The mental indulgence in this sort of rationalization is in reality incompatible with every teaching of Freemasonry. A few moments of reflection will demonstrate this fact.

The Winding Stairs in the Fellowcraft Degree lead us a part of the way up to the Light of Truth, but it remains for the ladder “extending from earth to heaven” in the Entered Apprentice Degree to show us the rest of the way. The latter is much more than a theological ladder. In former times the word theological meant not so much “religious” as “philosophical.” Note, too, that the ultimate aim of our climbing is heaven; our ascent is not made on a Tower of Babel. Our objective dare not be a smaller or lower one. This means that every Mason, to be worthy of his calling, must be a perfectionist.

We are told in the Great Light in Masonry that the citizenry of the Kingdom of Heaven consists of perfect beings, and this perfection is set for us: “Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which in heaven is perfect.” (Matthew 5:48) The citizen of the Kingdom is to be perfect himself; he cannot be the source of any imperfect thing. This injunction would be a hollow mockery if it pointed us to an unattainable goal. The Supreme Architect of the

Universe does not make of Himself the promulgator of impossible! For the Mason, therefore, the motto is "*Ne plus ultra*," "Nothing farther."

In the Scottish Rite the first fourteen degrees constitute what is called the "Rite of Perfection." The whole teaching of the Scottish Rite is the attainment of what we regard too often as unattainable. To rest content with shoddy work and piecemeal morals must be a thing of the past.

A Mason must give serious consideration to the moral judgments involved in questions such as these: the use of atomic bombs on civilians, whether in time of war or otherwise; a nation at peace maintaining strict censorship over its citizens; not giving financial support to charity when the individual is financially able; not taking the trouble to vote at elections; disbelieving in God; a doctor allowing a badly deformed baby to die when he could save its life but not cure its deformity; falsifying an income tax return; driving an automobile while drunk, but without accident; living on inherited wealth without attempting to render service to others; etc.

Are we justified in looking out for "No. 1," without caring what happens to the rest of mankind? In saying "everybody's doing it" as a reason (rationalization) for our doing the same thing? Is it really harmless to "get away with it" because no one sees or hears it?

Cutting corners in morals, religion, business, or other relationships is coming to be the more or less accepted standard of life and conduct. The saying that "we have to live with ourselves" means little except that we are willing to live with almost any kind of person.

Yet, in the face of all this, we have the uncompromising statement in Masonry's Great Light: "Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God." (Matthew 5:8) Guilelessness has almost ceased to be a virtue worth mentioning; guile (nowadays often called "diplomacy" or "business acumen") is the order of the day. Who will make us hold the torch high and demand of ourselves and others the highest standards of living and action?

It is not enough to wish for things or merely to plan to do them. Psychologists have a name for this sort of thing; they call it "wishful thinking" or "rationalizing." Many persons who indulge in these to an excessive extent are said to be abnormal or mentally sick.

There is another thing that must not be overlooked. Kant had no corner on “categorical imperatives.” Freemasonry has at least one of them: self-improvement. This is obligatory and is no mere tinsel or window-dressing of Masonic ritual. A Mason is bound to better himself in spirit, mind, and body – always and in every way. If he slips from the pathway by saying or doing something that lowers him in his own and his fellowman’s estimation, he has derogated from his profession. It is not expected that he will be able to reach the pinnacle of perfection by himself, but the help of God is always abundantly available.

Consequently, we find that individual initiative and private enterprise are not enough. We have responsibility to the whole of human society. “...Masons are linked together by an indissoluble chain of sincere affection.” What is the purpose of this? “To relieve the distressed is a duty incumbent on all men, but particularly upon Masons ... to soothe the unhappy, to sympathize with their misfortunes, to compassionate their miseries, and restore peace to their troubled minds, is the grand aim we have in view.” This is the ticket, so to speak, without which no passage is obtainable.

Dr. Charles G. Reigner in *The Degrees of Masonry* calls the Winding Stairs “the stairway of life.” He says:

The pathway of life is not a straight or level road on which we can travel without exertions. On the contrary, it is a ‘winding’ path. It is beset with difficulties that are the common lot of humanity. But for the thoughtful Mason, the road he travels, however steep or winding it may be, still leads onward to a higher sense of what life is and what it is meant to be.

Thus, the Winding Stairs become a symbol of the Mason’s mental and spiritual life and growth, of learning, study and enlarging horizons, of courage and Masonic character.

The late Carl H. Claudy wrote in his *Pocket Encyclopedia of Masonic Symbols*:

The *Winding Stairs* are the symbol of the realities of the Masonic career. A straight stair, a ladder, hides neither secret nor mystery at its top. But the stairs that wind hide each step from the climber; what is just around the corner is unknown. The Winding Stairs of life lead us to we know not what; for some, a Middle Chamber of fame and fortune; for others, of pain and

frustration. The Angel of Death may stand with drawn sword on the very next step for anyone.

Yet man climbs because he has courage; because he has faith, because he is a man. So must the Freemason climb. The Winding Stairs *do* lead somewhere. There *is* a Middle Chamber. There are wages of the Fellowcraft to be earned. But the objective of all our striving must not be lost sight of. For the purpose of our climbing is the “starry-decked heavens where all good Masons hope at last to arrive.” Wages as such are not vouchsafed here, for the reward is the ultimate one of heaven itself. Is there any greater? It is the Supreme Architect of the Universe, who gives His final approval in the “Well done, good and faithful servant.” (Matthew 25:23)

There is the further thought that “the three principal rounds of the ladder are faith, hope, and charity.” Perhaps we should also note that these are not the only rounds of the ladder – all the Masonic virtues are likewise to be made the objects of our endeavors. There are kindness, honor, liberty of both conscience and body, righteousness, wisdom, loving-kindness, patience, fidelity, trust, manhood, gentleness, humility, and a host of others, all of which enter into the make-up of what we call human character.

One further observation may be worth mentioning here. The word *ladder* in the Greek language is *climax*. The word means “the highest point,” or the “point of greatest interest,” “the summit.” There is always the notion of “going up,” of “ascending”; and the end is at the top, not at some point at a lower level.

Again, we turn to Claudy’s *Pocket Encyclopedia of Masonic Symbols*:

The revised edition of the Bible reads “love” in place of “charity,” which makes the Masonic ritual of Jacob’s ladder more understandable. That “charity extends beyond the grave through the boundless realms of eternity” seems an overstatement, if charity is thought of in terms of putting a ten-cent piece in a blind beggar’s cup. But if it is “love” which extends through eternity, the conception is at once beautiful and Masonic, since brotherly love is one of the great teachings of Masonry.

One further admonition must be mentioned. Beware of frustrations, barriers, and detours on your progress through Masonry. The Fraternity does not guarantee to eliminate or to overcome these obstacles for the zealous and industrious brother. He himself must assume this responsibility.

The Entered Apprentice is admonished that he is to erect his “future moral and Masonic edifice” on certain tenets, virtues, and principles. Without them he cannot build; he is like the man building his house upon the sand instead of upon the rock.

We find, then, that we are all face to face with the inevitable necessity of making our choice between the *sand* and the *rock* as our foundation. As one recent writer said: “We are the first people in human history to possess the power of total self-destruction.” Actually, as never before, Masonry finds among its more serious obligations, the demonstrating of the correct answer to this dilemma. In the proper ascent of the Stairway and the Ladder, materially, mentally, and spiritually, and in arriving at the summit, we shall become Masons worthy of the name!

On the campus of Williams College in Massachusetts stand the “Hopkins Memorial Steps.” They were erected in memory of Mark and Albert Hopkins, two famous educators of the last century. Mark Hopkins was the brother who became President of William College and of whom it was said, “Mark Hopkins sitting on one end of a log and a boy on the other constitute a university.”

Supposed to have been written by Professor Albert Hopkins, the other brother, these lines were placed on the Memorial Steps after having been found among his papers after his death:

**Climb high;
Climb far,
Your goal the sky,
Your aim the star.**

Can anyone – Mason or profane –
have a finer or greater theme for his
life?



The author was a Past Grand Master of The Grand Lodge of Virginia in 1934 and Masonic author. He was a member of the Scottish Rite, the York Rite, the Shrine, and an Honorary Member of the Supreme Council, 33rd Degree. He belonged to a number of Lodges around the world and has been honored by a number of Grand Lodges.

He served in both World War I and World War II. In 1945, he served as military governor of Weimar, Germany, during which time he was commander of the Buchenwald Concentration Camp after it was liberated from the Germans. Brown ran for Governor of Virginia, and in 1932, he was a candidate for the United States House of Representatives.

He was a faculty member of Columbia University, Washington and Lee University (teaching, at different times, German, Biology, Education and Psychology, and also serving as psychological examiner and director of vocational guidance for seven years), University of Virginia, George Washington University, University of Guadalajara, Mexico and Elon College, North Carolina (as Professor of Social Sciences). He also served as president of Atlantic University, president of the Virginia Academy of Science and president of the Association of Virginia Colleges.

SYMBOLISM

The subject of Symbolism is a peculiarly difficult and immense topic. In the usual amount of space devoted to our lectures it is impossible to more than touch upon a very few general points. Many books, articles, lectures and even the ritual of the lodge itself contain a very large and comprehensive instruction on the symbols and emblems of Freemasonry. The presentation here, therefore, can only be an attempt to interest you in a further study of the theme. Freemasonry has been defined as a beautiful system of morality, veiled in allegory and illustrated by symbols. The first three degrees of our system are called symbolic degrees, wherein both by symbols and lectures; and allegories, the Freemason is admonished to study and acquire learning, and is actually taught a complete system of organized knowledge.

The word "Symbol" is derived from the Greek, meaning "To Compare." A symbol is the expression of an idea by comparison. Symbolism is the science of symbols, or signs; the art of representing abstract truths and ideas by concrete things. An allegory is a story told to illustrate or convey some truth. Some of the most important truths have been handed down to us through allegories, that being one of the favorite methods the Master used to convey His teachings. It is one of the peculiarities of an allegory that its message may not be understood by all men. One must be prepared within his own mind and heart to receive the truth or else he sees it not. It is only a few of all those who hear, who perceives the lesson designed to be taught by the allegory. The great majority, having ears to hear, hear not; having eyes to see, see not the beautiful lesson, but hear only a pretty story that interests them for a short while and then is lost. But the earnest seeker for truth, he who is duly and truly prepared for its reception, sees beyond the veil of the allegory and perceives the beautiful, simple truth which it conceals from the multitude but reveals to the chosen few.

The origin of the symbol is Divinity itself, for when at the beginning of recorded time, Jehovah made a covenant with man, promising that never again would He send the waters to cover the face of the earth and destroy all flesh, He set the first symbol the multi-hued arch of the rainbow - in the clouds as an emblem of security and an assurance to all future generations of His watchful care.

Symbolical instruction is recommended by the constant and uniform usage of antiquity; and it has retained its influence throughout all ages, as a system of mysterious communication.

Christ taught by symbols and parables. The mysterious knowledge of the Druids was embodied in signs and symbols. The Mysteries were a series of symbols; and what was spoken there consisted wholly of accessory explanations of the act or image; sacred allegories explanatory of established symbols.

The picturesque and variegated maze of the early symbolism of the human race we cannot study in detail, tempting as it is.

Indeed, so luxuriant was that old picture language that we may easily miss our way and get lost in the labyrinth, unless we keep to the right path. First of all, let us keep ever in mind, a very simple and obvious fact, although not less wonderful because it is obvious. Socrates made the discovery - perhaps the greatest ever made - that human nature is universal. Whether we study the earliest groupings of the human mind, or set the teachings of the sages side by side, we find, after comparison, that the final conclusions of the wisest minds as to the meaning of life and the world are harmonious, if not identical.

Thus, we begin to understand why the same signs, symbols and emblems were used by all peoples to express their earliest aspirations and thoughts. We need not infer that one people learned them from another, or that there existed a mystic, universal Order which had them in keeping. They simply betray the unity of the human mind, and show how and why, at the same stage and culture, races far removed from each other came to the same conclusions and used much the same symbols to body forth their thought. Illustrations are innumerable of this unity both of idea and of emblem, and also as confirming the insight of the great Greek, that, however shallow minds may differ, in the end all seekers after truth follow a common path, comrades in one great quest.

Symbols and symbolism are as old as man. It is the primeval, yet universal language of the world. Symbols and symbolism are not peculiar to any nation, peoples, secret societies or brotherhoods; whether primitive, medieval or modern.

Symbols and symbolism are not bound down by rules; hence a man with a symbol can have the satisfaction that, as a free moral agent, he can see in

it, and through it, more things in Heaven and earth than are dreamed by common mortals.

When the savage began to emerge from his isolation and took his first steps toward becoming a social creature, profiting by association and cooperation with fellow human beings, one of the first needs was a sign or symbol whereby he could distinguish, during primitive battles, between creatures of his own tribe or family and those of the enemy tribes. A peculiar type of club, a splotch of colored clay on the body of the warrior, and later some rude device on his clumsy shield served for a time the purpose of insignia. Eventually these bits of wood, bodily ornamentation and shield signs were replaced by the skins of animals attached to poles so that they might be held high in the air and recognized at a distance. From such crude beginnings it is easy to trace the evolution of the flags of civilized man.

Today these emblems of armies and navies have a deep and noble significance far removed from their use in leading men to battle. In reality, flags are the symbols of idealism.

The first learning in the world consisted chiefly of symbols. The wisdom of all the ancients that has come to our hand is symbolic. It was the mode of the ancient philosophers to represent truth by certain symbols and hidden images. These ancient symbols and allegories always had more than one interpretation. They always had a double meaning, and sometimes more than two, one serving as the envelope of the other.

The human mind speculates upon the great mysteries of Nature and finds its ideas anticipated by the ancients, whose profoundest thoughts are to be looked for, not in their philosophies, but in their symbols, by which they endeavored to express the great ideas that vainly struggled for utterance in words, as they viewed the great circles of phenomena - Birth, Life, Death and New Life out of Death - to them the greatest of mysteries. Remember, while you study their symbols, that they had a profounder sense of these wonders than we have.

To them the transformation of the worm to the butterfly were a greater wonder than the stars; and hence the poor, dumb scarabs, or beetle, was sacred to them. Thus, their faiths are condensed into symbols or expanded into allegories, which they understood, but were not always able to explain in language; for there are thoughts and ideas which no language ever spoken by man has words to express. The Zodiac was known in India and Egypt for

incalculable ages. Ancient temples were often marked with a carved zodiac, by which the date of the building could be determined by reckoning the difference between the position of the signs of the zodiac as depicted somewhere in the temple, often in the ceiling, and their actual position in the Heavens, at any given time of observation. We moderns use a cornerstone for the same purpose.

The wise men of ancient time, who knew the secret wisdom religion, monumented in the stupendous conception of the zodiac, which was a pictorial design for the common people, the ideas comprehended under the term "Evolution," to which they were able to give a much wider interpretation than modern science has yet been willing to accord to the wisdom of the ancients. Originally only ten of the signs were of a meaning generally known to the uninitiated public; two were secret.

The two most famous divisions of the Heavens, by seven, which is that of the planets, and by twelve, which is that of the zodiacal signs, are found on the religious monuments of all people of the ancient world. In many other ways the system of numbers was closely connected with ancient forms of worship, and has come down to us in Freemasonry; though the secret meaning with which the numbers used by us are filled, is unknown to the vast majority of those who use them.

The three sacred numbers; three, five and seven, consecrated in Freemasonry, always appear together in the stars of the Heavens; in the three "Kings of Orio," near the five stars of the Hyades, and close by the seven of the Pleiades. The veneration paid to these numbers had its source in the stars, where the ancient astronomers saw all the symbols of Freemasonry.

A language of hieroglyphics was adapted to the celebrations of the Sacred Mysteries of ancient Egypt, unknown to any but those who had received the Highest Degree. And to them ultimately were confined the learning, the morality and the political power of every people among which the mysteries were practiced. So effectually was the knowledge of the hieroglyphics of the highest degrees hidden from all but a favored few, that in process of the time their meaning was entirely lost, and none could interpret them.

In this long ago, before the age of books, man also expressed himself in architecture through the use of various symbols; such as the Swastika of the Chaldees, the Triangle of the Egyptians, the Triple Tau of the Hebrews, the

Cross of the Christians, the Square, Compasses, Plumb, Level and Circle of the Architects; blood brothers of the Accepted Masons.

The knowledge now imparted by books and letters was of old conveyed by symbols; and the priests invented or perpetuated a display of rites and exhibitions which were not only more attractive to the eye than words, but often more suggestive and richer with meaning to the mind.

Freemasonry, successor of the Mysteries, still follows the ancient manner of teachings. Her ceremonies are like the ancient mystic shows - not the reading of an essay, but the opening of a problem requiring research and explanation. Her symbols are the instructions she gives. The Lectures are endeavors, often partial and one-sided, to interpret these symbols. He who would become an accomplished Freemason must not be content merely to hear, to even to understand the lectures; he must, aided by them and having as it were, the way marked out for him; study, interpret and develop these symbols for himself.

The more important Masonic symbols are very ancient, and their true meanings can only be found by tracing them back into the past. This will be found to be particularly the case with the Third degree; its true meaning can only be realized by the study of similar rites which appear to go far back into the history of our race.

When the great obelisk called Cleopatra's Needle was lifted from its resting place in Alexandria, Egypt, for the purpose of moving it to the United States; many Masonic symbols were found.

These included a rough ashlar, a perfect ashlar, a square, a trowel, a plummet and a white stone. When the Obelisk was placed in position in Central park, New York City, where it now stands, the emblems were replaced exactly as they had been found at Alexandria. In a brief lecture like this one it is hopeless to attempt to deal at all adequately with such deficiencies as there may be in our knowledge of the Masonic system to which we belong. The most we can hope to do is to offer a few hints or clues, which those who do so desire, may develop for themselves in the privacy of their own thoughts.

For, in the last resource no one can communicate the deeper things in Freemasonry to another. Every man must discover and learn for himself; although, a friend or brother may be able to conduct him a certain distance on the path of understanding.

We know that even the elementary and superficial secrets of our Order must not be communicated to unqualified persons, and the reason for this injunction is not so much because those secrets have any special value, but because that silence is intended to be symbolical of that which applies to the greater, deeper secrets, some of which, for appropriate reasons, must not be communicated, and some of which, indeed, are not communicable at all because they transcend the power of communication.

So, my Brethren, Freemasonry teaches by allegory and symbol, and it is your part to extract from them the truths that will be of service to you in the building of an upright Masonic character. If you see only the stories that Freemasonry presents, and do not perceive what they are designed to teach, you are missing the best part of Freemasonry, yet you may comfort yourself with the thought that by far the greater majority of Freemasons are no wiser than yourself.

A single example of the symbolism of words will indicate to you one branch of Masonic study. We find at one point a certain phrase "I will always hail, ever conceal, and never reveal," and in the catechism, these:

Q. "I Hail," A. "I conceal,"

and ignorance, misunderstanding the word "Hail," considers it as "From whence do you Hail?"

But the word is really "hele" from the Anglo-Saxon verb "helan," to cover, hide, or conceal.

Wherefore to "hele" means the same thing as "Tile" - itself symbolic, as meaning primarily to cover a house with tiles. Thus, language itself is symbolism, and words are as much misunderstood and misused as more material symbols are.

One of the greatest emblems of our Order is the Bible, which is used among Freemasons as the symbol of the Will of God, however it may be expressed. And therefore whatever, to any people, expresses that Will may be used as a substitute for the Bible in an American Masonic Lodge. Thus, in a body consisting entirely of Jews the Old Testament alone may be placed upon the Altar; and Turkish Freemasons may make use of the Koran. Whether it be the Gospels to the Christian, the Pentateuch to the Israelite, the Koran to the Muslim, or the Vedas to the Brahman; it everywhere Masonically conveys the same idea - that of symbolism of the Divine Will revealed to man. The Square is a right angle, and belongs only to geometry - earth- measurements - that

trigonometry, which deals only with planes and with the earth, which the ancients supposed to be a plane.

The compass describes circles, and deals with spherical trigonometry, the science of the spheres and heavens. The square therefore is a symbol of what concerns the earth and the body; the compass of what concerns the heavens and the soul. Upon the Altar you see these tools and you remember how they were arranged in each degree. For the Apprentice, the points of the compass are beneath the square. For the Fellowcraft, one is above and one beneath. For the Master, both are dominant and have the rule, control and empire over the symbol of the earthly and the material. Thus, as the heavens are higher than the earth, so should the spiritual in man rise above the material and dominate all his thoughts and actions.

Our own bodies are but symbols of the Soul within, and as each spirit has in it the more of heavenly light, so it is reflected in a fairer body symbol. Here we find ourselves in a Holy place, as we stand before the Secret of the World, where Being passes into Appearance.

The sun is the ancient symbol of the life-giving and generative power of the Deity. The Moon was the symbol of the passive capacity of nature to produce - the female, of which the life-giving power was the male.

The "Master of Life" was the supreme Deity, above both. The "Master of Life," the Sun and Moon, are symbolized in every Lodge by the Master and Wardens.

The Cross has been a sacred symbol from earliest antiquity... It is found upon all the enduring monuments of the world; in Egypt, Assyria, India, Persia and on the Buddhist Towers of Ireland. Pointing to the four quarters of the world it was the symbol of universal Nature.

The Perfect Ashlar is a symbol of faith and permanency in the Lodge. Stone, the material of which it is made, was considered of great importance in many of the ancient religions, and in some was worshipped.

The Temple of Solomon presented a symbolic image of the Universe; and resembled in its arrangements and furniture, all the temples of the ancient nations that practiced the Mysteries.

The Cosmos is a beautiful flower without much fragrance. Its eight petals are mostly pink and white. In the heart of the flower we find clustered pistils and five pointed stamens which are its male and female reproductive

organs. The name of the flower - Cosmos - is significant and signifies law, order, harmony and truth combined within the Universe.

Thousands of year ago the spiritual leaders of the Chaldeans studied the Universe and symbolized their findings in hieroglyphics which are as full of meaning for us as they were to them. Thus, we find that long before the time of Moses they represented the name of Jehovah by the eight-pointed star - because to them, as to us, He is ever the same. Let us fix this symbol in our minds. Take the calendar pad of any month in which the first day falls on any one of the first five days of the week draw a line through 1, 9 and 17. Do the same through 2,9 and 16; 3,8 and 15; and 8, 9 and 10. The sum of each line is 27.

The resulting eight-pointed figure is a mathematical demonstration of the meaning of this age-old symbol of Jehovah; for, take it in any direction, and we find that, like Him, it represents, it is ever the same.

The five-pointed star - point up - is a very ancient symbol of man, and was used by the old sages to designate the absolute sign of human intelligence. It refers to the spiritual element predominant in man, while the same figure with two points up refers to the Goat of Mendes - or that the beast is in the ascendant.

If we apply this symbolism to our Cosmos blossom we may draw near to God as did those reverent and understanding men of old.

The petals of the flower are in the exact form of the figure you have drawn on your calendar pad, and in the heart of the flower is the ancient symbol of man - "male and female created He them. Square, triangle, cross, circle - oldest symbols of humanity, all of them eloquent, each of them pointing beyond itself, as symbols always do, while giving form to the invisible truth which they invoke and seek to embody. They are beautiful if we have eyes to see, serving not merely as chance figures of fancy, but as forms of reality as it revealed itself to the mind of man.

Sometimes we find them united, the Square within the Circle, and within that the Triangle, and at the center the Cross. Earliest of emblems, as they show us hints and foregleams of the highest faith and philosophy, betraying not only the unity of the human mind but its kinship with the Eternal - the fact which lies at the root of every religion, and is the basis of each.

Freemasonry conceals its secrets from all except the Adept and Sages, or the Elect, and uses false explanations and misinterpretations of its symbols to mislead those who deserve only to be misled; to conceal the truth from them , and to draw them away from it. Truth is not for those who are unworthy or unable to receive it, or would pervert it. So, God Himself incapacitates many men, by color-blindness, to distinguish colors, and leads masses away from the highest Truth, giving them the power to attain only so much of it as is profitable to them to know.

So, Freemasonry jealously conceals its secrets, and intentionally leads conceited interpreters astray.

Albert Pike, one of the deepest students of the symbols of Freemasonry, has this to say of one of the well-known hieroglyphics: "To the circle enclosing the central point and itself traced between two parallel lines, a figure purely Kabbalistic, have been added the superimposed Bible, and reared on that the ladder with three or nine rounds, a vapid interpretation then being given of the whole so profoundly absurd as actually to excite admiration."

It may be asserted in the broadest terms that the Freemason who knows nothing of our symbolism knows little of Freemasonry. He may be able to repeat every line of the ritual without an error, and yet, if he does not understand the meaning of the ceremonies, the signs, the words, the emblems and the figures he is a Masonic ignoramus. It is distressing to notice how much time and labor is spent in memorizing "the work" and how little in ascertaining what it all means. Thousands of Freemasons hear the beautiful truths concealed in the symbolism of our ritual but in the language of the Bible "They have eyes and they see not; they have ears and they hear not."

In the ceremonies of making a Freemason, we do not attempt to do more than to indicate the pathway to Masonic Knowledge, to lay the foundation for the Masonic edifice; the brother must pursue the journey or complete the structure for himself by reading and reflection. Our symbolism is as flexible as it is suggestive, and may be interpreted in many ways by each initiate or student according to his light, "Each sees what he carries in his heart" we read in the Prologue of Faust.

The blossom in your hand - that grasspear nodding at your feet - those mysterious trees which fling their posturing arms to every wind that blows - all are symbolic of an unseen power.

That water lily yonder, which bends to see its reflected image, the bee that dives into its chalice, the waves that lap against the lily-fronds - these too point to an invisible thinker.

The broad-bosomed sea with its lurking depths and myriad life- forms, speaks eloquently of a Master Craftsman. And that purple mountain yonder holds Divine Revelation in its clasp of snow. Behold the scripture of stars - Mars, blinking redly in the southern heavens - Jupiter, trailing like a silver scarab toward the peaks which claimed the setting sun. The Milky way, with its sweep of fiery worlds - that shooting star - our glorious sun - all creation points with an unerring finger to the stupendous Mathematician concealed eternally behind the drapes of Nature.

Mouse and elephant, wren and eagle, minnow and whale - MAN - all carry mutely, surely, a message couched in terms of universal understanding.

God reveals himself today, as in the beginning, through the visible universe around us - His only written word. He speaks to us today as in the far past, through the unchanging language of Nature. His diary is written in the gnawed-out hills, in the Eternal Truths "which lie undiscovered around us."

The Trestleboard of Nature shows A vast array of symbols rare, while all her elements disclose Unchanging truths designed with care, impressed more deeply in the heart While craftsmen diligently strive To gather from symbolic art The truth that through its power survive.

WHY JOPPA?

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The seaport of Joppa pops up several times in the Masonic lore – primarily as the place that King Hiram of Tyre delivered the timber for use in the Temple of King Solomon, in an explanation of a grip, and as the place where the ruffians attempted to escape Palestine on the way to Ethiopia. Almost every jurisdiction that names its lodges (as opposed to just naming them) has at least one lodge named —Joppa. Is there any significance attached to this Mediterranean seaport from a Masonic symbolic point of view or, is it mentioned simply because it was there? More specifically, was there a reason why Joppa was chosen as the place where the ruffians attempted to leave Solomon’s jurisdiction?

Never becoming a major seaport because of its size and topography, over the centuries Joppa did develop as a logistical base for many ancient empires and civilizations. Located on the Mediterranean coast thirty-five to forty miles northwest of Jerusalem and about three miles south of the mouth of the Yarkon River, the entrance to its small cove was from the north and not extremely safe. A natural breakwater of rocks ran parallel to and about 300 feet from the shore to form Joppa’s narrow, and sometimes treacherous small cove. To the north from Joppa towards the Yarkon, were sandstone ridges that essentially prevented landing from the sea. Coastal sands penetrated inland to form a barrier to the sea hampering landing on the south.

Masonic tradition informs us that the coast of Joppa — was so precipitous that it was difficult for the workmen to ascend without assistance... given by Craftsmen stationed along the walls of the harbor for that purpose. Even as late as 1842, when Baron Geramb visited the Holy Land, embarking and disembarking from a ship was difficult, if not outright dangerous because of the high rock borders of the cove and the required height of the bridges (docks) with relationship to the level of the sea. Without ladders the seamen (and passengers) had to have assistance to ascend to the docks.

Joppa is mentioned in secular records from the late bronze age of the mid-15th century B.C. thro' the late 1st century A.D. It seems to have been traded back and forth between the great powers. From Thudmose III through the Ramesside period of Egypt when Joppa was an ordinance center, through the Philistines, Israelites and Persian periods, and into the Greco-Roman period when it last served as a Roman sea base and was destroyed by Vespasian, Joppa is mentioned - ever so sparsely - in the secular records of ancient times in the eastern Mediterranean area, but, it does not seem to have been of any major strategic significance nor of major trading importance.

Excavations of the site show occupation at least from the Middle Bronze Age through the Hellenistic period in seven main strata, with several substrata, that corroborate the written secular and Biblical histories.

Our interest, of course, is the period that the land was controlled by the Israelites. Certain interpretations suggest that Joppa and its surrounding hinterland may have been part of the lands inherited by the tribe of Dan; however, others argue that it was not part of the Danite's inheritance, but remained in the hands of the Philistines. Even if it was not part of the Danite inheritance, the description of the second commissioner's district under Solomon, — in Makaz and in Shaalbin, and Bethshemesh, and Elonbethhanan" seems to include the area around Joppa as a definite part of Solomon's realm. It is obvious that it was servicing as a seaport during the monarchical period when God told Jonah to take his message to Nineveh and Jonah attempted to flee to Tarshish by way of Joppa. And of course. It was the place to which timber was shipped by King Hiram of Tyre for Solomon's building project in Jerusalem and again was the entrance port over 700 years later at the building of the second temple.

In Masonic writings, even as late as 1696 in the Edinburgh Register House Manuscripts there is not even a hint of the Hiramic Legend, much less Joppa. Joppa seems to have it's first appearance shortly after formation of the first Grand Lodge in 1717, when Doctor Anderson casually mentions its historical account of The Craft in the Book of Constitution of 1723. But Anderson only mentions it in the historical sense, not in any ritualistic context, and then only in the Biblical setting as the port to which the timber for the temple was shipped. However, even as the fraternity and its ritual continued to develop, Joppa does not seem to have occupied any significance in the overall scheme. This is vividly shown by its total version of the Hiramic Legend found in Samuel Pritchard's *Masonry Dissected* in 1730.

As we know Pritchard's *Masonry Dissected* appears to have remained as an accepted, albeit disclaimed, monitorial work of the Lodges until the early 1760's. In 1760 an exposure, claiming to be workings of the Lodges under the Ancient's practice, was published by H. Sergeant under the name of *The Three Distinct Knocks*. In this exposure the Hiramic Legend has been expanded to include a search for the assassins that describes one department of the Fellowcraft searchers going —west to the sea of Joppa. In less than three years another alleged exposure, this time claiming to be the work of the — Moderns, also tells of a search for the assassins that carried one of them to —the sea side near Joppa. But neither of these accounts attaches any distinctive significance to this particular seaport.

As time and the Fraternity moved onward, we find no significance attached to Joppa in the Preston or Webb monitors. Indeed, only the alleged exposure of the time seems to even mention Joppa at all. William Morgan's *Illustration of Masonry* published in 1827, in three almost identical passages, mentions that the supposed assassins had attempted to gain passage to Ethiopia at the port of Joppa. But still no hint of any symbolic significance attached to this ancient seaport.

Time continues to march onward, and the Legend expanded on the lessons it was teaching. In this explanation, the need arose for the ruffians or assassins to attempt to escape to teach yet another lesson. The choice was an attempted escape through Joppa to Ethiopia. But why through Joppa? What symbolic significance did Joppa hold? The ritual itself makes no obvious suggestion of any purpose whatsoever. Neither do the Masonic writers over the centuries seem to attach any symbolic significance to this rough little harbor. In fact most do not even mention it, and if they do it is simply in its Biblical and historic sense as the seaport to which the timber and other goods were delivered for Solomon's building projects or in the legendary sense of being the place of the attempted escape from Solomon's domain. In his *Encyclopedia of Freemasonry* Brother Albert G. Mackey simply states that Joppa is a town in Palestine and the seaport of Jerusalem, from which it is distant about forty miles in a westerly direction. It was here that the King of Tyre sent ships laden with timber and marble to be forwarded overland to Solomon for the construction of the Temple. Its shore is extremely rough and much dreaded by navigators who, on account of its exposure, and the perpendicularity of its banks are compelled to be perpetually on their guard. Coil's *Masonic Encyclopedia* does not even list it. Brother Charles C. Hunt, in

his Masonic Concordance of the Holy Bible gives us an apparent interpretation of the name Joppa as —"beauty" and two definitions or explanations — "A Seaport Town of Jerusalem It was from this port that the ships of Hiram, King of Tyre. Transferred their cargoes of supplies for the temple to be shipped overland about forty miles to Jerusalem. B; It Is The Only Harbor between Egypt and Caramel and therefore of great commercial importance. It is now called Gaff and has (in 1948) about 40,000 inhabitants"

Maybe lies here the secret of —Why Joppa|| Joppa was the only harbor between Egypt and Mt. Caramel. Carmel is located near the Mediterranean coast, south of the mouth of the Kishon River about sixty miles north of Joppa and almost eighty miles northwest of Jerusalem. The route from Carmel to Jerusalem is over many hills and small mountains, while the route from Joppa to Jerusalem is only thirty-five to forty miles through valleys and small hills. From a physical - topographical - prospective Joppa was the only logical seaport for Jerusalem, at least on the Mediterranean coast.

Why did King Hiram ship the timbers and other supplies from Tyre to Solomon through Joppa? The overland route from Tyre to Jerusalem was too mountainous and too long. Likewise, the overland route from Carmel to Jerusalem was rough and long. Floating or shipping them to Joppa was relatively easy, and the route from Joppa to Jerusalem was much easier than from any other direction.

But why did the ruffians choose Joppa as their route of escape to Ethiopia? Or, How can you sail from Joppa to Ethiopia? Those questions have been answered previously. The question here is Why was the Joppa route chosen? After all, Solomon had a much larger seaport within his domain. Ezion-geber was at the northern end of the Gulf of Aquaba, a large inlet of the Red Sea. It was here that Solomon built a large smelter for refining the ores of the Arabah. Ezion-geber, as a busy harbor with direct access to the Red Sea, would have been the most logical route to Ethiopia. But Ezion-geber is also located almost one hundred sixty miles from Jerusalem over mountains and desert, and Joppa is only thirty-five to forty miles away. Ezion-geber was more than four times as far away from Jerusalem than Joppa and over a much more harsh and dangerous route - although both routes were within Solomon's jurisdiction. Even for the less-than-brilliant rogues with which the legend deals, the shorter, smoother, safer, and quicker route to exit the jurisdiction, was only logical. Besides, this was the way with which they were

probably most familiar, as this was presumably the way they entered the realm.

Why Joppa? Geography dictated that it was the only logical place, both as the place to import the timbers from Tyre and as the place to leave the country the quickest. There appears to be no symbolic reason for the inclusion of Joppa in our legends.

The Bible refers to two Jerusalem's. One, the material city of that name, the other symbolic, "Holy City" Maybe if we look hard enough, we can find, or even create, a second Joppa We have just looked at the physical Joppa Now

Joppa is not mentioned by name many times in the Bible. We have already seen that it is cited specifically as the port that was used to receive timbers and supplies for Solomon's building projects and again for a like purpose at the second building of the temple. And it was at Joppa that Peter raised Tabitha (Dorcas) from the dead and later at the home of Simon the tanner, had the vision of a calling to carry his ministry to the gentiles. But we cannot overlook the story of Jonah, Remember Jonah was called by God to go to Nineveh and preach against his wickedness, fearing the mission Jonah attempted to flee Israeli and the presence of God himself by going to Tarshish through Joppa. The ship in which he sailed from Joppa was caught in a storm, and Jonah was thrown into the sea by the crew to save themselves and was swallowed by a large fish. After three days in the belly of the fish and after much repenting, he was cast upon the shore and only then did he follow the bidding of the Lord.

The great work in the temple (in which) Hiram was engaged is symbolic of the work you, and all men, do daily. As he supervised the workmen, so do you supervise and organize your life, dreams and hopes. The enemies he encountered... you meet constantly. As he wasn't always victorious, neither will you be. But the hope that was held out for him will be held out for you, if you, like him are faithful to your trust....It is interesting to note that Hiram's enemies came from the inner circle--- the worker's whom he trusted. So, do most of man's adversaries. He will usually guard himself against attacks from those he believes he must fear, but has no reason to protect himself from those he loves and trusts.

Brother Allen Robert identified these enemies as greed, jealousy, and selfishness, Brother Joseph Fort Newton pointed out that three of the greatest

thinkers identified the enemies to be the three primary causes of sin in the human heart, to wit; Socrates contended that one was ignorance, in that, “no man does evil unless he is so blinded by ignorance that he does not see the right” Plato, said that in spite of knowledge and the ability to see right and wrong clearly, man will still do wrong if in a dark mood, and that Passion stirs up sediments from the bottom of the mind and so clouds reason that even clear vision fails. While Aristotle identified the enemy that causes us to do evil as (M)oral (P)erversion, a spirit of sheer mischief, which does wrong, deliberately and in the face of right, calmly and with devilish cunning, for the sake of wrong and for the love of it”

Brothers George S. Drafton George H. Steinetz Albert Pike and many others have all had different interpretations of the actual symbolism of the ruffians or assassins, and this symbolism varies from writer to writer from thinker to thinker from person to person from situation to situation and from time to time. But, the general philosophy remains the same; the assassins are those negative characteristics of man or mankind that have the tendency to assassinate, to maim, to kill, and to destroy the natural precepts embodied in the virtues of Hiram Abif present in all of us.

—When faced with Truth...Divine Truth as symbolized by the judgment and wisdom of Solomon- when confronted with those eternal Truths set forth by the Great Architect of the Universe through the inspired writers of His Volume of The Sacred Law- these Ruffians take flight. They attempt to hide in the remotest regions of man’s own self, that eternal Ethiopia of man’s subconscious where they will be hard to distinguish from other trait’s|| Just as our assassins attempted to flee the judgement of Solomon to Ethiopia and Jonah attempted to flee to Tract. Joppa was the last civilized point that either our assassins or Jonah visited before being stopped, and having to face that which was fleeing. Wherever the assassins or Jonah went, they could not escape God or their own remorse and guilt. This remorse and guilt are stopped in the Joppa of Man. It is in his own Conscious, in his own logic, in his own intellect that man finds his Joppa, that place where the enemies, the ruffians, the assassins of his character can be stopped. It is only when man has Faith enough to allow Truth to enter his Joppa, his Conscious, it is only then that he can stop his inner ruffians.

Most Worshipful Brother Rob Morris, in one of the verses of his poem Quarry, Hill and Temple wrote

Thine at the midnight in the cave

Thine in the floats upon the wave
By Joppa's hill
By Kedron's rill
And thine when Sabbath rest we have
Yes, yes dear friend, my spirit saith
I'm thine until and after death
No bounds control
The Mason's soul
Cemented with a Mason's faith

Why Joppa? It was the only logical place.

MOST EXCELLENT KING SOLOMON

by Dr. J.C. Montgomery, Jr.

Most Worshipful Brother Montgomery served as Grand Master of the Grand Lodge of Missouri in 1978-79. He is a Fellow and Past Master of the Missouri Lodge of Research, and former editor of the Royal Arch Mason International Journal and the Missouri Freemason. Recognized as an outstanding Masonic author, he holds a doctor of divinity degree from Central Methodist College and is a retired United Methodist Minister. This STB encompasses excerpts from an article, originally published in the Winter, 2011 issue of the Missouri Freemason. -Editor

I wonder if you have ever had the experience of sitting through a degree or listening to the "same old, same old" ritual and all of a sudden a phrase, a word, even an action caught your attention in a new way. Now I don't know how many Third Degrees I have witnessed or taken part in during my seventy-one years as a Master Mason, probably a good many. But it was the second section; the Lodge had become the theater. In the first act brave and steadfast Hiram ABI had lost his life. In the second act the scene is a Lodge room within the nearly finished Jerusalem temple; the officers have taken their stations; King Solomon is in the East.

He addresses the Senior Warden. That officer responds: "Most Excellent King Solomon."

That moment jarred me. Ordinarily we address Grand Masters as "Most Worshipful." The word "Excellent" is really found in the York Rite. Why should this be different?

Hiram ABI, presumably a Grand Master from the Craft in Tyre, is not accorded that title. And then the deeper question came to mind. What was there that was "excellent" about Solomon anyhow? Why did the ritual develop in this way?

First of all, we should remember that our ritual (as we have it) is of English origin. The word "Excellent" is an honorific just like "Excellency" and in such usage was applied to royalty or nobility. Likewise, the word "worshipful" is applied to certain offices. In this sense, it is certainly correct to speak of "Most Excellent King Solomon."

Can we apply this to the man himself? But before we make any judgement it might be better to speculate how the ritual itself came to its

present form. I use the word "speculate" because we really do not know the full story.

There may have been several reasons why the eventual ritual of the Master Mason degree, indeed the teachings of all degrees, became centered around the lessons of the Temple. The most obvious one is simply that the operative Masons were builders. It was not much of a stretch to see a link between the building of Solomon's temple and the erection of the magnificent cathedrals. The operative Masons saw theirs as a holy calling, as did Solomon.

Everywhere in England, indeed also in Scotland and Ireland, there were the examples of building, the cathedrals and the castles. And where better to look for building and the builders than in the stories about Solomon and the first temple in Jerusalem?

A second thought about the development of the ritual, especially the second section of the third degree: How would this teaching of the Fraternity be communicated? Obviously by lectures, or the one-on-one instruction of the apprentice by an older fellow of the Craft. But lecturing, even this, gets boring, and something more striking was needed.

Beginning in the 1300's there developed in both England and the continent the community dramas known as the "mystery" or the "morality plays." In the research that I have done, the various guilds or workers associations each took part putting on different scenes, almost always of a religious nature.

For example, the baker's guilds at York and Coventry always did a playlet depicting the Last Supper. The plasterers did the Creation. You would laugh to learn that the water-carriers did the story of Noah and the Flood, and the shipwrights the building of the Ark. Yes, the Masons had a part, but it was not the building of the temple, rather the coming of the Wise Men in the Christmas story.

There was, however, one play which had to do with the building of the Temple. It was called "Hiram's (Hiram's) Dream." It depicted the vision which Hiram the architect had for the Temple. Unfortunately, as the Protestant Reformation prevailed in England and the plays were banned as being Catholic, that and many other manuscripts were lost or destroyed. Nonetheless a century and a half later the format of the mystery play found its

way back in the legend of the Third Degree, the building of the Temple, and the appearance of the one we address as "Most Excellent King Solomon."

It may seem anti-climactic because this has been a long way back to the question, what was excellent about Solomon? Here I want to touch on some features of the king's life, trying to look at it with an historian's eye but a Mason's heart. It is difficult not to be "preachy," because the most of what we know comes from the Holy Scriptures, especially the First Book of Kings with echoes in Chronicles, the early historians Josephus and Eusebius, and some of the findings of modern archeology.

We should not forget that the Temple was an historic fact, that Solomon, King Hiram of Tyre, and Hiram the skilled craftsman were actual historical figures. It would not be surprising if across the nearly 3,000 years since they lived, legends and myths did not develop. Indeed, they were the sort of leaders about whom stories would cluster. Parenthetically it should be noted that almost every culture has a story about a faithful workman who lost his life in the defense of his integrity. Small wonder that this found its way into Masonic teachings.

Nonetheless it is fair to say that Solomon and his reign represented both heights and depths of ancient Israelite history. Here I am indebted to John Kenneth Kuntz, a younger ministerial colleague in Missouri, who went on to a distinguished academic career as a professor of religion at the University of Iowa.

First, Solomon left a record of administrative achievements. Ignoring traditional tribal boundaries, he reorganized the nation into twelve administrative districts. These provisioned his court and served as a source of labor for his building programs.

Second, Solomon had a strong military policy. His military machine boasted 1,400 chariots and 12,000 horsemen (I Kings 10:26). In modern terms we might call it "a quick strike force." He strengthened the fortifications of Jerusalem and put military centers and cavalry posts around the nation's perimeter.

Again, Solomon pursued an active foreign policy; much after the custom of the time, it was through marriage. This was a custom of many nations even until modern times, except that in the case of Solomon it seems to have been quite a harem. By marrying Pharaoh's daughter, Solomon secured the city of Gezer as part of her dowry. It served as a defense outpost for Israel. Because

of his alliance with Tyre, Solomon could expand his architectural and maritime ambitions.

The nation had been primarily agrarian and pastoral. Solomon brought them into the world of commerce and industry. He established a trade program centered on the Gulf of Aqaba. He entered the caravan trade with the Sabeian kingdom of Arabia through the visit of the queen of Sheba (I Kings 10: 1- 10,13). We have heard of horse traders; Solomon became a middleman in the business of chariots from Egypt and horses from Cilicia, all of which passed through Israelite territory and presumably paid excise fees both ways.

Then, of course, there was Solomon's building program: A full administrative complex, a house for Pharaoh's daughter, a judgment hall, and "the house of the Forest of Lebanon," which was both an armory and the treasury. And our Masonic ritual gives us embroidered Biblical details of the Temple, not alone a place of worship but a symbol of imperial power. We may think of the three inner pillars designated Wisdom, Strength, and Beauty.

The final achievement of Solomon is that this was an age of enlightenment for ancient Israel. Open to the world of that day in material ways, it became culturally productive. Solomon fostered a court-centered wisdom movement. It is an exaggerated statement that Solomon spoke 3,000 proverbs and composed 1,005 songs (I Kings 4:31- 32) and that the Hebrew Scripture books of Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, and The Song of Solomon are attributed to him. Perhaps there is a Solomonic nucleus in the Proverbs.

By all of these criteria, the ancient king richly deserves the title of "Excellent," yet we know that for all of his achievements the reign of the powerful monarch sowed the seeds of the kingdom's failure. The grandiose programs drained the resources of the land. He had encouraged a social stratification which violated the Mosaic covenant which embraced all Israelites as equal before YHWH. He violated Torah by his foreign marriages and his tolerance of alien faiths.

Yet Solomon remains important for us as Freemasons. The lessons of the temple are not so much a narrative of history as they are an invitation to the kind of life we build and the faithfulness we show. Finally, in the drama of the second section Solomon keeps his word. But the real hero is not the king.

Rather it is you, the faithful Mason, who learns and lives those lessons. As the line from the song, "The Impossible Dream," goes: "And the world will be better for this."

THE HIRAMIC LEGEND: WHENCE & WHEREFORE

by W. Bro. Chakravarthy Sampath Madhavan

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PREFACE

The Hiramic Legend is the heart of the third degree ritual. Hiram Abif is one of the brightest characters recorded in the annals of Freemasonry, and his story is held up as the shining example for all Masons to emulate. Being the principal actor in the drama of the ritual, he might fairly be expected to make a ceremonial entrance from the wings. But Hiram comes to centre-stage through a trap door as it were. The legend is presented, suddenly and dramatically, in the third degree, without the least hint of it in the preceding degrees; neither the Entered Apprentice nor the Fellow-Craft knows anything at all about Hiram Abif.

Masonic scholars have tried to trace the origin of the Hiramic Legend, and discover when and why it was introduced in our ritual. But there is very little written record available about the internal working of the lodges before the early 18th century, and the little that is available is "complex, confusing, and often fragmentary". Our knowledge of the history of those times is incomplete and obscure, and according to Robert Gould:

To a necessarily great extent therefore, all speculations with regard to the more remote past of the sodality must repose on inference or conjecture; and deductions which are accepted with easy faith by some, will be rejected as irrational by others.

In this paper I have tried to present, with as little speculation as possible, a plausible and coherent account of the origin of the Hiramic Legend and of its inclusion in the traditions of our Craft.

With this rather lengthy preamble let us now start on the subject of this paper, for doing which there can be no better place than the VSL.

HIRAM ABIF IN THE BIBLE

The Bible has two accounts of the building of King Solomon's Temple - in the Second Book of Chronicles, and the First Book of Kings. According to

Second Chronicles (ii:3) Solomon requested Hiram, King of Tyre, to furnish men and materials for building the Temple. Solomon also asked for a specially gifted craftsman:

Send me now, a man cunning to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass, and in iron, and in purple, and crimson, and blue, and that can skill to grave with the cunning men that are with me in Judah, and in Jerusalem. (ii:7)

The King of Tyre accordingly sent Hiram to King Solomon, saying:

And now I have sent a cunning man, endued with understanding, of Hiram my father's, the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan, and his father was a man of Tyre, skillful to work in gold, and in silver, in brass, in iron, in stone, and in timber, in purple, in blue. and in fine linen, and in crimson; also, to grave any manner of graving, and to find out every device which shall be put to him, with thy cunning men, and with the cunning men of my lord David thy father. (ii. 13 &14)

From this it is apparent that Hiram was esteemed highly in his profession as to have been deputed for so important a work.

He is alluded to as "Hiram Abi," and the word "Abi," meaning "my father," is usually taken in the sense of "master," a title of respect and distinction.

Solomon had asked for a craftsman to work and engrave on metals and that is exactly what Hiram was. The pieces which he executed for the Temple were:

The two pillars, and the pommels and the chapters which were on the top of the pillars ; and four hundred pomegranates on the two wreaths; two rows of pomegranates on each wreath, to cover the two pommels of the chapters which were upon the pillars. He made also bases, and lavers made he upon the bases; one sea and twelve oxen under it. The pots also, and the shovels and the flesh hooks and all their instruments, did Hiram his father make to King Solomon, for the house of the Lord, of bright brass. Chronicles (2: iii. 15 to 2: iv:16) & Kings (1: vii: 15 to 45)

So how did a skilled metalworker come to be known as a master stone mason? Alfred Mackey offers an interesting explanation.

In the original Hebrew text of the passage in the book of Chronicles, the words which designate the profession of Hiram Abif are Khoresh nekhoshet, -

literally, a worker in brass. The error into which the old legendists and the modern Masonic writers have fallen, in supposing him to have been a stonemason or an architect, has arisen from the mistranslation in the Authorized Version of the passage in Chronicles where he is said to have been "skillful to work in gold and in silver, in brass, in iron, in stone, and in timber." The words in the original are Baabanim vebagnelsim, in stones and in woods, - that is, in precious stones and in woods of various kinds.

That is to say, besides being a coppersmith he was a lapidary and a carver and gilder.

The wrong translation of the words 'stones and woods' in the singular to 'stone and timber', could well have led to the supposition that he was a stonemason.

There are two other differences between the accounts given in the two texts. In the Second Chronicles he is described as "the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan, and his father was a man of Tyre", while First Kings says "He was a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in brass".

Similarly, according to the Chronicles Hiram was sent to Jerusalem by the King of Tyre, when Solomon started to build the temple. But the Book of Kings says that "King Solomon sent and fetched Hiram out of Tyre" (vii; 1 & 8) when the temple was completed.

While most Masonic historians dismiss these as minor discrepancies, some argue otherwise, and suggest that there could have been two persons - possibly father and son - and claim that this interpretation confirms the death of Hiram. The first, a master craftsman who could work on any metal, who was probably murdered before his work was completed. And the second, his son, (his mother having become a widow because of the death of his father), who could work only in brass.

Solomon sent and fetched him out of Tyre, instead of merely summoning him, (that is he sent his men to conduct him safely because of what happened to his father) to complete the work left unfinished by the death of his father.

Be it as it may, let us next look into Hiram in our Masonic history.

HIRAM ABIF IN MASONIC TRADITIONS

The earliest factual information that we have about Masonic history comes from a collection of documents known as the "Old Charges" or the "Manuscript Constitution" of Masonry. Two of the earliest of these are the Regius Manuscript of 1390 and the Cooke Manuscript of 1410. There are 130 versions of these documents running right through the 18th century. We

meet with the first allusion to Hiram Abif in the Cooke MS. It says:

And at the making of the Temple in Solomon's time, as stated in the Bible in the third book of Kings and the fifth chapter, Solomon held four score thousand masons at work. And the son of the king of Tyre was his master mason.

Here Adoniram, the chief of the workmen on Mount Lebanon who was "over the levy", and who was later stoned to death, has been confused with Hiram Abif. The literal meaning of Adoniram being Lord Hiram, it has been mistakenly concluded that this Lord Hiram was the son of the King of Tyre. In nearly all the succeeding manuscripts the word Adon, seems to have been corrupted, and he is called variously as Aynon, Aman, Amon and Adon.

The first mention of the Hiramic Legend, including the murder, the discovery and the raising occurs in 1730, in Samuel Prichard's *Masonry Dissected*. But the name of Hiram Abif is first found in Dr. James Anderson's *Book of Constitutions* of 1723 in which he says The King of Tyre sent to King Solomon his namesake Hiram Abif, the prince of architects . . . the wise King Solomon was Grand Master of the Lodge at Jerusalem, King Hiram was Grand Master of the Lodge at Tyre, and the inspired Hiram Abif was Master of Work.

The second edition of Anderson's *Constitutions* published in 1738 mentions the death of Hiram Abif.

Their joy was soon interrupted by the sudden death of their dear master, Hiram Abif, whom they decently interred in the Lodge near the Temple, according to ancient Usage.

And that is the first known reference to the death of Hiram Abif.

ORIGIN OF THE HIRAMIC LEGEND

The question that naturally arises is how did the elaborate legend of the builder originate from such slender references, and how was a tragedy invented where there probably was none?

Most Masonic researchers are of the view that the Hiramic Legend is simply the adaptation of the Legend of Osiris, with a Masonic and Biblical background. John Fellows suggests "The story of Hiram is only another version, like those of Adonis and Astarte, and of Ceres and Proserpine, of the fable of Osiris and Isis."

This legend is briefly narrated below:

Osiris was the wise and benevolent king of Egypt who was killed by his jealous brother Seth. This evil brother then cut up Osiris' body and scattered the parts throughout Egypt. Osiris had a faithful wife Isis who, along with her sister Nephthys, gathered the pieces together. Using her magical abilities, Isis put the pieces back together, but Osiris could never again live like the other gods. He, therefore, reigned as lord of the underworld. Horus, the falcon-headed son of Osiris and Isis killed his uncle Seth in battle and became the ruler of Egypt. Horus was born to Isis after the death of Osiris, and was therefore called a widow's son.

As Fellows so categorically states, "The likeness throughout is so exact as not to admit of doubt."

We might now digress a little to briefly discuss the structure of the Craft and the evolution of the ritual in the 17th and 18th centuries.

TRANSITION FROM OPERATIVE TO SPECULATIVE MASONRY

Until the 17th century, Freemasonry was mainly operative, and consisted of three classes or ranks - not degrees – of Masons, namely, Masters, who made contracts and undertook the work of building for employers; Fellow-Crafts or Journeymen employed by these Masters; and Entered Apprentices, who were received and taught the art of building. After seven years the apprentice was required to offer an essay or master's piece as proof of proficiency, and then admitted as a Master of the Art and a Fellow of the Craft. This ceremony of admission is the basis of our ritual.

In those days Fellow Crafts followed the work from building site to building site. When a building was completed, they travelled, sometimes a considerable distance, to the site of another building, seeking employment. As they were not so well known to one another or to the Masters, it was necessary for the Master to be satisfied that the man was not a cowan, or rough layer, but capable of skilled work. It also had to be ensured that that he

had been regularly received into the Guild, a necessary condition of employment in those days. So "lodges" were formed at each site, to meet when necessary, to admit apprentices and Fellow Crafts. According to C.N. Batham:

The picture, then, is of lodges throughout the country meeting irregularly as occasion demanded, perhaps not surviving for any great length of time, and of informal meetings of groups of members of the Craft for the sole purpose of initiating friends of theirs. There is nothing other than brief references to their ceremonies as, unfortunately for Masonic historians, brethren of those days were pledged to the utmost secrecy about all aspects of Free-masonry and so committed nothing to writing if they could possibly avoid doing so.

But as the erection of great buildings such as cathedrals, palaces, and castles grew less, masons became more settled in towns where they were employed in more ordinary building. Then they formed what Bro. Knoop calls "territorial lodges". After the settling of lodges at fixed centres, non-operative members began to be admitted. Thus, in the 17th century the transition from "operative" to "speculative" got well under way. Hughan remarks:

The 17th century operative Masons were most favourable to the speculative element in their midst, and encouraged their admission to such an extent, that sometimes the Lodges consisted almost exclusively of brethren in no way connected with building.

This culminated in the transition to a wholly speculative character in the 18th century. Alfred Mackey says:

These two elements of Freemasonry continued to exist together for a very long period of time. But at length, from causes which must be attributed to the increasing power and influence of the Speculative element, as well as to intellectual progress, there came a total and permanent disseverance of the two. . . . The men of culture and science who were in constant communion with their operative associates, were getting dissatisfied with a society of mechanics who had lost much of that skill as architects. ...The first act of severance occurred in England in the year 1717, when the Grand Lodge of "Free and Accepted Masons" was organised followed nineteen years afterward by the organization of the Grand Lodge of Scotland with similar methods.

EVOLUTION OF THE THREE DEGREE SYSTEM

We had seen earlier that, in the early 17th century the ritual consisted of a simple ceremony of accepting an apprentice, and that because of illiteracy and secrecy, there exist few records of the nature of this ceremony. Some Masonic scholars hold that there were two ceremonies. G.W. Speth believes that:

The Apprentice was "made" a Mason by some ceremony of a secret character, and received certain signs and words and so on for recognition. At the end of his servitude, his passing into the ranks of free craftsmen, Masters of the Art and fellows of the Fraternity, was celebrated by another secret ceremony, in which further signs and words and so on were communicated, and that this ceremony contained the essentials of the present third degree.

This theory is borne out by the Edinburgh Register House Manuscript dated 1696, found in the Public Records Office of Edinburgh. This contains the earliest description of the ceremonies and catechisms of the two degrees.

We now move on to the founding of the Grand Lodge in 1717. We definitely know that there were two degrees at that time and the second or senior degree was titled "Master and Fellow-Craft." The founding of the Grand Lodge also signaled the transition of the Craft from Operative to Speculative, the Speculatives being dominant. In time, the simple Operative ritual was no longer considered to be fitting to the character of the new Order and was progressively replaced by a more ornate one adapted to the designs of Speculative Freemasonry. According to Mackey:

On the establishment of the Grand Lodge . . . Speculative Freemasons perfected the transition from wholly Operative to wholly Speculative Freemasonry by the fabrication of degrees and the development of a more philosophical ritual, composed, as it has always been conjectured, by Desaguliers and Anderson, but principally always by the former.

The original first degree was split into two and the second degree became the third. The Three-Degree System grew up by a gradual process between 1717 and 1730 and the ritual evolved from a simple ceremony for communicating the secrets of the Craft, to a sophisticated philosophical system of allegory and symbolism. This evolution from rudimentary ceremonies and catechisms, to the beautiful and elaborate ritual of today continued - through the time of the Union of the 'Antients' and the 'Moderns'

in 1813, and the formation of "Stability Lodge of Instruction" in 1817, and the "Emulation Lodge of Improvement" in 1823 - until 1835.

HIRAMIC LEGEND IN THE RITUAL

The first record of the third degree being conferred was at London in 1724. But the Hiramic Legend was probably not part of the ritual of that time. We had seen earlier that Anderson's Constitutions of 1723 make no mention of the tragedy, but just fifteen years later, in the second Constitutions of 1738, the three ruffians had killed the Prince of Architects. This is conclusive proof that the Hiramic Legend became a part of Masonic Traditions between 1723 to 1738, and not earlier.

Pick and Knight, in their Pocket History of Freemasonry say:

It is probable that, before the Craft finally settled on the building of King Solomon's Temple, other prototypes were tried out, perhaps by small groups of Masons in isolated parts of the country.

We come across one such prototype in the Graham MS of 1726, with which we shall deal in detail in the next section of this paper.

For the present we shall continue with the question whether the story was entirely originated by the compilers of the new ritual, or was there some foundation for it existing in the craft guilds before the formation of the Grand Lodge? Gould thinks:

If the murder of Hiram Abif had been a tradition of the Craft in early days, not only would allusions to him be found in the literature of the Order, but he would have appeared in the earlier degrees, and not been thrust without any sort of warning into the third degree, much to the surprise of all who regard Craft Masonry as a gradually developing spectacle.

Hughan is also of the opinion that ritualistically Hiram Abif is unknown before the Third Degree, and this has not been traced before 1723-7.

But there is another school of thought that contends, with justification, that Brethren, who a few years later, split up on very simple points into Ancients and Moderns, would not have allowed an entirely new legend to be introduced into Freemasonry and believes that there is sufficient evidence to prove that some part of the story of Hiram was known to Masons before this period. For instance, we read that, at the installation of the Duke of Montagu

as Grand Master in 1721, Dr. John Beal, Deputy Grand Master, was invested and installed into the chair of Hiram Abif, to the left of the Grand Master.

I would like to end this part of our discussion by quoting Gould:

When the legend of Hiram's death was first incorporated with our older traditions, it is not easy to decide, but in my judgment it must have taken place between 1723 and 1729, and, I should be inclined to name 1725 as the most likely year for its introduction.

- but with the proviso that it is not impossible that the Legend, or some part of it, was known to the Craft before that time.

THE LEGEND OF NOAH AND THE GRAHAM MANUSCRIPT

We had, in the previous section, mentioned the Graham manuscript of 1726. This is of special importance for a study of the development of our Ritual because this manuscript makes very clear reference to King Solomon and Hiram Abif, and their respective parts in the building of the Temple:

Four hundred and four score years after the Children of Israel came out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of Solomon's reign over Israel, that Solomon began to build the House of the Lord. . . . Now we read in the 13th verse of the 7th chapter of the First Book of Kings that Solomon sent and fetched Hiram out of Tyre, he being a widow's son of the Tribe of Naphtali, and his father was a man of Tyre, a worker in brass. . . . And he came to King Solomon and wrought all his work for him.

But the manuscript does not go on to give us the legend of our third degree, which has Hiram as its central figure. Instead, it gives practically all the ingredients of that legend in a very different setting, with a "traditional history" of which Noah was the central figure - which may be taken as about 1,300 years before the building of King Solomon's Temple. In the words of H.W. Coil:

We have it by tradition and still some reference to scripture that Shem, Ham and Japheth went to their father Noah's grave to try to find something about him to lead them to the veritable secret which this famous preacher had, for all things needful for the new world were in the Ark with Noah. Now these 3 men had agreed that, if they did not find the very thing itself, that the first thing they did find was to be to them as a secret thing not doubting but did most firmly believe that God was able and would cause what they did find

to prove as veritable to them as if they had received the secret at first from God himself. So, they came to the grave finding nothing but the dead body almost consumed. Taking a grip at a finger, it came away; so from joint to joint; so to the wrist; so to the elbow; so they reared up the dead body and supported it; setting foot to foot, knee to knee, breast to breast, cheek to cheek and hand to back, and cried out: 'Help, O, father,' as if they had said; 'O, Father of Heaven, help us now for our earthly father cannot.'" So they laid down the dead body again and not knowing what to do, one, said: 'Here is yet marrow in the bone;' and the second said: 'But a dry bone,' and the third said; 'It stinketh.' So, they agreed to give it a name as is known to Freemasonry to this day.

We cannot fail to observe that there are several details that are almost identical with elements in the Hiramic Legend.

Anderson, in the Book of Constitutions of 1723 calls Noah and his three sons "all Masons true". This perhaps was an admission that the Legend of Noah was in use at that time, and a hint that its inclusion in the ritual of the proposed Third Degree was being contemplated by him and Dr. Desaguliers.

SYNOPSIS

Recapitulating the summary of the preceding sections of this paper, it can be reasonably assumed that: -

Hiram Abif is mentioned in the Bible and in Anderson's Constitutions and is referred to by different names in the Old Charges.

The Hiramic legend is an adaptation of the legend of Osiris;

Freemasonry had become predominantly, if not completely, speculative by 1717;

Prior to 1717 a two degree system was in existence, and the ritual of the second degree contained elements of the present Third Degree;

The Three Degree system was probably invented in 1724 by Dr. Desaguliers to give a philosophical and ethical content to the ritual.

The Legend of Noah was in use when the Three Degree system was introduced, and was later replaced by the Hiramic Legend.

REASONS FOR THE INTRODUCTION OF THE LEGEND.

Let us next discuss the reasons for the introduction of the legend of the Builder in the ritual of Freemasonry. We know that the three degrees were meant by Dr. Desaguliers to represent birth & infancy, adulthood & education, and old age, death, & immortality of the soul, respectively. The symbolism of the third degree is expressed by the powerful imagery of Ecclesiastes xii, which is an exhortation to remember the Creator while you are still young, because old age will soon catch up with you, and the pleasures of life will no longer be yours to seek. That is, in old age, one should be able to look back on a life well spent, one's responsibilities fully discharged, and contemplate the end with equanimity and without fear, secure in the knowledge that it is only the body which will perish, while the soul is immortal. The great and useful lesson of the third degree is that:

(Nature) prepares you, by contemplation, for the closing hours of existence, and when by means of that contemplation she has conducted you through the intricate windings of this mortal life, she finally prepares you how to die.

And also, that one need not fear death because the soul is immortal:

. . . in this perishable frame there resides a vital and immortal principle .
. .

I submit that had this sentence been completed with a phrase like "which will endure when time with you shall be no more" it would have been more appropriate to the context, and more in tune with the theme of the teaching. But the ritual says that "the Lord of Life will enable us to trample the King of terrors beneath our feet". The resentment, violence and deep anger expressed in these words appears to be in sharp discord with the spirit of the degree, which is tranquility.

Let us now look at the Graham manuscript, and the Legend of Noah. It is fully in consonance with, and would have, as it probably did, amply illustrated the message of the Third Degree.

We have a very old and venerated patriarch, who was laid to rest after a life of great achievement.

It has its origins in the Bible and is, in fact, older than the story of Solomon's Temple.

It has been referred to in all the Old Charges, and is well known to the Craft.

It has all the elements that make up the legend of Hiram.

It was used in the third degree ritual before being substituted by the Hiram Legend.

Now comes the important question. Why was the Legend of Noah replaced by the Legend of Hiram? Both are similar enough to warrant the continuance of the former. But if the Hiram Legend replaced it in the Third Degree Ritual, it obviously was because it had an element which the former lacked - that of betrayal, violent death, martyrdom and revenge.

When we are taught to face death serenely, knowing that the soul is immortal, where is the question of grieving over a death, and avenging it? Truth to tell, it is this contradiction that prompted my study, and I believe that, it is in the answer to this question that we will find the reason for including the Hiram Legend in our ritual.

BRIEF HISTORY OF ENGLAND & SCOTLAND IN 17th AND 18TH CENTURIES

We had mentioned earlier that Masonic scholars have tried to trace the origin of the Hiram Legend, and discover why it was introduced in our ritual. They have propounded many theories, some of which are listed below:

1. The actual death of Hiram Abif.
2. The legend of Osiris.
3. Expulsion of Adam from Paradise.
4. The entry of Noah into the Ark.
5. Death and Resurrection of Christ.
6. The murder of Thomas Becket.
7. Persecution of the Templars and the death of DeMolay.
8. Execution of Charles I.
9. An invention of the Jacobites to aid the house of Stuart.
10. A representation of Old Age.

Of these, I would like to take up the execution of Charles I, for further examination. This is because, it was a cataclysmic event which had the element of violent death, martyrdom and revenge; it could have provoked the strong resentment and anger observed earlier; and it occurred at the precise period of time that has been the subject of our discussions.

At this juncture, we might take a brief look at the history of the Royal House of Stuart during those turbulent years of early 17th century. At its zenith, the dynasty ruled over the kingdoms of England & Scotland, but in 1746 its fortunes were irretrievably lost in the bloody battle of Culloden.

For over 300 years Scotland had to struggle constantly to preserve its independence and fend off a powerful England. Yet ironically, in 1603, it was the Scottish king, James VI who ascended the English throne as James I and united the two

kingdoms. On his death in 1625, his son Charles became king. But in 1649, after a civil war, Charles was tried by Parliament, and beheaded. The regicide traumatised the nation because, the populace remained largely royalist at heart; as evidenced by the fact, that after the Parliament had ruled the country for 11 years, monarchy was restored. Charles II, exiled son of the dead king ascended the throne and his brother, James II succeeded him. James attempted to restore royal prerogative, and supported the Catholic faith. In 1688 Parliament forced James to abdicate in favour of his Protestant daughter Mary, and her husband William, to prevent succession by his Catholic son, James Francis Edward, later to be known as the Old Pretender. This is called the Glorious Revolution of 1688. James died in exile in France in 1701. The Old Pretender, and his son, called Bonnie Prince Charlie, or the Young Pretender, made several efforts to recapture the throne of England; their supporters were called Jacobites. There were two major Jacobite uprisings; the attempt of the Old Pretender in 1715 had considerable support in Scotland but failed due to inept leadership; that of Bonnie Prince Charlie in 1745 was badly planned and the Jacobites were mercilessly slaughtered in Culloden. That was the end of the Jacobite cause.

HIRAMIC LEGEND AND THE EXECUTION OF CHARLES I

It must now be emphasised that from hereon the evidence is circumstantial, and our arguments, like Freemasonry in the middle of the 17th century, become predominantly speculative. With this caveat, let us

return to the Hiramic Legend and the execution of Charles I. By the middle of the 17th century, Freemasonry had acquired power and prestige. Many eminent Masons - Robert Murray, Elias Ashmole, Inigo Jones and Nicholas Stone, to name a few - were staunch royalists. It is quite probable that the dead King's son, then in exile in France, was in contact with his supporters, and that they met in the safety and privacy of the Lodge to further their designs. For obvious reasons those designs had to be concealed from other members of the Craft. A suggestion was advanced that the Hiramic Legend might have been invented and cautiously introduced in the ritual to promote loyalty to the royalist cause. In the words of Hextall, the Hiramic Tradition was:

Calculated to remind the Royalist Freemasons, in the strongest possible manner, of the murder of their King, and of events to be striven for in the future.

In his History of the Three Grand Lodges, Rebold supports this theory and suggests that the speculative Masons of England and Scotland invented two higher degrees, and gave to Freemasonry an entirely political character; that these Masons were men of power and high position, and it was through their influence that Charles II was enabled to recover the throne in 1660.

Professor Robinson in his 'Proofs of Conspiracy' also appears to entertain similar thoughts:

It is not improbable that the covert of secrecy in those assemblies had made them coveted by the Royalists as occasions of meeting. Nay, the Ritual of the Master's Degree seems to have been formed, or perhaps twisted from its original institutions, so as to give an opportunity of sounding the political principles of the candidate, and the whole of the Brethren present. For it bears so easy an adaptation to the death of the King.

Ragon, in his Masonic Orthodoxy, goes still further. He says that Ashmole and other Brethren had renounced the simple initiation and established new degrees. That the Fellow Craft degree was fabricated in 1648, and that of Master a short time afterward; that the decapitation of King Charles I, and the part taken by Ashmole in favour of the Stuarts produced great modifications in this third and last degree, which had become of a Biblical character.

Dr. Oliver, in a posthumous work titled "The Discrepancies of Freemasonry," says that "The Grand Mystery", published in 1924

. . .was the examination or lecture used by the Craft in the 17th century, the original of which, in the handwriting of Elias Ashmole, was given to Anderson when he made his collections for the "Book of Constitutions.

There is one other fact that lends credence to this theory. In 1720 "several valuable manuscripts concerning the Lodges, regulations, charges, secrets and usages of Masons (particularly one written by Mr. Nicholas Stone, the Warden under Inigo Jones) were too hastily burned by some scrupulous Brothers" in order that the papers "might not fall into strange hands". The destruction followed a request by Grand Master Payne that any old writings or records concerning the fraternity, to show the usages of ancient times, should be brought to the Grand Lodge. Preston, in his Illustrations, remarks:

Many of the fraternity's records of this and the preceding reigns were lost at the Revolution: and not a few were too easily burnt in our times by some scrupulous brothers, from a fear of making discoveries prejudicial to the interests of Masonry. There is evidence enough here to concede that the execution of King Charles I was the possible cause of the invention of the Hiramic Legend, to which Elias Ashmole was possibly instrumental. But even if the legend had been actually invented and introduced in our ritual, there would have been no justification for its continuance, since its purpose - viz. restoration of monarchy - was accomplished in 1660. So, it might not be unreasonable to suggest that the propagation of the Hiramic Legend was abandoned after the Restoration, but was resumed after 1715 when the Jacobite cause demanded it.

HIRAMIC LEGEND AND THE JACOBITE CAUSE

Let us now examine the possible connection of the Hiramic Legend with the Jacobites. The 1708 Act of Union was repugnant to the Scots, and the accession of the Hanoverians to the thrones of England and Scotland in 1714 rekindled their latent loyalty to the Stuarts. The rebellion of 1715 nearly succeeded, and brought home the fact that the Jacobite cause had many influential supporters, not a few among them probably being Freemasons. It is not improbable that they used the privacy of the Lodge, as was done during the Cromwellian interregnum, and revived the old legend of the builder to test and keep alive the loyalty of Brethren to the Jacobite cause.

Much has been written about Freemasonry and the Jacobites and it is unnecessary for us to dwell in detail on that aspect. But no account of the

subject would be complete without the mention of Chevalier Michael Andrew Ramsay, who was tutor to the Young Pretender. Ramsay was a man of learning and genius - a Scotsman, a Jacobite, a Roman Catholic, and an ardent Freemason to boot. He used his not inconsiderable powers to adapt Freemasonry as a fitting instrument for the restoration of Stuart fortunes. It is a matter of history that he invented the High Degrees during the second and third decades of the 18th century for this purpose. It is not improbable that he would have influenced the development and interpretation of the Craft ritual as well to the advantage of the Jacobites. Being intimately acquainted with the old legends of Masonry, he transferred the Biblical allusions of Freemasonry to his political aim.

Many examples of this can be cited from the rituals of the Scottish Rites. But we will restrict ourselves here only to those in respect of our Craft. One such is that, after the death of James II in 1701, his Queen Consort, Mary of Modena, survived as a widow for a period of seventeen years; her son the Old Pretender was styled "the widow's son", thus being identified with Hiram Abif. Similarly, the Jacobites invented a new substitute word for the master's degree, very similar to the word that we know... This word, 'Macbenac' is derived from the Gaelic Mac, a son, and benach, blessed, and literally means the "blessed son"; and this word was applied by the Jacobites to James.

According to Rev. Covey Crump:

The possibility does remain that the Hiramic Tradition had in some way a Jacobite application, and that it was with the object of concealing that connection from Anderson that the famous holocaust of Masonic documents was effected in 1720.

We thus have reasonable grounds to propose that Jacobite loyalties could well have influenced the preferment of the Hiramic legend over the Legend of Noah in our ritual. I would now sum up this discussion with the words of Mackey, from whom I have drawn much in the course of this treatise:

It cannot be denied that at a subsequent period the primitive degrees were modified and changed till their application of the death of Hiram Abif to that of Charles I., or the dethronement of James II, and that higher degrees were created with still more definite allusion to the destinies of the family of Stuart.

CONCLUSION

In the preceding pages I have attempted to present a compendium of facts about the most celebrated Mason of all time. I have approached the Legend of Hiram Abif purely in a spirit of historic enquiry, and I believe, established a tenable case that its inclusion in the ritual of our Craft could have been influenced by the Jacobites. But it must always be remembered that any conclusion about its antiquity or authenticity can in no way affect the value of the legend to Freemasons. The lessons found in the Legend of Hiram Abif reach to the roots of the soul and spirit. They are instilled in the heart forever. They depict man's search for truth, for courage, for his immortal soul. And that is why the Legend will live on and on and Hiram Abif will be venerated in the traditions of Freemasonry and continue to shine as the stars for ever and ever.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I gratefully list below the works of eminent Masonic scholars, which I have consulted and quoted from, in preparing this article.

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- Freemasonry - From AD 1600 to the Grand Lodge Era: A Sketch of the transition Period - Bro. W.J. Hughan
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- The Legend Of Hiram Abiff - Jerry Marsengill
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- Making of a Nation - George S. Draffen.
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- The Legend of The Third Degree - R.S. Thornton
- The Degrees of Masonry: Their Origin and History - A.L. Kress & R.J. Meerken
- Masonic Education Course - Kent Henderson
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